# Miscellaneous — Smart Short Notes

General Studies: General Science | Environment & Ecology |
Economic & Social Development | Uttar Pradesh Special

Condensed revision notes distilled from the UPPSC question-bank PDF (361 pages, ~2,000 MCQs), organised topic-wise for quick revision.

# Contents


## PART I - GENERAL SCIENCE

Miscellaneous · Environment and Sustainable Development

## PART II - ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

Ecology · Food Chain in Ecosystem · Flow of Energy · Ecosystem: Miscellaneous · Biodiversity · Causes of Biodiversity Loss and Conservation · Endangered Species · Ramsar Convention · Biodiversity : Miscellaneous · Greenhouse Effect and Climate Change · Climate Change Conference · Climate Change : Miscellaneous · Ozone Layer · Forest and their types · India State of Forest Report · Efforts Related to Conservation of Wildlife/Forest · National Park · Biosphere Reserve · Wildlife Sanctuary · Project Tiger · Non Conventional Energy · Environmental Pollution · Air Pollution · Acid Rain · Water Pollution · Sound Pollution · Soil Pollution · Pollution : Miscellaneous · Water Conservation · Organizations and Institutions · Various Awards · Days and Dates · Environment: Miscellaneous · Nature of Indian Economy

## PART III - ECONOMIC & SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

National Income & Gross Domestic Product · Sustainable Economic Development · Agriculture and Allied Sectors · Industrial Sector · Tertiary Sector · Fiscal Policy & Revenue · Planning · Money and Banking · Human Development · Employment & Welfare Schemes · Poverty & Unemployment · International Trade · Foreign Exchange, FDI & External Debt · International Organizations · India : Population · India : Urbanization · World Population & Urbanization · Historical Scenario

## PART IV - UTTAR PRADESH SPECIAL

Political Scenario · Economic Scenario · Geographical Scenario · Climate and Forest · Population and Urbanisation · Wildlife & Bird Sanctuaries · Mineral Resources · Agriculture, Soil and Crops · Dams, Rivers and Means of Irrigation · Transportation · Cultural Activities · Industrial and Scientific Institutions · Educational and Sports Institutions · Scheduled Tribes · Plans / Projects · Languages and Dialects · Awards/Honours · U.P. Miscellaneous

# PART I - GENERAL SCIENCE

## Miscellaneous

- The 2024 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was jointly awarded to Victor Ambros and Gary Ruvkun for the “discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation.” In 2025, the Nobel Prize in this category was awarded to Mary E.
- The correct matching is as follows– Name of Scientist Field of Work Birbal Sahni – Palaeobotany K.C.
- To prepare the framework for future science and technology programmes and to give direction to new initiatives, the New Science and Technology Policy, 2003 was announced on 3 January 2003 during the 90th Indian Science Congress in Bengaluru.
- Pasteurization is a process by which milk is sterilized by destroying disease-causing microorganisms, thereby improving its shelf life.
- Dingo and Basenji are dog breeds which, instead of barking like ordinary dogs, produce a kind of howling sound.
- The objective of the ‘Red Ribbon Express’ is to travel across the country and create awareness among people about the dangers of HIV/AIDS and the ways to prevent it.
- On 25 December 2014, the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, launched the ‘Mission Indradhanush’ programme.
- Cholesterol is a sticky, waxy alcoholic substance found in cells and circulated in blood plasma.
- Trans fat is dangerous for human health because it lowers the level of “good” cholesterol, HDL (High-Density Lipoprotein), and increases the level of “harmful or bad” cholesterol, LDL (Low-Density Lipoprotein).
- Pheromones are chemicals secreted by insects.
- The correct matching is as follows– Compound present in bones – Calcium phosphate Acid present in vinegar – Acetic acid Souring of milk – Lactic acid Ripening of fruits – Ethylene Iodine is a nutritionally important substance obtained from an algae called Laminaria.
- The correct matching is as follows: Mineral oil – Petroleum Vegetable fat – Phytosterol Mustard oil – Edible oil Animal fat – Cholesterol Mustard oil is not used as a lubricant.
- * Which one of the following is a substance that is obtained abundantly from the sea and is given in a specific deficiency disease? – Iodine
- Acetic acid is found in a free state in the juices of many fruits.
- Sour milk contains lactic acid, not lactose.
- The correct matching is as follows– Skin cancer – Ultraviolet light Noise pollution – Decibel Global warming – Carbon dioxide Ozone hole – Chlorofluorocarbon
- The correct matching is as follows– Lactobacillus – Preparation of curd Rhizobium – Nitrogen fixation Yeast – Alcohol production Aspergillus – Citric acid formation
- Saccharomyces is a unicellular yeast that is used in the fermentation of toddy or ethanol (alcohol).
- It is because herbicides are absorbed at different rates by weeds and crop plants that weeds are destroyed while useful plants remain unharmed.
- AIDS is a highly fatal viral disease that has now spread throughout the world.
- World Alzheimer’s Day is observed every year on 21 September.
- B 3 3 2 3 C 4 1 4 2 D 1 4 1 4■ U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992 The correct matching is as follows– 5 June – World Environment Day 1 December – World AIDS Day 5 September – Teachers’ Day 16 October – World Food Day
- The correct matching is as follows: World Tuberculosis Day – 24 March World AIDS Day – 1 December Anti Leprosy Day – The last Sunday of January (31 January 1999 was a Sunday) International Ozone Day – 16 September
- World Health Day – 7 April National Maritime Day (India) – 5 April World Athletics Day – 7 May World Red Cross Day – 8 May Therefore, when arranged chronologically, the correct order is 2, 1, 3,
- (Events) (Date) World Heritage Day – 18 April International Day of Light – 16 May World Thyroid Day – 25 May World No Tobacco Day – 31 May Thus, 1, 4, 2, 3 is the correct order.
- The yellow colour of human urine is due to a pigment called urochrome.
- The term biomass is used for substances derived from living organisms.
- Oxidation reactions produce free radicals, which initiate chain reactions that damage cells.

- EEG: Electroencephalography – It is the process of recording the electrical activity produced on the scalp by the firing of neurons inside the brain.
- The correct matching is as follows: Audiogram – Ear ECG – Heart EEG – Brain Mammogram – Breast
- Diseases in the internal parts of the human body are identified with an instrument called an endoscope.
- The technique used for examining the stomach or other internal organs of the body, called endoscopy, is based on total internal reflection because it works through optical fibers, in which information is transmitted by internal reflection.
- 'Tetraplegia' means paralysis of both arms and both legs.
- Silk fibre, hair, feathers, nails and claws are made of keratin.
- Sunn hemp is a type of plant fibre obtained from the stem of a tropical Asian plant (Crotalaria juncea).
- Most tadpoles are mainly herbivorous and feed primarily on algae and aquatic plants.
- The semen of a bull for artificial insemination is stored in liquid nitrogen at a temperature of about –196°C.
- Holstein Friesian is a high milk-yielding breed of cow.
- Electron beam therapy is a type of external radiotherapy used in the treatment of certain types of cancer.
- Frog, snake and lizard have a three-chambered heart.
- A three-chambered heart is found in amphibians (such as frogs).
- The correct matching is as follows: Bulimia – Eating disorder Cholesterol – Egg yolk Atropine – Alkaloid Insulin – Pancreas
- Scientists at the Agarkar Research Institute, Pune, synthesized nanoparticles of the semiconductor cadmium sulphide (CdS) with the help of a yeast named 'Schizosaccharomyces pombe'.
- B 4 3 2 1 C 2 1 4 3 D 1 2 3 4 U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010 A cardiologist is a specialist in heart diseases.
- A female dog named Laika was the first animal to go into Earth's orbit in space.
- Anaesthetics are mainly used to reduce sensation.
- Phenolphthalein is generally used as an indicator in acid-base titrations.
- Angora wool is obtained from the Angora rabbit.
- Foetal growth can be measured through ultrasound technology (ultrasonics).
- 'SANRAKSHA' is associated with the AIDS research and control project in Bengaluru.
- NACO (National AIDS Control Organisation), established in 1992 as a division of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, is associated with the implementation of HIV/AIDS control programmes in India.
- On 10 November 2022, Union Minister Jitendra Singh dedicated to the nation India's first national repository for life science data.
- On 19 April 2022, in the presence of Mauritius Prime Minister Pravind Kumar Jugnauth and WHO Director-General Tedros Ghebreyesus, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone of WHO's Global Centre for Traditional Medicine (GCTM) at Jamnagar, Gujarat.
- The Indian Institute of Vegetable Research (I.I.V.R.) is situated in Varanasi.
- The correct matching is as follows– Institute Location National Centre for Organic – Ghaziabad and Natural Farming Indian Institute of Pulses Research – Kanpur Indian Institute of Vegetable Research – Varanasi Indian Institute of Sugarcane Research – Lucknow Note: In March 2022, the National Centre for Organic Farming was renamed as the National Centre for Organic and Natural Farming.
- The Indian Veterinary Research Institute is located at Izzatnagar in Bareilly district of Uttar Pradesh.
- The Central Drug Research Institute (C.D.R.I.) is located in Lucknow.
- The Central Institute of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP) is situated in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.
- The Central Electrochemical Research Institute is located in Karaikudi, Tamil Nadu.
- The High Security Animal Disease Laboratory is located in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh.
- B.S.I.P. (Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeobotany) is not an institute of C.S.I.R.
- The National Institute for the Mentally Handicapped (present name: National Institute for the Empowerment of Persons with Intellectual Disabilities) is located at Secunderabad (Hyderabad district, Telangana).
- The correct matching is as follows– Institute Place Central Drug Research Institute – Lucknow Central Leprosy Institute – Agra (National JALMA Institute of L eprosy and Other Mycobacterial Diseases) Motilal Nehru National – Allahabad Institute of Technology (now Prayagraj) Indian Institute of Sugar – Kanpur Technology (National Sugar Institute) Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.
- The Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture (CISH) is located in Lucknow.

- The Artificial Limbs Manufacturing Corporation of India is a Government of India enterprise working under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.
- The Centre for DNA Fingerprinting and Diagnostics (CDFD) is an autonomous organization funded by the Department of Biotechnology (DBT), Ministry of Science and Technology, Government of India.
- The correct matching is as follows: FAO Headquarters – Rome Central Agmark Laboratory – Nagpur Central Rice Research Institute – Cuttack Central Potato Research Institute – Shimla
- The headquarters of the International Potato Center is located in Lima, Peru.
- The National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI) is located in Lucknow.
- The National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (NBPGR) is located in New Delhi.
- ICAR's (Indian Council of Agricultural Research) Central Institute for Research on Goats is located at Makhdoom, Mathura.
- Testosterone is a steroid hormone mainly found in mammals, reptiles, birds, and other vertebrates.
- In 1991, C.D.R.I. (Central Drug Research Institute), Lucknow, developed a non-steroidal contraceptive pill called Centchroman, which is also known by names such as Centron, Saheli, and Chhaya.
- Anthrax is a serious bacterial disease. Through in vitro techniques, anthrax spores can be produced and used in biological warfare.
- Quinine is a natural white crystalline alkaloid substance having antipyretic, antimalarial, analgesic, and antiinflammatory properties.
- The country’s first dinosaurium was opened at the B.M.
- The bear seen performing tricks in streets is the sloth bear.
- Among the given options, the ant has the largest brain in proportion to its body.
- The honeybee is a social insect that is useful in detecting landmines.
- Dr. Christian Barnard was a famous surgeon from South Africa who first successfully performed the transplantation of a human heart.
- The function of a pacemaker is to regulate the heartbeat, that is, the pulsation of the heart.
- The S.A. node, or sinoatrial node, is a group of cells located in the right chamber of the heart.
- Excessive loss of fluid from the body is called dehydration.
- In fact, except for sea water, any liquid may be suitable to make up for the deficiency of water in a dehydrated person.
- Man feels discomfort in humidity and heat because the sweat released from the body does not evaporate due to humidity.
- The largest flower found in the world is Rafflesia arnoldii, a member of the genus Rafflesia.
- For seed germination, water, suitable temperature, and oxygen (O2) are most important, whereas sunlight is not necessary.
- The correct matching is as follows: Silicon carbide – Carbon fibre – Carbon dioxide – Dichloro-difluoromethane – Artificial diamond Aircraft Photosynthesis Refrigerator
- – – Specialized rubber Modified starch
- Rayon is a fiber made from regenerated cellulose.
- The pig is an omnivorous animal and cannot digest fiber efficiently, whereas the animals given in the other options, such as goat, cow, and elephant, can digest fiber much better with the help of microorganisms present in their digestive system.
- A bio-injector is a painless needle-free injector through which medicines are administered into the body without causing pain.
- Aspirin, also called acetylsalicylic acid, is a salicylate drug that is commonly used as a painkiller for relief from mild pain, as an antipyretic, and as an anti-inflammatory drug.
- During the First World War, mustard gas was used by the German army against British soldiers in 1917.
- A wax coating is a modern method of keeping fruits and vegetables safe for a longer time, though it is different from preservation.
- Clay has a high water-holding capacity because the diameter of its soil particles is small.
- Eutrophication is the process by which the concentration of nutrients in a water body increases.
- Biodegradable substances are those waste materials that decompose and get assimilated into nature through biological processes.
- An auxanometer is used to measure the rate of growth in plants.

- The age of a tree is determined by counting the annual rings or growth rings present in it, which are found in the stems of plants in the form of rings.
- Cellulose is the most abundant organic substance found in nature.
- Fructose is also called fruit sugar. This type of sugar is mainly found in fruits, which is why fruits taste sweet.
- Lac is obtained from the lac insect. It is secreted by the crimson-coloured female insect and is used in making varnish, polish, shellac, sealing wax, etc.
- In nature, many marine organisms and insects produce light on their own.
- The Green Revolution is related to crop production.
- Nitrous oxide, methane, and carbon dioxide are released from paddy fields.
- The ‘Dapog’ method of raising rice seedlings was developed in the Philippines.
- 2, 4-D (2, 4-Dichlorophenoxyacetic Acid) is an auxin, a plant hormone, that is used as a herbicide (weedicide) in crops.
- A herbicide is a type of chemical used in agriculture to destroy weeds.
- Gambusia is a species of freshwater fish.
- According to J. V. Narlikar, astrology has not yet been regarded as science.
- Scientific inquiry depends on commitment to practical ideals such as truthfulness and on the responsibility to communicate results.

## Environment and Sustainable Development

- The collective group of land, water, air, plants, and living beings found on the Earth and surrounding us is called the environment.
- According to the report 'Our Common Future' published in 1987 by the World Commission on Environment and Development (WCED), also known as the 'Brundtland Report', sustainable development means development that meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.
- Assertion (A) is in accordance with the accepted definition of sustainable development.
- For sustainable development, conservation of biodiversity, prevention and control of pollution, and reduction of poverty are all essential.
- Event Year Publication of 'The Limits to Growth' Report – 1972 The carrying capacity of the environment refers to the limit Publication of the Brundtland Commission – 1987 of the maximum population or activity that an ecosystem/ Report environment can sustain continuously without long-term Coming into force of the Montreal Protocol – 1989 degradation, on the basis of available resources and its Rio Earth Summit – 1992 capacity to assimilate waste/pollution.
- 'The Population Bomb' is a well-known book on environment and population, published in 1968.
- “Sustainable development” is the concept of development under which, along with the needs of the present, the needs of the future are also taken into account.
- 818 9. development, mainly two rules are recognized – (i) in the case of renewable resources, the rate of use/extraction should be less than or equal to their rate of regeneration; and (ii) the generation of waste/pollutants should remain within the absorptive/assimilative capacity of the environment.
- The damage caused to the environment due to the destruction of natural habitats, loss of biodiversity, or depletion of natural resources is called environmental degradation.
- Sustainable development and the use of paper bags are related to the positive aspect of environmental protection.
- Sustainable agriculture means using land in such a way that its quality remains intact for a long time while preserving the environment.
- Natural vegetation is a true indicator of climate, and changes in climate caused by the increasing amount of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere also bring changes in natural vegetation.
- Forest Policy and the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 are directly related to the preservation of environmental balance, while environmental concerns have also been incorporated into Industrial Policy and Education Policy.
- The ‘ECOMARK’ label is given to Indian products that are eco-friendly and safe for the environment.
- Silent Spring is a book related to environmental science, and its author is the American biologist and conservationist Rachel Carson.
- Excessive urbanization and industrialization are harmful to balanced development, environment and ecology, as well as the conservation of biodiversity.
- The author of ‘Green Development’ is W.M.

- In the detailed discussion on the negative aspects of development in the mid-1980s, the main issues included depletion of natural resources, environmental pollution, and displacement and rehabilitation of the common people, but ‘politics and development’ was not among the major themes of discussion.
- Plachimada is a small village located in Palakkad district of the southern Indian state of Kerala.
- ‘Greenwash’ refers to a situation in which an organization seeks to mislead people about its environmental practices or about the environmental benefits of a product or service.

# PART II - ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

## Ecology

- Ecology is a branch of biology in which the interrelationships between living communities and their environment are studied.
- An ecosystem is a functional natural resource system consisting of both abiotic and biotic components, and it has its own productivity.
- The biosphere is a thin layer made up of soil, rocks, water, and air, spread around the Earth as the largest ecosystem, with which living organisms are associated, and it sustains life.
- The correct sequence of biological organization from organism to biosphere is – Population → Community → Ecosystem → Landscape It should be noted that the number of individuals of the same species is called a population.
- The term “Ecosystem” was first used by A.G.
- In an ecosystem, energy is lost at each successive trophic level.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021 The various components of an ecosystem depend on one another.
- The ocean is the largest ecosystem in the world.
- The marine (ocean) ecosystem is the most stable ecosystem.
- Forest, lake, and grassland are natural ecosystems, whereas a paddy field is an artificial ecosystem created by humans.
- Cutting forests does not help in maintaining ecological balance; rather, it disturbs it.
- Water management, afforestation, and wildlife protection positively affect ecological balance.
- In an ecosystem, the pattern of conversion of abiotic elements into biotic components and the return of these biotic components into abiotic form is called the biogeochemical cycle.
- American biologist Eugene Odum described ecological succession as a gradual sequence.
- Migration is the process in which organisms move from one place to another.
- The concept of ‘ecological transition’ was first used by John W.
- Both the above statements are correct. Each species has a distinct niche, and every species is adapted to its environment.
- In the ecological niche of a natural ecosystem, if resources are sufficient, the number of species does not decrease; rather, it increases.
- The entire sequence of communities that successively change at a particular place is called 'Sere'.

## Food Chain in Ecosystem

- A food chain is a sequence of different types of organisms through which energy flows in an ecosystem.
- The correct sequence of different components in the food chain is as follows – Grass → Grasshopper → Frog → Snake ↓ ↓ ↓ ↓ (Producer) (Primary Consumer) (Secondary Consumer) (Tertiary Consumer)
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) In a food chain, mainly herbivorous animals are included in the category of primary consumers.
- When human beings eat vegetables, they are primary consumers, whereas when they eat meat, they fall in the category of secondary consumers.
- In the marine food chain, phytoplankton are the main primary producers.
- Among the biotic components, green plants come under the category of producers.
- All those plants that produce food through photosynthesis are called producers.
- In an ecosystem, the biotic components are divided into two major parts – (1) autotrophic components and (2) heterotrophic components.
- A lotic ecosystem refers to any kind of moving or flowing water, such as a river, spring, channel, stream or waterfall.
- Phytoplankton are microscopic organisms found in aquatic environments.
- Green plants – ecosystem is the correctly matched pair.

## Flow of Energy

- The primary source or driving force of energy in an ecosystem is solar energy.
- In the biospheric ecosystem, the flow of energy is unidirectional.
- In an ecosystem, energy flows from the abiotic system to the biotic system.
- *UPPSC Question Papers U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2023 General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Rule / Concept Scientist Ten Percent Raymond L.
- Green plants capture about 1 percent of the sunlight falling on their leaves in a terrestrial ecosystem.
- Due to high temperature and high rainfall throughout the year in the equatorial region, tropical evergreen vegetation is found here.
- From the viewpoint of biomass production, tropical rain forests rank first.
- The diagrammatic representation of the biomass present per unit area at different levels of an ecosystem is called the pyramid of biomass.

## Ecosystem: Miscellaneous

- *UPPSC Question Papers 825 The word Bionomics is formed from the words 'Bio' and 'nomics'.
- The quantity of ecological resources required for a human being to maintain his or her lifestyle properly is called the ecological footprint.
- The unit of measurement of ecological footprint is the global hectare.
- Eucalyptus has been declared an environmental hazard because of its excessive water uptake capacity.
- The transitional zone between two different communities is called an ‘ecotone’.
- Arne Naess first used the term ‘Deep Ecology’ in 1973.
- The Chipko Movement was an important movement carried out to prevent the felling of trees.

## Biodiversity

- The presence of different species in an environment is known as biodiversity.
- Biodiversity is defined as the diversity of different living organisms (plants and animals) present in an ecosystem.
- The term biodiversity was first used by Walter G.
- The most important aspect of biodiversity is the maintenance of the ecosystem.
- In December 2010, through Resolution No.
- Among the given options, maximum biodiversity is found in tropical rain forests.
- Generally, species diversity decreases as one moves from the equator towards the poles.
- Among the given options, the greatest biodiversity is found in Silent Valley, situated in Palakkad district of Kerala.
- The Valley of Flowers is located in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand.
- The term ‘hotspot’ was first used by Norman Myers in 1988.
- Among the given options, the Western Ghats is the richest region in terms of biodiversity.

## Causes of Biodiversity Loss and Conservation

- The major causes of biodiversity loss are the destruction of natural habitats, overexploitation of natural resources, invasion by exotic species, reduction in forest area or density, industrialization, unscientific mining, illegal hunting, and illegal trafficking, etc.
- Although all the four factors mentioned above affect biodiversity, the greatest threat to biodiversity arises from the destruction of natural habitats and vegetation.
- Natural habitats are being destroyed in order to exploit natural resources and to promote industrial production and urbanization, and this is the most important factor causing biodiversity loss.
- Among the given options, ‘destruction of natural habitat’ is the most important factor causing biodiversity loss.
- India’s population is increasing continuously, but the decline in the number of birds is due to the large-scale destruction of their habitats and the excessive use of insecticides, chemical fertilizers, and mosquito repellents.
- Butterflies are poikilothermic organisms; therefore, regions with warm climates are considered the most suitable for them.
- A decrease in the number of trophic levels leads to an increase in the number of organisms of a particular class, whereas biodiversity declines.
- Biosphere reserves are an important strategy for the conservation of biodiversity.

- Conservation of organisms in their natural habitat is called in situ conservation.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Ex situ conservation is a process by which endangered species of plants and animals are conserved away from their natural habitats.
- Biosphere reserves are protected areas meant for the conservation of genetic diversity.
- Coral bleaching occurs due to environmental stress such as an increase in sea temperature and ocean acidity, especially as a result of global warming.

## Endangered Species

- The listing of species facing extinction is done in the Red List or Red Data Book of the IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature).
- *UPPSC Question Papers 829 Among the Indian birds mentioned in the question, the Great Indian Bustard has been listed in the Critically Endangered category in the IUCN Red List.
- World Wetlands Day is observed every year on 2 February to commemorate the International Convention on Wetlands, which was signed on this day in 1971 at Ramsar, Iran.
- According to the given explanation, a species is considered extinct when it has not been seen in its natural habitat for 50 years.
- Diclofenac sodium is a common painkiller used by farmers for animals as a pain-relieving medicine and also for treating fever.

## Ramsar Convention

- The Ramsar Convention is related to the conservation of wetlands.
- The transitional land between terrestrial and aquatic ecosystems, where water is usually at or near the surface or the land is covered by shallow water, is called a wetland.
- Wetlands are areas lying between aquatic and dry terrestrial ecosystems.

## Biodiversity : Miscellaneous

- The Government of India, in collaboration with the Government of Norway, has established the Centre for Biodiversity Policy and Law (CEBPOL) at the National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) in Chennai, Tamil Nadu.
- The Tenth Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD COP-10) was held in Nagoya, Japan, in 2010.
- Among the given options, a broad niche is not responsible for the extinction of a species.
- Sea buckthorn is a tree found in the hilly regions of Ladakh.
- The biosphere is the largest ecosystem on Earth.
- The Biological Diversity Act was passed by the Indian Parliament in December, 2002.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology)
- The book 'Tomorrow’s Biodiversity' was written by Vandana Shiva, who is an active environmental activist and writer.

## Greenhouse Effect and Climate Change

- Joseph Fourier proposed the concept of greenhouse gases in 1824.
- Greenhouse gases are those gases present in the atmosphere that absorb and emit radiation within the thermal infrared range.
- According to the World Meteorological Organization (WMO), among the major long-lived greenhouse gases, carbon dioxide and methane have the highest relative contribution to the greenhouse effect or global warming.
- After being heated by the Sun, when the Earth begins to cool, heat is radiated outward from the Earth.
- Oxides of sulphur and nitrogen (except nitrous oxide) do not directly contribute to global warming.
- Among the given options, nitrogen oxides (NOx) are not greenhouse gases naturally found in the atmosphere.
- Among the gases given in the question, propane is not treated as a greenhouse gas.
- Among the gases given in the question, nitrogen is not a greenhouse gas.
- Hydrogen is not a greenhouse gas. In nature, it is found in diatomic form.

- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Greenhouse gases and pollution are directly responsible for climate change, while depletion of the ozone layer is considered an indirect factor.
- Ozone is both harmful and beneficial for life on Earth.
- In the Earth's carbon cycle, respiration, decomposition of organic matter, and volcanic activity increase the amount of carbon dioxide, whereas in the process of photosynthesis, autotrophic plants absorb carbon dioxide from the atmosphere and release oxygen.
- There are two major factors responsible for climate change – factors that increase carbon emissions and factors that reduce carbon absorption.
- Global warming is mainly caused by the emission of carbon dioxide (CO2), which increases its concentration in the atmosphere.
- Paddy fields, coal mines, and domestic animals are humanrelated sources of methane emission into the atmosphere, whereas wetlands, termite mounds, oceans, hydrates, etc.
- The effect of global warming can be seen in the rapidly melting ice in glacial regions.
- Global warming is a serious challenge to life on earth.
- An increase in sea-water temperature causes stress to corals, which leads to loss of their colour (bleaching) and death.
- Since 1900, the average temperature of the earth has increased by about 1°C (1.8°F), and most of this increase has been observed after 1975.
- In the absence of the greenhouse effect, the average temperature of the earth's surface would be 0°F or about –18°C.
- Urban Heat Island is the condition in which the average surface or atmospheric temperature of a city is significantly higher than that of the nearby rural area.
- China is the largest contributor to carbon dioxide (CO2) emissions.
- Bhutan is regarded as a carbon-negative country.
- The IPCC emphasizes reducing greenhouse gas emissions so that global temperature rise can be limited to 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels.
- 'Net-zero' means a balance between the amount of greenhouse gases emitted and the amount removed from the atmosphere.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 835 Climate change is increasing pressure on resources.
- Milutin Milankovitch proposed theories related to climate change that are associated with the Earth's long-term orbital variations.
- A change in the Earth's position with reference to the Sun is also responsible for variation in the amount of solar radiation reaching the Earth.
- An ice core is a cylindrical sample obtained by drilling into a glacier or an ice sheet.

## Climate Change Conference

- 'Agenda 21' is a non-binding voluntary action plan of the United Nations in the context of sustainable development.
- The 'United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change' (UNFCCC), supported by more than 50 countries, came into force on 21 March 1994.
- In 2015, the 21st United Nations Climate Change Conference (COP21) was held in Paris.
- The 'Green Climate Fund' (GCF) was envisaged at the 16th United Nations Climate Change Conference (COP16) held in Cancun, Mexico, in 2010.
- Only the developed countries are donors to it.
- The Global Environment Facility (GEF) was established in 1991 as a pilot programme.
- C.D.M. (Clean Development Mechanism) is a mechanism for controlling greenhouse gas emissions to reduce global warming, and it emerged under the Kyoto Protocol.
- The Kyoto Protocol is an international agreement linked to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC).

## Climate Change : Miscellaneous

- *UPPSC Question Papers 837 The Great Barrier Reef is the world's largest coral reef.

- The Deep Carbon Observatory (DCO) is a global group of more than 1000 scientists working on a 10-year mission to understand the quantity, movement, forms, and origin of carbon on Earth.
- Scientists at the University of Manchester suggested producing bright clouds by spraying droplets of sea water into the atmosphere above the Pacific Ocean, so that more sunlight could be reflected and global warming could be controlled.
- India's first National Action Plan on Climate Change was launched on 30 June 2008.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2025 Ozone (O■) is mainly found in the stratosphere (about 10–50 km altitude, with maximum concentration at about 15–35 km), and it absorbs the harmful ultraviolet radiation of the Sun, especially UV-B and UV-C.
- Under India's National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC), eight national missions are included.
- At the time of the question, Global Atmosphere Watch Stations had been established in Algeria, Brazil, and Kenya, whereas no such station had yet been established in India.
- In May 2011, the Emission Reduction Purchase Agreement was signed between Himachal Pradesh and the World Bank.
- Carbon trading is related to the Kyoto Protocol, not to the Montreal Protocol.
- On 21 July 2018, the then Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Dr.

## Ozone Layer

- Ozone in the stratosphere is formed mainly due to ultraviolet radiation.
- Ozone (O3) is a gas made up of three oxygen atoms and is found in very small quantities in the atmosphere.
- The ozone layer is mainly located in the lower part of the stratosphere, at an altitude of about 10 to 50 km above the Earth's surface.
- The level of ozone in the stratosphere is naturally regulated by nitrogen dioxide.
- Water vapour and carbon dioxide are two major greenhouse gases.
- Chlorofluorocarbon is a man-made gaseous and liquid substance composed of chlorine, fluorine and carbon.
- The ozone layer present in the atmosphere blocks the harmful ultraviolet rays coming from the Sun.
- Chlorofluorocarbons, halons and carbon tetrachloride are all ozone-depleting substances.
- Greenhouse gases responsible for ozone pollution in the troposphere are water vapour, carbon dioxide, methane, ozone, nitrous oxide and chlorofluorocarbons.
- In 2005, researchers led by G.W. Kent Moore of the University of Toronto discovered the ozone halo above the Tibetan Plateau.
- In 1994, the United Nations General Assembly declared that 16 September would be observed every year as the International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer.
- Harmful ultraviolet radiation from the Sun can cause skin cancer.
- The ozone layer absorbs 93–99 percent of the highfrequency ultraviolet light from the Sun, which is harmful to life on Earth.
- The British team was the first to detect the ozone hole over Antarctica in 1985.

## Forest and their types

- The tropical evergreen forest biome has the greatest number of plant species.
- Tropical rain forest – This biome lies near the Equator and extends between 10° North and 10° South latitudes.
- Net primary productivity is the rate at which an ecosystem/ biome accumulates energy, excluding the energy used in respiration.
- Tropical evergreen forests are found in the Western Ghats (Sahyadri), North-East India, and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands in areas receiving more than 200 cm of average annual rainfall.
- Tidal forests are found in delta regions and in areas affected by sea tides; these are also known as mangrove vegetation.
- Among the given options, Chorao Island in Goa is a completely protected mangrove area.
- Tropical deciduous forests are also called monsoon forests.
- Among the given options, the Eastern Deccan Plateau is predominantly characterised by dry evergreen forests, not moist forests.

- The correct matching is as follows – Tropical forest – Silent Valley Coniferous forest – Himachal Pradesh Mangrove vegetation – Sundarban Deciduous forest – Rajasthan
- The Odisha coast is the region most affected by cyclones originating in the Bay of Bengal.
- The Bhitarkanika mangroves are located in Kendrapara district of Odisha in the delta region of the Brahmani, Baitarani, and Mahanadi rivers.
- Renewable resources are those which, after use, can be renewed and used again.
- Forests, because of their canopy, act like water engineers.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) On the basis of stages of development, natural resources can be classified into the following groups – (i) Potential Resources, (ii) Actual Resources, and (iii) Reserve Resources.
- Aluminium is called a green metal because of its environment-friendly nature and recyclability.
- The decline in forest area in India has been directly related to demographic transition in India, because increasing population puts greater pressure on forest land.
- The main cause of forest degradation is industrial development, under which forests are cut for the establishment and expansion of urban areas, timber is exploited, and the cleared land is then used for agriculture.

## India State of Forest Report

- The Forest Survey of India, located in Dehradun, releases the India State of Forest Report (ISFR) every two years through satellite imagery.
- According to the India State of Forest Report (ISFR), 2015, the total forest cover and tree cover in the country was 79.42 million hectares (794,245 sq.
- India's dense forests are divided into very dense forests and moderately dense forests.
- According to ISFR 2023, the top 5 states/Union Territories in terms of the highest percentage of geographical area under forest cover are as follows: Lakshadweep (91.33%), Mizoram (85.34%), Andaman and Nicobar Islands (81.62%), Arunachal Pradesh (78.67%) and Meghalaya (75.65%).
- According to the 'India State of Forest Report 2021', more than 33 percent of the geographical area of 17 States/Union Territories in the country was under forest cover.
- According to ISFR 2023, the top 5 states with the largest forest-covered area in the country are as follows:
- According to ISFR 2021, option (b) was the correct answer.
- At the time of the question as well as at present, Arunachal Pradesh has the largest area of very dense forests.
- According to the 'India State of Forest Report 2017', among the 14 physiographic regions of the country, the largest tree cover in terms of area is found in the Central Highlands (11,534 sq km), followed by Eastern Deccan (10,663 sq km), Western Coast (9,445 sq km), Western Himalaya (9,393 sq km), and Northern Plains (9,196 sq km).
- According to the 'India State of Forest Report (ISFR) 2023', the total recorded forest area of Uttar Pradesh is 17,435 sq km, which is 7.24 percent of its geographical area.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 845 According to the India State of Forest Report (ISFR), 2023, the descending order of the given states in terms of percentage of forest cover is as follows: Manipur (74.29%), Odisha (33.67%), Maharashtra (16.53%), Haryana (3.65%).

## Efforts Related to Conservation of Wildlife/Forest

- According to the National Forest Policy, 1988, at least one-third, that is, about 33 percent of the total area of the country, should be under forest cover in order to maintain ecological balance.
- According to the National Forest Policy (1952), forests were classified as follows– (i) Protected Forests, (ii) National Forests, (iii) Village Forests, and (iv) Tree-lands.
- Ensuring ecological balance and promoting community participation in forest management are among the main objectives of the National Forest Policy, 1988, whereas promoting social forestry and bringing two-thirds of the country's total land under forest cover are included among the strategies under this policy.
- MISHTI (Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes) was announced in the Union Budget 2023–24 and was formally launched on 5 June 2023.
- The 'Apna Van Apna Dhan' scheme was started by the state of Himachal Pradesh.
- Valparai town is located in Coimbatore district of Tamil Nadu.
- For the protection and conservation of wildlife from smuggling and illegal hunting, the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 was enacted in India.

- Events Year Wildlife (Protection) Act – 1972 Project Tiger – 1973 Project Elephant – 1992 Biological Diversity Act – 2002 Therefore, the correct chronological order is: I, III, IV, II.
- The Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 provides a legal framework for the protection of any captive or wild animal, other than vermin, and not only wild animals; therefore, statement 1 is incorrect.
- Under the new National Forest Inventory Design implemented in 2016, the forest inventory review period was reduced from 20 years to 5 years.
- In India, the Forest (Conservation) Act, 1980 was enacted by Parliament on 27 December 1980, although it was made effective from 25 October 1980.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 847 The Forest Research Institute was established in 1906 in Dehradun district of Uttarakhand.
- The Rajiv Gandhi Wildlife Conservation Award is presented by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to educational and research institutions, forest and wildlife officers, and wildlife conservationists for distinguished work in the field of wildlife conservation.
- The National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (NBPGR) was established in 1977 in New Delhi as a nodal agency at the national level for the management of plant genetic resources.
- Operation ‘Olivia’ is an annual initiative of the Indian Coast Guard aimed at ensuring a safe breeding ground for Olive Ridley turtles along the Odisha coast, especially in 848 Gahirmatha and nearby coastal areas.
- A new organization called ‘SAVE’ has been started as a wildlife conservation effort in Nepal and India, with the main objective of conserving vultures.
- Destruction of natural habitat, forest fires, and illegal commercial trade in wild animals are major causes of the extinction of wild animals, whereas rapid population growth is not treated here as a major direct cause of extinction; rather, it increases competition for habitat and food.
- The pugmark technique is used for estimating the number of different wild animals.
- Since its establishment in 1961, the World Wildlife Fund (W.W.F.) has adopted the Giant Panda as its emblem.
- The World Wildlife Fund was established in April 1961.
- Among the given options, Suriname has the highest percentage of its total geographical area under forest cover.
- Among the given countries, Japan has the highest percentage of its geographical area under forest cover.

## National Park

- India’s first national park was established in 1936 as Hailey National Park.
- Corbett National Park receives its water from the Ramganga River.
- Nagarhole National Park, located in Karnataka, is also known as Rajiv Gandhi National Park.
- Keibul Lamjao National Park is located in Bishnupur district of Manipur.
- Keoladeo Ghana National Park, earlier known as Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary, is located in Bharatpur, Rajasthan.
- Genetic diversity is maintained in national parks through in-situ conservation.
- At present (as of April 2025), there are a total of 107 national parks in India.
- Dachigam National Park was established in 1981.
- Rhinoceros rehabilitation work is being carried out in Dudhwa National Park.
- Indravati National Park is located in Dantewada district in the Bastar region of Chhattisgarh.
- Great Himalayan National Park is located in the Kullu region of Himachal Pradesh; Rajaji National Park is spread across Dehradun, Haridwar, and Pauri Garhwal districts of Uttarakhand; Keoladeo National Park is located in Bharatpur district of Rajasthan; and Van Vihar National Park is located in Bhopal district of Madhya Pradesh.
- The Gulf of Mannar is a marine national park.
- In July 2016, at the 40th meeting of the World Heritage Committee held in Istanbul, Turkey, Nalanda Mahavihara located in Nalanda, Bihar, the historic Capitol Complex of Chandigarh, and Khangchendzonga National Park were declared World Heritage Sites.
- The Delhi Zoo was given the status of National Zoological Park in 1982.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Similipal National Park is located in the state of Odisha.
- Pin Valley National Park is located in Himachal Pradesh, not in Jammu and Kashmir.
- Similipal National Park was established in 1980.
- The correct matching of the given national parks with their states is as follows – *UPPSC Question Papers 851 National Park Bandhavgarh National Park Bandipur National Park Rohla National Park Gir National Park State Madhya Pradesh Karnataka Himachal Pradesh Gujarat

- Keoladeo National Park, located in Bharatpur district of Rajasthan, is the winter migratory habitat of the Siberian crane.
- National Park State/Union Territory Dachigam Jammu and Kashmir Papikonda Andhra Pradesh Sariska Rajasthan Bandipur Karnataka
- Bandipur National Park is located not in Tamil Nadu but in Karnataka.
- National Park Year of Establishment Jim Corbett 1936 Kanha 1955 Kaziranga 1974 Silent Valley 1984
- The matching of the given states and their respective national parks is as follows – State National Park Assam Kaziranga Gujarat Gir Madhya Pradesh Kanha Uttarakhand Corbett
- National Park Anshi National Park Betla National Park Indravati National Park Gugamal National Park State Karnataka Jharkhand Chhattisgarh Maharashtra
- The correct matching is as follows: National Park State Intanki Nagaland Betla Jharkhand Shiroi Manipur Guindy Tamil Nadu
- The correct matching of the sanctuaries/national parks and their main protected animals is as follows– Sanctuary/National Park Main Protected Animal Kaziranga Rhinoceros Gir Lion Sundarban Tiger Periyar Elephant
- The main protected animals in Periyar National Park are the tiger and the elephant.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 853 Dhupgarh Peak is the highest point of the Satpura Range in Madhya Pradesh.
- The Nilgiri tahr (Cloud Goats) is found in Eravikulam National Park (Kerala).
- Rani Jhansi Marine National Park was established in 1996.
- India's Oceanic National Park is located in the Gulf of Kutch.
- The Garden of Five Seasons is located near Mehrauli in New Delhi.
- Yellowstone National Park is the first national park in the United States of America.
- National parks in Bhutan cover 12,922 sq km, which is about 33.65 percent of the country's total geographical area of 38,394 sq km.

## Biosphere Reserve

- A biosphere reserve is a protected area related to genetic diversity.
- - A.G. Tansley Reiter U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013 The term "Biosphere" was first used by Edward Suess.
- So far, the Government of India has established a total of 18 Biosphere Reserves, out of which the following 13 have been included by UNESCO in the World Network of Biosphere Reserves under the MAB (Man and the Biosphere) Programme –
- Among the given options, the Gulf of Mannar is the largest UNESCO-recognized biosphere reserve in India in terms of area (10,500 sq.
- Among the given options, Nanda Devi was included in UNESCO's World Heritage List in 1988, and in 2005 the World Heritage Site was extended to include the Valley of Flowers.
- The Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve was established in 1986, Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve in 1988, Sundarban Biosphere Reserve in 1989, and Khangchendzonga Biosphere Reserve in 2000.
- The matching of major biosphere reserves and their locations is as follows – Biosphere Reserve Location Nokrek Meghalaya Manas Assam Dihang-Dibang Arunachal Pradesh Agasthyamalai Kerala and Tamil Nadu Similipal Odisha Khangchendzonga Sikkim Cold Desert Himachal Pradesh Pachmarhi Madhya Pradesh Nanda Devi Uttarakhand *UPPSC Question Papers 855
- See the explanation of the above question.
- Nokrek Biosphere Reserve is spread over the Garo Hills in Meghalaya, whereas Agasthyamalai is located in the Western Ghats in Kerala and Tamil Nadu, Dihang-Dibang is situated in Upper Siang, West Siang and Dibang Valley in Arunachal Pradesh, and Nanda Devi is located in Uttarakhand.
- The Cold Desert, located in Himachal Pradesh, was declared the 16th Biosphere Reserve of India on 28 August 2009.

## Wildlife Sanctuary

- Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary is located in Kerala.
- Chinnar Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the state of Kerala.
- The Wild Ass Sanctuary is located in the Rann of Kachchh in the state of Gujarat.

- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from codes given below the lists : List-I List-II (Wild Life Sanctuary) (State) A.
- Namdapha, Bandipur, Periyar and Lamjao Sanctuaries are located in Arunachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala and Manipur respectively.
- The correct matching is as follows – National Park / State/Union Territories Wildlife Sanctuary Dachigam Jammu and Kashmir Keoladeo Ghana Rajasthan Kanha Madhya Pradesh Periyar Kerala
- Similipal National Park is not located in Madhya Pradesh, but in Odisha.
- The bird sanctuary of Tamil Nadu is located at Vedanthangal and Karikili.
- National Chambal Sanctuary, also known as the National Chambal Gharial Wildlife Sanctuary, is an extensive protected area in northern India for the critically endangered gharial, red-crowned turtles, and the endangered Ganges river dolphin.
- The Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, England, were established in 1759.
- Shuklaphanta Wildlife Sanctuary is located in the Terai region of Nepal.

## Project Tiger

- International Tiger Day is observed every year on 29 July to spread awareness about the status of tigers worldwide.
- In view of the problem of the tiger species becoming endangered, the Central Government launched ‘Project Tiger’ in April 1973 for tiger conservation.
- Bandipur Tiger Reserve is located in Karnataka, Manas Tiger Reserve in Assam, Namdapha Tiger Reserve in Arunachal Pradesh, and Similipal Tiger Reserve in Odisha.
- Dampa Tiger Reserve is located in Mizoram.
- List-I List-II (Tiger Reserve) (State) Buxa Tiger Reserve is not in Bihar, but in West Bengal.
- Pench Tiger Reserve extends over Madhya Pradesh (90%) The Tiger Reserves and their respective states are as follows– and Maharashtra (10%), whereas Kanha lies only in Tiger Reserve State Madhya Pradesh, Manas only in Assam, and Sariska only Bandipur Karnataka in Rajasthan.
- (Tiger Reserve) (State) A. Bandipur B. Manas C.
- Amangarh Tiger Reserve, a buffer area of Corbett Tiger Reserve, is located in Bijnor district of Uttar Pradesh.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 859 Sariska Tiger Reserve is located in Alwar district of Rajasthan.
- In 2015, Rajaji National Park in Uttarakhand was granted the status of a Tiger Reserve.
- According to the detailed report of the Fourth All India Tiger Estimation, 2018, released in July 2020, 70 percent of the world’s tigers were found in India, and about 30 percent of India’s tigers were found outside tiger reserves.
- At the time of the question, Bandipur Tiger Reserve in Karnataka had started using unmanned aerial vehicles (drones) for wildlife management.
- The first World Tiger Summit was held in St.

## Non Conventional Energy

- Solar radiation plays the most important role in the water cycle.
- The remains of plants that stayed buried under the earth for thousands of years, that is, plant fossils, which are used as fuel, are called fossil fuels.
- At present, after fossil fuels, the second most important source for meeting India’s energy needs is solar energy.
- Renewable energy is that form of energy which is neither polluting nor adversely affects natural resources.
- The International Solar Alliance (ISA) is the first treatybased intergovernmental organization headquartered in India, and at present the number of its member parties is
- Compared with coal, petroleum, natural gas and nuclear energy, hydroelectric power is the best source of electricity generation from the viewpoint of sustainable development.
- A solar cell obtains energy from the Sun or from any other source of light through the photovoltaic effect.
- Solar energy is a form of energy that does not create the problem of environmental pollution.
- Among the given options, wood, coal and cow dung are sources of biomass energy, whereas nuclear energy is not a source of biomass energy.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Among renewable energy sources in India, solar power has the highest potential.

- The world's first fully solar-powered international airport, Cochin International Airport, is located at Kochi in Kerala.
- In 2018, Diu became the first Union Territory of India to run entirely on solar energy.
- Biofuel is not as cost-effective as fossil fuels (diesel, petrol, coal, etc.).
- Jatropha is a biodiesel crop. It is a species of flowering plant that is resistant to drought and destructive pests.
- When hydrogen burns in air, it combines with oxygen to form water, and in this process a large amount of energy (about 150 kilojoules per gram) is released.
- Sikkim (India) is the world's first 100 percent organic state.
- While establishing nuclear power plants, it is necessary to take into account the leakage of radioactive rays and radioactive elements.
- The energy obtained from hot water found in the Earth's crust and used by humans for various purposes is called geothermal energy.
- Minerals are exhaustible over time, solar energy is derived from the sun and is inexhaustible, the main constituents of biogas are methane and carbon dioxide, and deforestation leads to a decrease in rainfall.

## Environmental Pollution

- Pollution produced by humans is placed in the category of anthropogenic pollution.
- Generally, the human impact on nature is called anthropogenic.
- Those pollutants which are broken down over time by microorganisms such as bacteria into simple and harmless substances in nature are called biodegradable pollutants.
- Those substances which get decomposed through biological processes are called biodegradable.

## Air Pollution

- The burning of coal, petrol, diesel, etc.
- Peroxyacetyl Nitrate (PAN) is a secondary pollutant present in photochemical smog, which causes irritation and burning in the eyes.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 863 Those air pollutants which directly enter the air from the source of pollution are called primary pollutants, such as CO, CO2, SO2, etc.
- Photochemical smog is formed when smoke and fog combine in the presence of sunlight.
- Carbon monoxide (CO) is a major primary air pollutant, which is colourless and highly toxic.
- Carbon monoxide (CO) is a highly harmful air pollutant.
- 'Fly ash' is a pollutant produced by the combustion of coal.
- Lichens are sensitive to atmospheric pollution, especially sulphur dioxide; therefore, they are widely used as reliable bio-indicators of air quality.
- Among the given options, sulphur dioxide is an air pollutant.
- At the time of the question, Ankleshwar was the most polluted city in India.
- In January 2020, Greenpeace India released the Airpocalypse Report.
- The atmosphere is cleaned by rain and dew, which remove smoke, dust, and gaseous waste materials from it.
- In Delhi, the level of air pollution rises considerably during the winter season because cold air is heavier and therefore General Studies (Environment & Ecology) does not rise much higher.
- Cigarette smoke is a complex mixture of chemicals.
- Cyclone divider is not a mechanical method of controlling air pollution.
- The objective of the Bio-Decomposer and Spray Programme launched by the Delhi Government is to eliminate pollution caused by stubble burning and to provide farmers with biodecomposer spray free of cost for converting stubble into manure.
- In January 2019, the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) was launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.
- Issues Description Full Name – Portal for Regulation of Air Pollution in Non-Attainment Cities (PRANA) Objective – To track online the physical and financial progress of the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) in selected cities and to monitor in real time various action plans and air-quality indicators.

## Acid Rain

- Acid rain occurs when gases like CO2, SO2 and NO2 combine with water vapour in the atmosphere and are converted into acids (namely carbonic acid, sulfuric acid and nitric acid, respectively).
- When the amount of acids in rainwater increases, it is known as acid rain.
- Among the countries mentioned in the question, Canada and Norway are the most severely affected by acid rain.
- Among the given options, Norway is the country most affected by acid rain.

## Water Pollution

- Among the given options, arsenic is an inorganic pollutant that contaminates groundwater.
- Among the given options, arsenic pollution in drinking water is highest in Kolkata.
- The groundwater of the Ganga-Brahmaputra plains in India and the Padma-Meghna plains in Bangladesh is severely affected by arsenic pollution.
- According to a fact sheet issued by the World Health Organization (WHO) in February 2018, naturally arseniccontaminated water is found in Argentina, Bangladesh, Chile, China, India, Mexico, and the United States of America.
- The leather industry causes the maximum chemical pollution through industrial waste.
- An excess of nutrients in water also affects living organisms.
- BOD (Biological Oxygen Demand) is the main unit for measuring water pollution.
- The highest concentration of BOD in the Ganga River is found between Kanpur and Allahabad (now Prayagraj).
- The Damodar River originates from Khamar Pat in Jharkhand and joins the Hooghly.
- “Knock-knee syndrome” is caused by fluoride pollution.
- At present, according to the data available from the CPCB (Central Pollution Control Board), Mumbai is the metropolitan city generating the highest annual per capita solid waste, while Delhi ranks second in this regard.
- On 31 December 2024, Union Jal Shakti Minister C.R.

## Sound Pollution

- High-intensity sound or unwanted noise that creates disturbance in our environment is called noise pollution.
- Among the given options, jet aircraft causes the maximum noise pollution.
- Under normal conditions, the rustling of tree leaves produces a sound of about 20 decibels (dB).
- Unplanned industrial development, excessive use of motor vehicles, and the operation of various mechanically defective vehicles contribute significantly to noise pollution.

## Soil Pollution

- Excessive use of fertilizers causes various kinds of pollution, of which soil pollution, water pollution, and air pollution are the major ones.
- Fertilizers, pesticides, insecticides, and herbicides destroy the natural, physical, chemical, and biological properties of the soil and make it unproductive.
- Sowing different crops on the same piece of land in a planned sequence over a fixed period in such a way that soil fertility is maintained and higher production is obtained is called crop rotation.

## Pollution : Miscellaneous

- In December 1984, extensive loss of life occurred due to the leakage of a poisonous gas called methyl isocyanate (MIC) from the Union Carbide plant located in Bhopal (Madhya Pradesh).
- Radioactive pollution can cause genetic changes in all living organisms, including humans, animals, and plants.
- DDT is a non-biodegradable pollutant. Such pollutants are not broken down by microorganisms.
- Glass, plastic, pesticides, e-waste, and synthetic rubber are non-biodegradable pollutants.
- Polythene is basically made of carbon and hydrogen.
- Among the given options, a plastic bag takes the longest time to decompose.
- To meet Euro-II standards, the sulphur content in ultra-low sulphur diesel should be 0.05 percent or less.
- Lead was used as an anti-knocking agent in automobiles.
- Excess fluoride ions cause a dental disease called fluorosis.

- Asbestos is a poisonous substance, and its dust can cause lung cancer.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) Carbon monoxide combines with haemoglobin in the blood and obstructs cellular respiration; it also damages the heart, liver, and kidneys.
- Respirable fine particles are particles small enough to enter the lungs during breathing.
- La Niña is a climatic phenomenon associated with coolerthan-average sea surface temperatures in the equatorial Pacific Ocean.
- Argemone seeds are commonly used as an adulterant in mustard seeds.
- Incineration is a waste treatment process in which the organic constituents present in waste materials are destroyed through combustion.
- Carbon Monoxide Sulphur dioxide Unsaturated Hydrocarbons U.P.B.E.O.

## Water Conservation

- The question mentions “World Water Conservation Day,” whereas the correct term is “World Water Day.” World Water Day is observed on 22 March.
- Biotic resources are obtained from the biosphere, that is, from living organisms or biological materials, such as forests, animals, and products obtained from them.
- Chlorine gas and bleaching powder are used to disinfect drinking water.
- According to the groundwater-related report released in 2017 by the Central Ground Water Board, out of a total of 6,881 assessment units (blocks/mandals/talukas/development blocks) in the country, 1,186 units in different states (about 17%) were over-exploited.
- The Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act was enacted in 1974.
- The Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Cess Act was enforced in 1977.
- Water can be disinfected by several methods, such as: (i) by heat and other physical means, (ii) by ultraviolet rays and other ionizing methods, and (iii) by oxidation through chemicals such as ozone, iodine, and chlorine compounds.
- Among the lakes mentioned in the question, the lakes situated in urban areas selected under the National Lake Conservation Plan (NLCP) for pollution control are Bhoj (Madhya Pradesh), Sukhna (Chandigarh), and Pichola (Rajasthan).
- At the time of this question, Bhimtal Lake of Uttarakhand had been included under the National Lake Conservation Project.
- The ‘Central Ganga Authority’ was constituted in February 1985 under the chairmanship of the then Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi.
- The National Ganga River Basin Authority (NGRBA) was constituted on 20 February 2009 under Section 3(3) of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.
- The ‘Ganga Action Plan’ was launched in 1985 by the then Ministry of Environment and Forests.
- The first phase of the Ganga Action Plan began in 1985.

## Organizations and Institutions

- The National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (NEERI) is located in the city of Nagpur in the state of Maharashtra.
- The World Meteorological Organization (WMO) is a specialized agency of the United Nations that studies the condition and behaviour of the Earth’s atmosphere.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 873 4. C. Rain Forest Research – Jorhat Institute D.
- Greenpeace International is a non-governmental environmental organization.
- Among the institutions given in the question, the National Institute of Nutrition is located in Hyderabad.
- The Indian Institute of Forest Management is located not in Kolkata, but in Bhopal.
- The Central Arid Zone Research Institute (CAZRI) is located in Jodhpur, Rajasthan.
- The Indian Institute of Ecology and Environment is located in New Delhi.
- The ‘Population and Environment Centre’ of the Environmental Information System (ENVIS) is located in IIPS (International Institute for Population Sciences), Mumbai.
- Under the Indian Antarctic Programme, three research stations have been established in Antarctica, namely Dakshin Gangotri, Maitri, and Bharati.

- Under an agreement reached at an international conference held in Geneva in 1948, the organization was formally constituted.
- India's first National Centre for Marine Biodiversity (NCMB) is located in Jamnagar, Gujarat.
- The Borlaug Award is given in the field of agriculture in recognition of Norman Borlaug's outstanding contribution to the Green Revolution.
- Norman E. Borlaug, internationally known as the father of the Green Revolution, was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1970.

## Various Awards

- The Indira Gandhi Environment Award, instituted in 1987 by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, is awarded to organizations and individuals making meaningful contributions in the field of environment.
- General Studies (Environment & Ecology) With the objective of increasing awareness and understanding of issues related to biodiversity, the United Nations has declared 22 May as the International Day for Biological Diversity.
- The Global–500 Award is given for outstanding work done in the field of environmental protection.

## Days and Dates

- World No Tobacco Day is observed every year on 31 May under the aegis of the United Nations.
- November is observed every year as World Toilet Day.
- It should be noted that World Environment Day is observed every year on 5 June.
- World Wetlands Day is observed every year on 2 February.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2025 ● ■International Ozone Day (International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer / World Ozone Day) is observed on 16 September; therefore, Pair 1 is correct.
- World Population Day is observed on 11 July.
- The correct matching is as follows– Day Event/Occasion April 18 – World Heritage Day May 22 – International Day for Biological Diversity July 29 – International Tiger Day December 5 – World Soil Day
- The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has announced that 5 October will be observed every year as National Dolphin Day.
- In Sierra Leone, National Sanitation Day is observed on the last Saturday of every month.

## Environment: Miscellaneous

- The 'LiFE Movement' was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 5 June 2022 on the occasion of World Environment Day.
- Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment) was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2022.
- With the inclusion of Jantar Mantar (Jaipur) by UNESCO in 2010, the number of World Heritage Sites in India reached
- Among the given options, the Konark Sun Temple was included in UNESCO's World Heritage List in 1984, whereas the Mahabodhi Temple was included in 2002.
- Baba Amte was associated with wildlife conservation and the Narmada Bachao Andolan.
- The Appiko Movement began in 1983 in the Western Ghats region of Karnataka, especially in the Uttara Kannada/ Sirsi area.
- The 14th Conference of the Parties (CoP-14) of the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) was held in New Delhi in September 2019.
- The 'Rally for Valley' programme was related to the rehabilitation of people displaced by the Narmada River Valley project.
- Aquatic systems, grasslands, and rainforests are examples of natural biomes, whereas cropland is an example of an anthropogenic biome.
- Eucalyptus is considered a threat to the environment because it lowers the groundwater table.
- Among the trees given in the question, the Sita Ashok tree is the most suitable for controlling dust.
- Mega-diverse countries are a group of countries that possess most of the Earth's biodiversity; therefore, these countries are considered highly biodiverse.
- Loquat is an evergreen fruit tree. Loquat is produced in large quantities in Japan.

- In India, the weather monitoring device SODAR has been installed at Kaiga, Kalpakkam, Tarapur, and Trombay.
- During different phases of the Pleistocene Age, much of the land surface was covered by ice sheets.
- In October 2019, on the eve of Mahatma Gandhi's 150th birth anniversary, the largest charkha made of plastic waste was inaugurated in Noida.
- The correct matches are – Skin cancer – Ultraviolet light Noise pollution – Decibel Global warming – Carbon dioxide Ozone hole – Chlorofluorocarbon

## Nature of Indian Economy

- An economy in which both the private and public sectors exist is called a mixed economy.
- India is a country with a mixed economy.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024 The Indian economy is a developing economy, although it still possesses many features of an underdeveloped economy.
- The term 'underdeveloped' is generally used for those economies in which the standard of living of the people is quite low, because the level of productivity is low and the level of population is high, resulting in low per capita income.
- The Indian economy is also called a developing economy or a mixed economy.
- All economic activities necessarily generate income; that is, all activities that generate income are economic activities.

# PART III - ECONOMIC & SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT

## National Income & Gross Domestic Product

- Among the options given, option (d) is not a characteristic feature of the Indian economy, whereas the other three options are characteristic features of the Indian economy.
- Among the options given, all 'except' “reforms in the judicial system” were part of the ‘Second Generation of Economic Reforms’ identified by the government.
- Consider the following statements about Amartya Sen’s advices regarding priorities for Indian Economy:
- Amartya Sen is associated with welfare economics.
- This idea was expressed by economist Amartya Sen, who was awarded the Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences in 1998.
- Prof. Raj Krishna first used the term ‘Hindu rate of growth’ in the early 1980s.
- The share of labour in Gross National Product is low because wages are lower in comparison to prices.
- The New Economic Policy adopted by India in 1991 was mainly based on liberalization, privatization and globalization.
- It should be noted that the major elements of economic development include direct contributions from capital accumulation, technological improvement, changes in population, specialized division of labour, entrepreneurship, natural resources, etc.; however, technicians and bureaucracy are not considered major contributing factors.
- The most appropriate measure of the economic growth of a country is per capita product/per capita real national income, because it reflects the per capita availability of national income.
- Economic growth means an increase in the real income of an economy over a period of time.
- Dadabhai Naoroji was the first to estimate India’s national income and assessed that the per capita income in India in 1867-68 was Rs.
- Prof. P.C. Mahalanobis was the Chairman of the National Income Committee appointed by the Government of India in 1949.
- See the explanation of the above question.
- In 2015, for the measurement of national income, 2011-12 was adopted as the new base year in place of 2004-05, and GVA (Gross Value Added) began to be calculated in place of GDP.
- Economic development of any country requires a multidimensional approach so that the goal of inclusive development may be achieved.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 883 For the period concerned in the question, option (c) was the nearest correct answer.
- For the period concerned, option (d) was the correct answer.
- For the period concerned, option (a) was the correct answer.
- For the period concerned, option (b) was the correct answer.
- At constant (2011-12) and current prices, Maharashtra has the largest economy among the states of the country.
- With reference to the period of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- For the period concerned, option (c) was the correct answer.
- Capital formation is a term used to describe net capital accumulation in a particular country during an accounting period.
- According to the Economic Survey 2025-26, India’s foreign exchange reserves rose from USD 668.3 billion at the end of March 2025 to USD 701.4 billion by 16 January 2026.
- Both for the period of the question and according to the Economic Survey 2025-26, during the decade 2000-01 to 2009-10, the highest rate of gross domestic saving (as a percentage of GDP) was achieved in 2007-08 (37.8%), while between 2010-11 and 2023-24 (1st R.E.), the highest saving was recorded in 2010-11 (36.9%).
- Among the given options, for the period of the question and according to the data released by RBI in August 2025 as well, option (c) is the correct answer.

## Sustainable Economic Development

- NITI Aayog is the nodal institution for the coordination and implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (Agenda 2030) in India.

- For the period of the question, option (a) was the correct answer.
- In the ‘SDG India Index & Dashboard, 2019-20’ released by NITI Aayog in December 2019, Uttar Pradesh was included in the ‘Performer’ category.
- The third SDG India Index and Dashboard, 2020-21, was released by NITI Aayog in June 2021.
- On 30 December 2019, NITI Aayog released the SDG India Index.
- In November 2021, NITI Aayog released the SDG Urban Index and Dashboard, 2021-22.
- Assertion (A) is true because the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are global collective objectives, and most of their indicators—such as poverty, hunger, health, education, access to energy, sanitation, etc.—are population-based or population-weighted.
- Among the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to be achieved by the United Nations by the year 2030, SDG2 includes Zero Hunger, SDG-3 includes Good Health and Well-Being, and SDG-5 includes Gender Equality.
- Goal 4 (SDG-4) under Sustainable Development Goals, 2030 relates to Quality Education.
- The official titles of the SDGs mentioned in the question are as follows: Goal-1: End poverty in all its forms Goal-3: Good Health and Well-Being Goal-4: Quality Education Goal-6: Clean Water and Sanitation
- Sustainable Development Goal-6 (SDG-6: Clean Water and Sanitation) seeks to ensure “availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all” by the year 2030.
- List-II (Related With) 1. Climate Action
- Statement 1 is true, whereas Statement 2 is false.
- The concept of sustainable development began with scientist Rachel Carson’s book Silent Spring and biologists Paul R.
- In April 1968, a group of thirty individuals from ten countriesincluding scientists, teachers, economists, humanitarians and administrators met at the Accademia Dei Lincei in Rome.
- The Environmental Kuznets Curve (EKC) shows the relationship between environmental degradation and per capita GDP.
- Balancing the use of resources and the need to conserve them for the future is called ‘Sustainable Development’, whereas careful use of resources and allowing them time to renew is called ‘Resource Conservation’.
- Neemrana is located in Alwar district of Rajasthan.
- The main objective of sustainable tourism is to manage tourism and the environment while maintaining cultural integrity and ecological processes.
- Skilled, healthy and educated citizens are the key to the development of any country.
- Investment in education is regarded as a major source of human capital.
- Assertion (A) is true because expenditure on education, health, skill development, etc.
- Human capital is treated like other forms of capital.
- Inclusive development means access to resources and facilities for all sections of society.
- Inclusive growth is a multidimensional concept of development in a comprehensive sense.
- The new chapter ‘Sustainable Development and Climate Change’ was added for the first time in the Economic Survey of 2011-12.

## Agriculture and Allied Sectors

- ‘Genetic industries’ are those industries which are engaged in the breeding and growth of specific species of plants and animals for the purpose of sale.
- ‘Cereal yield’ is defined as the quantity of cereal crops produced per unit area of harvested land.
- Farmers who possess some means but are not affluent are called ‘Bullock Capitalists’.
- Chaudhary Charan Singh opposed Nehru’s Soviet-style economic development.
- In general, land reforms and particularly tenancy reforms aim, from the perspective of social justice, at redistributing ownership of holdings and reorganizing operational holdings for the optimum use of land.
- According to the Agricultural Census 2015-16, a holding of less than 1 hectare in India is called a marginal holding, and farmers having such holdings are termed marginal farmers.
- Rural poverty discourages farmers from investing in advanced agricultural technology.
- Agriculture plays an important role in promoting development.
- Among the given options, in 2014-15 a negative growth rate (-0.2%) was recorded in agriculture and allied sectors at constant prices (2011-12).

- Agriculture showed a negative growth rate during the Third Five-Year Plan.
- According to the 2014 estimate of the National Sample Survey Office (NSSO), during the agricultural year July 2012–June 2013, the estimated total number of agricultural households in rural India was 90.2 million.
- At the time of the question and according to the present data of the UPAg portal of the Government of India, option (c) remains correct.
- At the time of the question and according to the data released by the USDA in April 2025, option (d) was correct among the options.
- The best soil for cotton is black soil, which is found most extensively in Gujarat, Maharashtra, Punjab, and Andhra Pradesh in India.
- The crown root initiation stage is the most critical stage for irrigation of wheat.
- According to Agricultural Statistics, 2015, the net sown area under crops in India in 2012-13 (provisional) was 13.99 crore hectares.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 893 Among the options given for the period concerned, option (c) was correct.
- Since the Green Revolution, foodgrain production in India has increased as expected.
- As a result of the Green Revolution in the 1960s, foodgrain production in India registered remarkable growth.
- Given the way the population is increasing in the country, mechanization and technological as well as institutional reforms in agriculture are not progressing in the same proportion.
- At the time of the question and according to updated data as well, China is the largest producer of vegetables in the world.
- For the period of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- At the time of the question and according to the latest available data, the correct matching is as follows: Fruit Largest Producer Mango – Uttar Pradesh (3rd A.E.
- : : Spain Brazil U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021 Among the options given, the top coffee-producing country is Brazil, not Mongolia.
- For the period of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- At the time of the question, among the pulses given in the options, lentil was imported the most.
- Among the given options, India earns the maximum foreign exchange through the export of basmati rice.
- The preferred variety of mango for export is Alphonso.
- Niger is a small oilseed crop, mainly grown under rainfed conditions.
- According to the 2023-24 data, Karnataka is the leading producer of mulberry silk in India.
- Initial efforts in the direction of cooperative farming in India began in the early decades of the twentieth century.
- The Indian economy is still basically an agriculture-based economy.
- The levy of tax on agricultural income in India falls within the jurisdiction of state governments.
- According to the 2011 Census, the largest percentage of workers in Uttar Pradesh (59.3%) is employed in the agriculture sector.
- The Kisan Bahi Scheme was implemented in Uttar Pradesh in 1992.
- Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana has been in operation since 16 August 2007, which falls under the financial year 200708.
- P. Sengupta and G. Sadasivam (1968) divided India into 4 macro agricultural regions, 11 meso (or mega) regions, and 60 micro regions.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 897 The National Horticulture Mission (NHM) is a centrally sponsored scheme.
- The National Horticulture Mission (NHM) is presently a sub-scheme under the Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH), which is being implemented in selected districts of 18 states and 5 Union Territories.
- The objectives of the National Horticulture Mission are to achieve high growth in the horticulture sector, undertake post-harvest management, and develop human resources.
- The Agricultural Labour Social Security Scheme (Krishi Shramik Samajik Suraksha Yojna) was launched on 1 July 2001.
- Food security means not only ‘production/availability’ but also ‘physical and economic access of every person at all times to adequate, safe, and nutritious food’.
- The main dimensions of food security are: Availability, Access, Affordability, Utilization, and Stability.
- In the context of food security, the ‘entitlement approach’ was propounded by economist Amartya Sen.
- The Central Government notified the National Food Security Act, 2013 on 10 September 2013, and it came into effect retrospectively from 5 July 2013.

- See the explanation of the above question.
- The National Food Security Mission (NFSM) was launched in October 2007.
- Through the Public Distribution System (PDS), the government makes foodgrains available to poor families at reasonable prices.
- Operation Flood was launched with the objective of accelerating the White Revolution.
- 900 ‘Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana’ was implemented in Uttar Pradesh as a part of Nand Baba Mission to improve cattle breed and increase milk production.
- According to 'the State of World Fisheries and Aquaculture, 2024', China is the top producer in total fisheries and aquaculture production in the world with a 36 percent share, followed by India (8%).
- The Blue Revolution is related to fish production.
- The Yellow Revolution is related to oilseed production.
- The Green Revolution in India began with the kharif crop in 1966.
- Organic farming is a production system that is beneficial to soil, ecosystems, and human health.
- The National Agricultural Technology Project (NATP) is a World Bank-assisted project.
- The first attempt at crop insurance in India was made on 1 April 1985 during the kharif season, when the Government of India launched the Comprehensive Crop Insurance Scheme (CCIS).
- In place of the Comprehensive Crop Insurance Scheme, which had started in April 1985, the National Agricultural Insurance Scheme was launched from the Rabi season of 1999-2000 by the Union Ministry of Agriculture (now Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare).
- The National Agricultural Insurance Scheme, which was launched from the Rabi season of 1999-2000, was extended to kharif crops from the Budget of 2004-05.
- The Weather-Based Crop Insurance Scheme was first implemented in Karnataka in 2007 (kharif season).
- Blue Revolution is related to fisheries, not mustard production.
- In January 2003, the then Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee launched ‘Hariyali’, a water-harvesting related development scheme costing Rs.
- The Rainfed Area Development Programme was launched in 2011-12 by the Department of Agriculture and Cooperation, Government of India.
- The Vishesh Krishi and Gram Udyog Yojana (VKGUY) was launched to promote exports of agricultural produce, forest produce, and village industry products.
- The National Land Records Modernization Programme (NLRMP) was launched on 21 August 2008.
- The Handbook of Agriculture is published by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR).
- The National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED), established on 2 October 1958, is related to agricultural marketing.
- In most parts of India, the market for agricultural products is developed and operated under the Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee Acts (APMC Acts) enacted by the states.
- The demand for agricultural products is inelastic.
- The ‘Kisan Call Center’ (KCC) was started on 21 January 2004 by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, Government of India.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) The first Krishi Vigyan Kendra was established in Puducherry (earlier Pondicherry) in 1974.
- The Indian Institute of Vegetable Research (IIVR) is located in Varanasi.
- The Central Food Technological Research Institute (CFTRI) is located in Mysuru (Mysore).
- The National Academy of Agricultural Research Management (NAARM) is located in Hyderabad.
- The Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute, established in 1962, is located in Jhansi.
- The International Potato Center (CIP), established in 1971, has its headquarters in Lima, Peru.
- The ‘Neeru-Meeru’ (Water and You) water conservation programme was launched in the state of Andhra Pradesh in 2000.
- In place of the Minimum Support Price, the Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) for sugarcane is approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA).
- For the Food Corporation of India, the economic cost of foodgrains is the sum of the acquisition cost of foodgrains (Minimum Support Price and bonus paid to farmers plus procurement incidentals) and the distribution cost.
- Minimum Support Price (MSP) ensures a minimum fixed price for farmers’ produce and also promotes food security by encouraging farmers to increase agricultural production.

- At the time of the question, option (c) was the correct answer.
- In October 2020, the Government of Kerala decided to fix the Minimum Support Price (MSP) for fruits and vegetables, which became effective from 1 November 2020.
- At the time of the question, option (a) was the correct answer.
- In the Union Budget for 2011-12, the interest subsidy on timely repayment of bank loans for farmers was increased from 2% to 3%.
- Land revenue is not included in the working capital cost of a farm, whereas seeds, fertilizer, and irrigation water are included in its working capital, because all these are agricultural inputs.
- Animal husbandry, cottage industries, and the availability of good tools contribute significantly to the rural economy.
- The major principles of agricultural finance are purpose, person, productivity planning, organization, etc.
- The government purchases agricultural produce from farmers at procurement prices.
- The maximum institutional credit for agriculture and allied activities in the country is being provided respectively by commercial banks, regional rural banks, and cooperative banks, while the contribution of foreign private banks in this regard is the least (almost negligible).
- Events Year Establishment of NABARD – 1982 SHG-Bank Linkage Programme – 1992-93 Kisan Credit Card Scheme – 1998-99 Establishment of Regional Rural Banks – 1975
- To protect the interests of consumers against price fluctuations in agricultural products like onion, potato, and pulses, the Central Government established the Price Stabilization Fund (PSF) in 2014-15.

## Industrial Sector

- According to at the time of question as well as the Fortune 500 India, 2025 list, option (c) is the correct answer.
- In theory, Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) means doing business while fulfilling social responsibilities, not doing a favor to society.
- Indian Railways had set the target of a zero carbon emission network by 2030 and 100 percent electrification by 2023.
- India’s first rubber-tyre-based metro is being built in Nashik, Maharashtra.
- Then Union Minister Arun Jaitley had announced in the 2015–16 Budget that the PPP model for infrastructure development would be reconsidered and strengthened again.
- After the task force constituted on the National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) submitted its final report, it was released by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on 29 April 2020.
- The PM Gati Shakti National Plan was launched on 13 October 2021 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi.
- The assertion (A) given in the question is incorrect; because if downloading is taken as the basis, India is at the top in the mobile gaming market, and if revenue is taken as the basis, India is not even among the top 5 countries.
- Established in 2001 as a joint venture (50:50) of Tata Steel and SAIL, ‘M-junction’ is India’s largest B2B e-commerce company.
- The ‘Make in India’ programme was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 25 September 2014.
- The special requirements of start-ups are met through angel investors, venture capital and crowd funding.
- During the Innovation Festival (17 January 2016), then President Pranab Mukherjee expressed his views on startups in these words: “In my view, for financing innovations, instead of a single solution, there should be a mixed model.
- Stand-Up India aims to make access to institutional credit easier for Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe and women entrepreneurs.
- The implementation of the Prime Minister Mudra Yojana (PMMY) is carried out by the Department of Financial Services (DFS) under the Ministry of Finance, Government of India.
- The correct chronological order of the Acts mentioned in the question is as follows: Minimum Wages Act – 1948 Industries (Development and Regulation) Act – 1951 MRTP Act – 1969 FERA – 1973
- According to the Minimum Wages Act, 1948, option (b) was the correct answer for the relevant period.
- For the period in question as well as in the current context, option (c) is the correct answer.
- The Index of Industrial Production (IIP) in India is calculated by NSO (earlier CSO).
- In the new series of the Index of Industrial Production released on 10 June 2011, the base year was changed to 2004–05.

- *UPPSC Question Papers 909 Fourteen years after the MSME Development Act came into existence in 2006, it was announced on 13 May 2020 under the Atmanirbhar Bharat package that the definition of MSME would be revised.
- Under the 2020 notification, option (c) was the correct answer.
- According to the Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) 2023– 24 released in September 2025, the top 5 states in terms of number of registered factories are as follows—Tamil Nadu > Gujarat > Maharashtra > Uttar Pradesh > Andhra Pradesh.
- At the time of the question as well as at present, among the industries mentioned, the handloom industry is the largest industry in Uttar Pradesh from the point of view of employment.
- At present, the major problems faced by small industries in India are lack of capital, marketing problems, shortage of raw materials, infrastructural constraints, customs duty policy, delayed payments, sickness, non-availability of quality data, etc.
- Small and cottage industries occupy an important place in the Indian economy.
- To study the problems of small industries and to give suggestions for their development, the then Union Ministry of Industry constituted an Expert Committee on Small Enterprises in December 1995 under the chairmanship of Dr.
- In the case of cooperative units, the cotton textile industry achieved a high rate of growth.
- In India, cottage industries developed first.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) Large-sized paper, that is, newsprint, is produced most extensively by Nepa Limited (formerly the National Newsprint and Paper Mills Limited) at Nepanagar, which is in Madhya Pradesh.
- KRIBHCO's Hazira fertilizer plant, located at Hazira near Surat, is based on natural gas.
- To promote the development of exploration and extraction of oil and natural gas in India, the Oil and Natural Gas Commission was established on 14 August 1956, but it received statutory recognition in October 1959.
- Oil India Limited (OIL), which received Maharatna status in September 2023, is a public sector enterprise engaged in the exploration, development and production of crude oil and natural gas, as well as oil transportation.
- Among the given options, the Minerals and Metals Trading Corporation (MMTC) is the largest trading organization in India's public sector.
- The functions and objectives of the public sector in India include providing public utility resources, creating social and economic overhead capital, ensuring balanced regional and sectoral development, and promoting egalitarian goals by encouraging redistribution of income and wealth.
- ESSAR OIL (now Nayara Energy Limited) is a private sector enterprise, whereas the other three enterprises listed in the options belong to the public sector.
- The correct matching is as follows— Refinery State Barauni – Bihar Bongaigaon – Assam Bina – Madhya Pradesh Koyali – Gujarat
- HAL (Hindustan Aeronautics Limited) is especially engaged in the production of aircraft and their equipment.
- In India, the development of tourism and hotel industry is the responsibility of ITDC (Indian Tourism Development Corporation).
- Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) was established in the year 2000.
- Among the four companies mentioned above, BSNL is the only company in which the Government of India holds 100% share capital, whereas in the other three public sector undertakings – NTPC, BHEL and SBI the present government shareholding is less than 100 percent (51.1%, 63.17% and 57.4% respectively).
- Gas Authority of India Limited had made a provision of Rs.
- In India, petroleum products such as petrol and diesel are 'deregulated commodities', and their prices are determined by oil companies.
- Navratna is a special category of public sector undertakings in which the government sees the potential capability of becoming global companies.
- Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Limited (MTNL) is a public sector enterprise included in Navratna, whereas GAIL India Limited and Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL) have been given Maharatna status.
- At the time of the question, except Indian Aluminium Company Limited, the other three companies had Navratna status.
- National Aluminium Company Limited (NALCO) was established in 1981 as a public enterprise of the Government of India.

- In August 2010, the ‘Udyami Helpline’ was established for micro, small and medium enterprises with the objective of providing information/guidance about various government incentive schemes and furnishing information related to obtaining bank loans for establishing enterprises.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 913 The Industrial Development Bank of India (IDBI) was established as a financial institution on 1 July 1964 under the Industrial Development Bank of India Act, 1964.
- The expanded form of B.I.F.R. is ‘Board for Industrial and Financial Reconstruction’.
- The government approved the Mega Food Park Scheme in September 2008.
- Among the options given in the question, employment generation is included in the social objectives of business.
- In a sole trader/sole proprietorship firm, the proprietor’s liability is unlimited, that is, beyond the capital invested in the firm.
- India’s second Industrial Policy was placed in Parliament by Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru in April 1956.
- Before liberalization, under the Industries (Development and Regulation) Act, 1951, it was necessary to obtain an industrial licence for establishing a new industrial undertaking, manufacturing a new item by an existing undertaking, changing the location of an industry, substantially expanding the existing capacity, and for all other such purposes.
- Under the economic reforms of 1991, the maximum changes were made under Industrial Policy 1991, because the basic pillars of this policy were liberalization, privatization and globalization.
- ISO-9001 and ISO-9002 certificates based on international quality management standards have been awarded to most Indian industries by the Bureau of Indian Standards.
- In the New Industrial Policy announced on 24 July 1991 by the then P.V.
- In India, the new economic policy of liberalization, privatization and globalization was announced in 1991 by the then Prime Minister P.V.
- Liberalization is the process of relaxing or removing government controls.
- Under the New Industrial Policy issued in July 1991, the government decided to reduce its role in public sector enterprises, as a result of which disinvestment in public enterprises began in 1991–92.
- FMCG generally refers to non-durable packaged consumer goods.
- Bhilai Steel Plant was established in Chhattisgarh, Bokaro Steel Plant in Jharkhand, Durgapur Steel Plant in West Bengal, and Rourkela Steel Plant in Odisha (earlier known as Orissa).
- The Indian Diamond Institute (IDI) has been established in Surat.
- The correct matching is as follows— Place Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh) – Muri (Jharkhand) – Gurgaon (Haryana) – Panki (Uttar Pradesh) – Industrial Centre Ship-building Aluminium Motor vehicles Fertilizer
- The correct matching is as follows— City Industry Coimbatore – Cotton textiles Rourkela – Iron and steel Kapurthala – Rail coaches Barauni – Oil refining
- The correct matching is as follows— Singrauli (Madhya Pradesh) – Coal Kajrahat (Uttar Pradesh) – Cement Koyali (Gujarat) – Oil Anand (Gujarat) – Milk
- The constitution of the National Renewal Fund (NRF) was announced by the Central Government under the New Industrial Policy of 1991.
- In 1991, under the New Industrial Policy, the government introduced an incentive-based ‘Voluntary Retirement Scheme’ (VRS) to free public sector undertakings from surplus employees.
- India was the first country in Asia to recognize the importance of the Export Processing Zone (EPZ) in export promotion, and Asia’s first export processing zone was established at Kandla (Gujarat) in 1965.
- Labour-intensive industries are those industries in which the importance of labour cost is greater than that of capital cost.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 917 Consumers and their organizations are not participants in industrial relations, whereas workers and their organizations, managers and their organizations, and the state governments and the Central Government are participants in industrial relations.
- Madras Aluminium Company (MALCO) is located at Mettur, Salem district (Tamil Nadu), not in Chennai.
- * The state of Gujarat is one of the major states of the country from the point of view of the petrochemical industry.
- Katni, situated in Madhya Pradesh, is famous for the cement industry, not for the paper industry.
- The centre of jute goods is Titagarh in West Bengal, and the centre of silk textile production is Bangalore in Karnataka.
- The coastal cities of Gujarat such as Porbandar, Dwarka, Bhavnagar, Baroda, Jamnagar and Surat are highly developed industrially, where textiles, cement, fertilizers, chemicals and petrochemical industries are prominent.

- Participation in management means the role of workers in policy-making of the enterprise, and the leaders of the workers' union in such an enterprise—or, where there is no workers' union, selected workers—are given a role by being placed on the management board of the enterprise.
- At the beginning of the twentieth century, the first sugar mill in India was established at Pratappur (Deoria).
- The Tarapore Committee was constituted to advise on rupee convertibility in the capital account, not on customer service in banks.
- The headquarters of the Khadi and Village Industries Commission is in Mumbai.
- A 12-member committee was constituted in July 1995 under the chairmanship of Mira Seth in relation to the development of the handloom sector.
- The Satyam Committee was constituted in July 1998 to provide policy recommendations regarding the textile industry, and it submitted its report in August 1999.
- To promote enterprises in the unorganized and informal sector, the Central Government constituted a National Commission in September 2004 under the leadership of former Planning Commission member Arjun Sengupta.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 919 The e-Biz portal is related to a single-window platform for access to government services.
- At the time of the question and in 2024 as well, TCS remained India's most valuable software company.

## Tertiary Sector

- The tertiary sector includes the service sector or service industry, which covers services related to trade, hotels, transport, communication, broadcasting, finance, banking, insurance, real estate, public administration, security, education, health, entertainment, etc.
- At the time of the question, Delhi was the correct answer among the given options.
- At the time of the question, option (c) was the correct answer.
- According to the Economic Survey, 2023 (2022–23), fashion, grocery and general merchandise will account for nearly two-thirds of the Indian e-commerce market by 2027.
- The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) was established on 20 February 1997 by an Act of Parliament to regulate telecommunication services, including tariff fixation/revision for telecommunication services, which were previously vested in the Central Government.

## Fiscal Policy & Revenue

- The ten broad themes of the Union Budget 2017-18 were – farmers, rural population, youth, poor and underprivileged sections, infrastructure, financial sector, digital economy, public service, prudent fiscal management and tax administration.
- In the Union Budget 2023–24, states were allowed a fiscal deficit of 3.5 percent of GSDP, of which 0.5 percent was linked to reforms in the power sector.
- In the Union Budget 2021–22, the Finance Minister proposed the Agriculture Infrastructure and Development Cess (AIDC) on a small number of goods.
- In the Economic Survey of 2015–16, the Indian economy's movement from socialism to limited marketism without exit was considered the 'Chakravyuha Challenge' of the Indian economy.
- According to the Economic Survey 2022–23, the Union Budget for FY 2022–23 was presented in a broadly uncertain economic environment.
- The Goods and Services Tax (GST), effective throughout the country from 1 July 2017, is an indirect tax.
- The Constitution (101st Amendment) Act, 2016 made the necessary provisions in the Indian Constitution for the implementation of GST (Goods and Services Tax) rules.
- GST is an indirect tax for the whole country, which will make India a unified common market.
- Under the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, Article 279A was inserted in the Constitution to provide for the constitution of the Goods and Services Tax Council.
- In October, 2020, the gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) revenue collection stood at Rs.
- 'Input Tax Credit' (ITC) means "the payment of tax on the supply of goods and services or both received by a registered person." Therefore, statement 1 is correct.
- Revenue Neutral Rate is a structure of different rates established under GST so as to match revenue with the earlier revenue income.

- The Saksham project approved by the Government of India is related to the new indirect tax network (system integration).
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) In India, fiscal policy is determined by the Ministry of Finance of the Central Government, whereas monetary policy is determined by the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) under the RBI.
- The long-term fiscal policy was announced by the then Finance Minister V.P.
- The action plan used by the government regarding revenue and expenditure to achieve desired effects relating to national income, production, and employment is called fiscal policy.
- The Economic Review is prepared by the Union Ministry of Finance.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 923 The Economic Survey of India is officially published every year by the Department of Economic Affairs under the Ministry of Finance, Government of India.
- Zero-Based Budgeting is a technique for reducing wastefulness in public expenditure.
- The share in total expenditure under the optional heads in the Union Budget 2023-24 and 2026-27 is as follows— Head 2023-24 2026-27 Interest payments 20 percent 20 percent States' share in taxes and 18 percent duties 22 percent Major subsidies 7 percent 6 percent Defence expenditure 8 percent 11 percent
- With reference to the Union Budget 2011-12, option (c) was the correct answer.
- The correct matching is as follows: Budget allocation: in lakh crore rupees Sector Year 2018-19 Year 2026-27 Defence 2.82 5.95 Agriculture and allied 0.63 1.63 activities Food subsidy 1.69 2.28 Rural development 1.39 2.73
- For the period of the question as well as at present, option (b) is the correct answer.
- Income tax, public debt, and VAT are sources of public revenue, whereas subsidy forms part of public expenditure.
- Among the income sources mentioned in the question, the first two – corporation tax and profits received from public enterprises and the last one, excise duty, relate to the current or revenue account, whereas the other two the amount received from the sale of National Savings Certificates and the loan from the World Bank – fall under the capital account.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- Three major reforms were introduced in Budget 2017-18.
- Both at the time of the question and according to Budget Estimates 2026-27, among the given options, the most important item of the Union Government's revenue expenditure is interest payments.
- According to the estimates of the Union Budget 2018-19, option (c) was the correct answer.
- According to Budget Estimates 2026-27, the updated position of fiscal deficit (as a percentage of GDP) is as follows— Year 2024-25 Year 2025-26 Year 2026-27 Actual Budget Est.
- According to the Union Budget 2026-27, the deficits shown in the Union Government budget (Rs.
- If interest payments are deducted from gross fiscal deficit, the remainder is called gross primary deficit.
- At the time of the question, option (a) was the correct answer.
- Effective revenue deficit is the difference between revenue deficit and grants given for the creation of capital assets.
- In the budgets of the Union Government, most of the fiscal deficit is financed through domestic loans and other liabilities.
- Statement (A) is true, because India provides about 8–9 percent of its expenditure in the form of subsidies (in Budget 2026-27, total subsidies are 8.41% of total expenditure), which is a major source of budget deficit.
- On the recommendation of the Hoover Commission (1949), performance budgeting was first used in the agricultural sector in the U.S.A.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 927 After 1991, fiscal consolidation was pursued, and to provide legal support to these reforms, the Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act (FRBMA-2003) was enacted on 26 August 2003 and came into effect from 5 July 2004.
- In the Union Budget 2020-21, a total disinvestment receipt target of Rs.
- While presenting the Railway Budget on 25 February 2016, the then Railway Minister Suresh Prabhu proposed the formation of a research and development organization called "Special Railway Establishment for Strategic Technology and Holistic Advancement" (SHREStHA).
- In the Rail Budget 2013–14, approval was given to run a passenger train named "Anubhuti" in order to provide an excellent ambience and the latest facilities and services.
- In India, the Direct Tax Code (DTC) is related to income tax (direct taxes).
- The imposition of Expenditure Tax in India was first suggested by Kaldor.
- Indirect taxes are called a regressive tax system because they are imposed at the same rate on all income groups.

- At the national level in India, the rates of income tax are determined and imposed by the Union Government.
- According to the Union Budget 2016–17, a 15% surcharge was payable on annual income exceeding Rs.
- In the Union Budget for FY 2011–12, a new category of “Very senior citizens” was created for persons aged 80 years or above in the context of income tax.
- The purpose of Central Sales Tax or Union Sales Tax is to reduce disparities in sales tax between States.
- The correct matching of estimated sources of income and their percentages in the Central Budget 2020–21 is as follows— Source Corporation Tax Income Tax Customs Duty Central Excise Duty Percentage Income 18 percent 17 percent 4 percent 7 percent In Budget Estimate 2026–27, the order of tax revenue sources in income is as follows— Income Tax (21%), Corporation Tax (18%), GST and Other Taxes (15%), Central Excise Duty (6%), and Customs Duty (4%).
- *UPPSC Question Papers 929 With reference to the year 2009–10, option (c) was the correct answer.
- In India, road tax is not levied by the Government of India.
- Customs duty and corporation tax are imposed and collected by the Union Government.
- Capital Gains Tax – Capital gains are of two types: longterm capital gain and short-term capital gain.
- The year 1986 was a historic year in the history of excise duty, when MODVAT was implemented from 1 March 1986 by V.P.
- CENVAT (Central Value Added Tax) is related to Central Excise Duty.
- Value Added Tax (VAT) is a multi-stage tax that is levied incrementally on the value added to a procut or service at each stage of the supply chain from initial production to the final sale to the consume.
- The VAT system, implemented from 1 April 2005, was not accepted at that time by BJP-ruled States as well as Uttar Pradesh (then ruled by the Samajwadi Party) and Tamil Nadu (then ruled by AIADMK).
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013 Service tax is an indirect tax.
- Income tax in India was introduced on 24 July 1860 by Sir James Wilson.
- Taxes that are imposed on goods (that is, indirect taxes) increase the price of goods, whereas direct taxes do not affect the prices of goods.
- The tax imposed by the Central Government on imports or exports is known as Customs Duty.
- A direct tax is one whose monetary burden cannot be shifted to another person; that is, in the case of direct taxes, both the impact and incidence of taxation fall on the same person on whom it is imposed.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 931 Excise duty is levied on goods produced in the country.
- * Which is not an indirect tax? [U.P. P.C.S.
- Telecom operators have to pay licence fee and spectrum charges to the Centre in the form of revenue sharing.
- Entertainment tax falls under List II (State List) of the Seventh Schedule of the Indian Constitution.
- Corporation tax is imposed by the Central Government, not by State Governments.
- Excise duty on liquor is imposed by State Governments.
- According to Article 280 of the Constitution, the President shall constitute a Finance Commission every five years or earlier if necessary.
- Both the Finance Commission and the Planning Commission (now replaced by NITI Aayog) are advisory institutions.
- Under the 88th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2000, all types of taxes collected by the Central Government were made shareable with the States.
- The 15th Finance Commission was constituted by the President under Article 280(1) on 27 November 2017 under the chairmanship of N.K.
- The criteria and weight assigned by the 13th, 15th, and 16th Finance Commissions for the distribution of Central tax revenues among States are as follows – Criterion 13th FC (2010–15) Weight 15th FC (2020–26) Weight 16th FC (2026–31) Weight 25.0% (1971) 15.0% (2011) 17.5% (2011)
- The Chairman of India’s First Finance Commission was K.C.
- N.K.P. Salve was the Chairman of the 9th, K.C.
- The Tenth Finance Commission recommended that 29% of the total revenue of the Centre should be distributed to the States as their share through appropriate constitutional amendment.
- The recommendations of the Kelkar Task Force are related to tax reforms.
- The Kelkar Committee, constituted under the leadership of Dr.
- At the time of the question, the latest committee that had submitted its report on tax reforms was known as the Kelkar Committee (Task Force).

- In 1991, a Tax Reforms Committee was constituted under the chairmanship of Raja J.
- From the point of view of tax relief to individuals, National Savings Certificate, Public Provident Fund, and National Savings Scheme are similar, under which tax relief is available on investment, whereas Indira Vikas Patra is different because there is no provision of tax relief on investment under it.
- Tax has to be paid according to existing rules on the interest income earned from Kisan Vikas Patra, whereas investment in the other options is eligible for income tax exemption up to a specified limit.
- The 10-character PAN number is divided into 5 parts.
- The five main sources of income of Panchayats are as follows –
- The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) was constituted by an Act of Parliament in 1988 and became operational in February 1995.

## Planning

- "Economic and social planning" is mentioned in Entry No.
- The Development Monitoring and Evaluation Office (DMEO) was established by the Government of India in September 2015 through the merger of the erstwhile Programme Evaluation Office (PEO) and Independent Evaluation Office (IEO).
- Ashok Chanda referred to the Planning Commission (now abolished and replaced by NITI Aayog) as the "Economic Cabinet." 936
- The National Development Council (NDC) was established on 6 August 1952.
- The Planning Commission, constituted on 15 March 1950 through a resolution of the Union Cabinet, was a nonconstitutional advisory body.
- Option (b) is incorrect because the Prime Minister is the ex officio Chairman of NITI Aayog.
- NITI Aayog is the nodal institution for coordination and implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (Agenda 2030) in India.
- Arvind Panagariya was the first Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog.
- According to the "India Innovation Index, 2019," Karnataka ranked first among the Major States.
- At the time of the question, option (c) was the correct answer.
- Planning in a nation is adopted to fulfill the following objectives –
- Under the Gadgil-Mukherjee formula, the highest weightage was given to population (1971), which was 60 percent.
- In 1944, the noted Gandhian economist Shriman Narayan Agarwal presented a plan for India's economic planning, which came to be known as the "Gandhian Plan." This plan envisaged the establishment of self-reliant villages along with a decentralized economic structure.
- Among the options given, Mahatma Gandhi opposed planned development in India.
- Gunnar Myrdal, in his book Indian Economic Planning in its Broader Setting, recommended the Rolling Plan for developing countries.
- In 1978, the Janata Party government terminated the Fifth Plan (1974–79) before time and introduced a Rolling Plan for 1978–80.
- The Twelfth Five-Year Plan covered the period 2012–17 with the objective of "faster, sustainable and more inclusive growth." In this plan, the targets were 8.0 percent growth in GDP, 4 percent in agriculture and allied sectors, and 10 percent in the manufacturing sector.
- During the Twelfth Five-Year Plan, the estimated growth rate of agriculture, forestry and fisheries was 4 percent.
- In the proposed Approach Paper for the Twelfth Five-Year Plan, the target for GDP growth was fixed at 9–9.5 percent.
- The Twelfth Five-Year Plan (2012–17) focused on "Faster, Sustainable and More Inclusive Growth."
- In the Twelfth Five-Year Plan, the highest amount was allocated to Social Services.
- The Eleventh Five-Year Plan covered the period 2007– 2012.
- In the Eleventh Five-Year Plan (2007–12), the expenditure proposed by the Centre, States and Union Territories was Rs.
- In the Eleventh Five-Year Plan, the growth targets for agriculture, industry and services were fixed at 4.0 percent, 10.5 percent and 9.9 percent respectively.
- During the Eleventh Five-Year Plan (2007–12), the original target of annual GDP growth was 9.0 percent.
- In the mid-term appraisal of India's Tenth Five-Year Plan (2002–07), the annual growth rate of the economy was reduced to 7 percent, against the original target of 8.0 percent.

- Expenditure on various major heads in the Tenth and Twelfth Five-Year Plans— 10th Plan 12th Plan Energy 26.47% 18.8% Social services 22.79% 34.79% Transport 14.31% 15.7% Communication 6.43% 1.1% Sector
- During the Tenth Five-Year Plan, the domestic saving rate was about 26.84 percent of GDP, whereas the investment rate during the same period was 32.1 percent of GDP.
- The Ninth Five-Year Plan emphasized “growth with social justice and equality.” This plan covered the period 1997–2002.
- The Women’s Component Plan was introduced as a major strategy in the Ninth Five-Year Plan (1997–2002).
- The Seventh Five-Year Plan (1985–90) ended on 31 March 1990.
- The basic objective of the Eighth Five-Year Plan was “human development in various dimensions.”
- The Integrated Rural Development Programme (IRDP) was launched in 1976 in 20 selected districts of the country.
- The Fifth Five-Year Plan started on 1 April 1974 and was to end on 31 March 1979.
- Under the Fifth Five-Year Plan, for the first time, national development programmes were started with the objective of poverty alleviation and fulfillment of the minimum needs of the poorer sections.
- The Green Revolution began in India in 1966–67, 14 banks were nationalised for the first time on 19 July 1969, and the slogan “Garibi Hatao” was given by Indira Gandhi in 1971, later included as the main goal of the Fifth Five-Year Plan (1974–79).
- The Growth Centre Approach was introduced in the Fourth Five-Year Plan with the objective of removing regional imbalances.
- The Second Five-Year Plan (1956–61) was based on the model developed by P.C.
- Keeping in view the then prevailing situation of large-scale foodgrain imports and inflationary pressure on the economy, the First Five-Year Plan (1951–56) gave top priority to agriculture, along with irrigation and power projects.
- The correct matching is as follows— Five-Year Plan Development Model Used First – Harrod-Domar Model Second – Mahalanobis Model Third – S.
- Five-Year Plan Programme First Plan (1951-1956) – ■Community Development Programme in 1952.
- The correct matching is as follows— First Five-Year Plan – 1951-56 Third Five-Year Plan – 1961-66 Fourth Five-Year Plan – 1969-74 Sixth Five-Year Plan – 1980-85
- *UPPSC Question Papers 941 Since the planning process began in 1951, the total number of uncovered years in the Five-Year Plans has been
- According to a study conducted by the Planning Commission on employment generation during the Eighth Five-Year Plan period (1992–97), the employment growth rate in the organised sector during the first two years of the plan period was only 0.36 percent as against the target of 2.6 percent.
- The Twenty-Point Programme was launched in 1975.
- Part IV of the Constitution, which contains the Directive Principles of State Policy, mentions Panchayati Raj (Article 40).
- The First Five-Year Plan was presented in Parliament by Pt.
- The correct matching is as follows: List-I List-II (Name of city) ■(Period in which the city was planned) Kanchipuram – Ancient Period Jaisalmer – Medieval Period Kodaikanal – Colonial Period Bhilai – Post-Independence Period Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990 The journal Yojana is published by the Publications Division under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, Government of India.

## Money and Banking

- According to the recommendations of the Working Group on Money Supply under the chairmanship of Dr.
- In India, the money multiplier is measured as the ratio of broad money (M3) to reserve money (M0 or Rm).
- Black money refers to money on which income tax has not been paid, causing loss of revenue to the government treasury.
- On 8 November 2016, under a historic announcement, the government demonetised the two highest denomination notes of Rs.
- Paper currency in India was first introduced by the Bank of Hindustan (1770–1832), the General Bank of Bengal and Bihar (1773–75; established by Warren Hastings), and the Bengal Bank (1784–91).
- The decimal currency system was introduced in India in 1957.
- The Reserve Bank of India has the authority to print currency notes up to Rs.

- In place of the proportional reserve system for note issue, the Minimum Reserve System was adopted in the year 1956, under which a fund of Rs.
- In India, the exclusive authority to mint coins belongs to the Government of India, that is, the Ministry of Finance, under the Coinage Act.
- In India, mints are located at Mumbai, Kolkata and Hyderabad.
- A falling inflation rate means that the rate of increase in prices (the annual increase) has decreased compared to the same period last year.
- The main effect of inflation is that the purchasing power of money falls.
- Bottleneck inflation occurs when supply decreases dramatically while demand remains at the same level.
- Inflation, calculated using the consumer Price Index (CPI), which also includes fluctuations in food and fuel prices, is called “headline inflation”.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was taken as the correct answer because at that time inflation in India was generally measured on the basis of the Wholesale Price Index.
- The Consumer Price Index (CPI) measures changes in the prices of a basket of goods and services.
- The consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers (CPI-IW) has been compiled by the Labour Bureau since 1944.
- For its employees, the Central Government determines dearness allowance in order to offset the impact of rising prices.
- In India, dearness allowance of employees is determined on the basis of the Consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers (CPI-IW).
- In India, the data relating to the Wholesale Price Index is released by the Office of the Economic Adviser under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
- In the measurement of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI), the share of manufactured products is the highest.
- At the time of the question, the new Wholesale Price Index (WPI) series was introduced on September 14, 2010, with the base year 2004-05 instead of 1993-94.
- The Producer Price Index (PPI) is an aggregate index that measures the average change in the prices of goods and services at the producer level.
- In India, life insurance companies were nationalized in 1956, and general insurance companies in 1973.
- Keeping the rate of interest low is helpful in controlling deflation.
- The All India Rural Credit Survey Committee, also known as the A.D.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) As per the announcement made by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman with the objective of boosting the economy, 10 public sector banks were merged into 4 banks with effect from April 1, 2020.
- In India, the EASE Index is a method of assessing the performance of Public Sector Banks (PSBs).
- Banks in which the government has at least 51 percent shareholding are called public sector banks.
- At the time of the question, except Bank of Punjab, the banks in all the remaining three options were nationalized public sector banks.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 947 The Industrial Credit and Investment Corporation of India (ICICI) was established in 1955 as a joint venture of the World Bank, public-sector banks of India and public-sector insurance companies.
- State Bank of India (SBI), with a one-fourth (1/4) market share among Indian banks, is India’s largest commercial bank.
- State Bank of India formed Farmers’ Clubs to reach farmers easily.
- At the time of the question, option (a) was the answer.
- In September 2015, State Bank of India launched the ‘SimplyCLICK Credit Card’ in partnership with seven major companies in India’s e-commerce sector Amazon India, BookMyShow, Cleartrip, FabFurnish, Food Panda, Lenskart and Ola.
- State Bank of India was the first Indian bank to open a branch in China in 2006.
- Among private-sector banks, Axis Bank was the first to establish a branch in Shanghai, China.
- ICICI Bank Limited, one of India’s largest private-sector banks, introduced the first mobile ATM service in Mumbai in December 2002.
- Establishment of ICICI – January 1955 Establishment of IDBI – July 1964 Establishment of IFCI – July 1948 All three institutions mentioned above provide long-term and medium-term financial assistance to the industrial sector.
- The correct matching is as follows– Bank Type Indian Bank – Public Sector ICICI Bank – Private Sector Citibank – Foreign Saraswat Bank – Co-operative

- As on March 31, 2025, among foreign banks in India, Standard Chartered Bank of the United Kingdom had the highest number of branches (100), followed by HSBC Ltd.
- First phase of nationalisation of banks – July 1969; Establishment of Regional Rural Banks – October 1975; Second phase of nationalisation of banks – April 1980; Establishment of NABARD – July 1982.
- The years of establishment of the given items are as follows– State Bank of India – 1955 Lead Bank Scheme – 1969 Regional Rural Banks – 1975 NABARD – 1982
- The Lead Bank Scheme (LBS) was introduced by the Reserve Bank of India in December 1969.
- The Small Industries Development Bank of India, or SIDBI, is a major development financial institution of India.
- The headquarters of the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) is in Lucknow, not in Mumbai.
- Financial inclusion means access to financial services for all sections of society.
- The objectives of financial inclusion include expanding financial services for the poor population, opening avenues of potential growth for the weaker sections, and expanding financial services in rural areas.
- According to the Rangarajan Committee constituted on financial inclusion, 'financial inclusion is the process through which financial services are made available at the right time and in adequate measure to the disadvantaged sections of society and low-income groups at low cost.' Low income, illiteracy, and lack of bank's branches all three are obstacles to the success of the process of financial inclusion.
- In recent years, special attention has been given to financial inclusion both in India and at the global level.
- C. Rangarajan was the chairman of the committee constituted on 'Financial Inclusion'.
- The Nachiket Mor Committee recommended the establishment of Payments Banks as a new banking framework to promote financial inclusion.
- The term 'shadow banking' was first used in the year 2007 by economist Paul McCulley.
- In the year 2010-11, in view of the reports of unfair practices adopted by microfinance institutions for the recovery of loans and the suicides committed by some farmers due to these practices, the Reserve Bank of India constituted a committee under the chairmanship of Y.H.
- Except the credit given by banks to farmers, the other three are liabilities of banks.
- Deposits form the most important component of the liabilities of commercial banks in India.
- According to the Reserve Bank of India, if interest and/or the instalment of the principal amount on a loan given by commercial banks remains overdue for a period of more than 90 days from the scheduled due date, it is called a NonPerforming Asset (NPA).
- Basel norms are related to giving an international framework to banking and financial institutions.
- The 'Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation' (DICGC) is governed by the Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation Act, 1961 and the Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation General Regulations, 1961, which were framed by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) by exercising the powers conferred under subsection (3) of Section 50 of the said Act.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the apex bank of India.
- In India, the financial agent and adviser to the Government in monetary and financial matters is the Reserve Bank of India.
- Treasury Bills were first issued in India in the year 1917.
- The Reserve Bank of India was established on April 1, 1935, in Calcutta, presently Kolkata, under the provisions of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.
- The Reserve Bank of India issues notes of all denominations except the one-rupee currency note.
- The function of credit creation is performed by commercial banks, while the remaining functions mentioned in the question are performed by the Reserve Bank of India.
- Monetary policy is complementary to fiscal policy.
- Equitable distribution of income and assets is not an objective of monetary policy.
- At the time of the question, monetary policy in India was formulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- In India, 'money and credit' are controlled by the Reserve Bank of India.
- The first three options given in the question are methods of quantitative credit control, while the last option (d) is a method of selective credit control.
- Under 'Open Market Operations' (OMO), the Reserve Bank of India buys and sells government securities and treasury bills.
- In July 2020, with the objective of boosting domestic demand, attracting investors and giving momentum to the sluggish economy, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) conducted 'Operation Twist'.

- To control inflation in the economy, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), under monetary policy, increases the Bank Rate, increases reserve ratios such as CRR and SLR, and sells securities in the open market.
- Every bank is required to keep a certain percentage of its demand and time deposits, as determined by the Reserve Bank, in the form of cash, gold, approved securities and foreign assets.
- PLR is not determined by the Reserve Bank of India.
- According to the Reserve Bank of India, commercial banks are required to keep a certain portion of their Net Demand and Time Liabilities, that is, deposits, as cash balances or as deposits with the RBI.
- Scheduled banks are required to keep a fixed percentage of their deposits with the Reserve Bank of India as the Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR).
- The Reserve Bank of India announces an increase in the Cash Reserve Ratio to reduce the credit-creation capacity of commercial banks.
- When a person or an institution sells a security to someone with an agreement or option to buy it back after a fixed period, it is generally called a repo or repurchase option.
- The repurchase option, i.e., repo rate, is used and regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for credit regulation in the money market.
- The rate of interest at which the RBI lends short-term funds to commercial banks is called the ‘repo rate’.
- The reverse repo rate is the opposite of the repo rate.
- Bank Rate is the rate at which the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) rediscounts the bills of commercial banks.
- * Raja J. Chelliah was never the Governor of the RBI.
- Between June 2010 and June 2011, there was a difference of 1.00% between the repo rate and the reverse repo rate.
- At the time of the question, option (c) is the correct answer.
- The tenures of the RBI Governors given in the question are as follows: Governor Tenure Dr.
- At the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- The Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881, was passed in December 1881, but it came into force on March 1, 1882.
- On March 1, 2015, the International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) was established at GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat.
- The Industrial Finance Corporation of India (IFCI) is a public-sector non-banking financial company that functions as a development bank.
- Institution Establishment Year Industrial Credit and Investment – 1955 Corporation of India (ICICI) Industrial Development Bank of India (IDBI) – 1964 Industrial Finance Corporation of India (IFCI) – 1948 Small Industries Development Bank of India – 1990 (SIDBI)
- SAIL (Steel Authority of India Limited) is a marketing institution, whereas SEBI in the capital market, SIDBI in the MSME sector and NABARD in agricultural credit are apex institutions in their respective fields.
- State Bank of India is a commercial bank and not an apex institution, whereas State Cooperative Bank, SIDBI and NABARD are apex institutions in their respective fields.
- The Malhotra Committee, constituted in 1993 under the chairmanship of R.N.
- The term Actuaries is related to the insurance sector.
- In India, provident fund is contractual saving.
- In India, the importance of pension funds has gradually declined, because venture businesses usually depend on their capital providers and banks generally want to invest in their associate institutions.
- In India, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) regulates mutual funds.
- Private-sector mutual funds were permitted in India in the year 1993, and ‘Kothari Pioneer’ (now merged with Franklin Templeton), registered in July 1993, was the first private-sector mutual fund.
- The Unit Trust of India was established on February 1, 1964 under the UTI Act, 1963, with the objective of utilizing the small savings of the lower- and middle-income groups of the country for industrial development.
- The National Stock Exchange of India was established in 1992 on the recommendation of the Pherwani Committee.
- The sensitive index of the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) is popularly known as the Sensex.
- Up to March 2014, the number of companies in the Bombay Stock Exchange Greenex Index (BSE-GREENEX Index) was 25, and even at present, the number of companies included in this index is
- The Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) is located at Dalal Street, Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- Bull and Bear are terms related to the stock market.

- In the Indian stock exchange, four types of speculators operate, namely – Bull, Bear, Stag and Lame Duck.
- Insider trading is related to the stock market.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999 IDBI, ICICI and Money Market Mutual Funds are parts of the money market, whereas the Reserve Bank of India is not a part of the money market.
- 'Commercial Paper' is a source of credit for the corporate sector.
- Blue-chip shares refer to the shares of companies that have a wide product range, high-quality management, and consistently provide high earnings and dividends.
- In the 'gilt-edged' market, government and semi-government securities are bought and sold.
- Sensex, BSE and Nifty are related to the stock market, whereas SAPs – Structural Adjustment Programmes – were meant to correct a country's economic and financial imbalances.
- 'Nikkei' or 'Nikkei 225' is the stock price index of the Tokyo Stock Exchange.
- Crude oil prices are related to the 'Brent Index'.
- Land Development Bank is a part of the cooperative credit structure.
- The structure of cooperative banks in India is three-tier.
- Consumer cooperative stores are established by their members, while their registration is done by the Registrar of Cooperative Societies.
- The nodal agency for the implementation of the 'Rural Infrastructure Development Fund' (RIDF), established in 1995-96, is NABARD.
- The first five Regional Rural Banks were established in India on 2 October 1975.
- * Except taking over the functions of the Agricultural Refinance Corporation of India, all the other functions mentioned in the question are performed by Regional Rural Banks.
- NABARD, i.e., National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development, was established in July 1982.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development)
- Institutions/Programmes Year of Establishment NABARD – 1982 Self-Help Group–Bank Linkage Programme – 1992–93 Kisan Credit Card Scheme – 1998 Regional Rural Banks – 1975
- The Self-Help Group–Bank Linkage Programme was started by NABARD in 1992–93 with the objective of providing microfinance.
- In the 1990s, two committees were formed under the chairmanship of M.
- The Raghuram Rajan Committee (2007-2008), commissioned by India's planning commission, produced the landmark report "A Hundred Small Steps," offering a comprehensive roadmap for financial sector reforms.
- The Reserve Bank of India constituted a high-level panel under the leadership of former RBI Governor Vimal Jalan for the detailed scrutiny of applications for granting licences to new banks.
- In 2007, a Working Group was constituted to revise the series of the Wholesale Price Index of commodities, and Professor Abhijit Sen was appointed its Chairman.
- The objective of the 'Swabhiman' programme, launched on 10 February 2011 for financial inclusion, is to provide banking facilities in rural areas without bank branches.
- The Kisan Credit Card scheme was announced in the Budget of 1998-99, while it was launched in August 1998.
- CRISIL, CARE and ICRA—all three operate as credit rating agencies in India.
- Credit Rating Agency Year of Establishment CARE – 1993 ICRA – 1991 CRISIL – 1987 Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.
- CRISIL is a global credit rating agency which evaluates the creditworthiness of companies as well as economies.
- The term 'Smart Money' is used for credit cards.
- Plastic Money is an alternative to cash, with the help of which goods and services are purchased.
- A credit card issued by a nationalized bank is not a prepaid payment instrument.
- In financial transactions through electronic means, PIN means Personal Identification Number.
- The market is an economic tendency which creates an inclination towards consumerism.
- A market where sellers are more than buyers is called a buyer's market.
- A very short-term market is suitable for vegetable crops.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 963 When total product is constant, marginal product is zero.
- There is a direct relationship between the demand for a commodity and its price, whereas there is an inverse relationship between the supply of a commodity and its price.
- An increase in prices benefits the trader class and harms the consumer class.

- Sales – Variable Cost Sales Change in Profit Fixed Cost + Profit or or Change in Sales Sales The profit-volume ratio can be improved in the following ways – by increasing the selling price, by reducing marginal or variable cost, and by giving more emphasis to those products which have a higher profit-volume ratio.
- The concept of imputed price/shadow price, which is used for the evaluation of capital investment proposals, was propounded by J.
- The legal definition of MRP (Maximum Retail Price) makes it clear that it is the maximum price at which a packaged commodity can be sold to the consumer.
- Trade is a concept under which activities related to the purchase and sale of goods are included.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) A condition is a stipulation essential to the main purpose of the contract; therefore, Assertion (A) is correct.
- Commerce is a broad concept under which the buying and selling of goods and services, i.e.
- Accounting is called the language of business.

## Human Development

- The law of the three stages of social development is an idea developed in the book 'The Course in Positive Philosophy' by the French sociologist Auguste Comte.
- According to the Economic Survey 2018–19, the basic dimensions of the SDG goals are closely interrelated with education and health, and this is reflected in the positive relationship between the HDI and SDG rankings of Indian states.
- The most appropriate assessment of the Physical Quality of Life is life expectancy, infant mortality rate and literacy.
- The Physical Quality of Life Index (PQLI) was developed by Morris D.
- The United Nations Human Development Index (HDI) was developed for the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) under the able guidance of the famous Pakistani economist Mahbub-ul-Haq.
- UNDP's first 'Human Development Report' was published in 1990, in which the first version of HDI was included.
- The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) first focused attention on the human aspect of development.
- Under the Human Development Index, the health dimension is assessed on the basis of life expectancy at birth, the education dimension on the basis of mean years of schooling and expected years of schooling, and the standard of living dimension on the basis of Gross National Income per capita in PPP dollars.
- Human development means expanding the richness of human life rather than only the prosperity of the economy.
- According to the Human Development Report, 2021-22, India's Human Development Index (HDI) rank declined from 130 for the year 2020 to 132 for the year 2021, not for 2022.
- When more children go to school and adult literacy improves, the education index under the Human Development Index will improve, and only then will India be able to secure a higher rank in the Human Development Index prepared by UNDP.
- In the Human Development Report of 1996, the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) described the path of economic development of developing countries as 'jobless', 'rootless', 'ruthless', 'voiceless' and 'futureless'.
- On the initiative of the then King of Bhutan, Jigme Singye Wangchuck, Bhutan chose Gross National Happiness (GNH) as an indicator of progress in 1972.
- There is a positive correlation in the ranking of Indian states based on the Human Development Index (HDI) and Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).
- At the time of the question, as well as with reference to the year 2019, option (b) is the correct answer.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- Kerala ranks first in the country in terms of the Human Development Index.
- According to the India Human Development Report (IHDR), 2011, among the given states, Uttar Pradesh had the highest Human Development Index in 2008, ranking 18th.

## Employment & Welfare Schemes

- The Aspirational Districts Programme (ADP) of NITI Aayog was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in January, 2018.
- Under Ayushman Bharat–Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY), there is a provision to provide health insurance coverage of up to Rs.

- The Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana, launched under the Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008, covers only workers of the unorganised sector.
- Except option (a), all the remaining three options are correct.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017 Under the National Rural Health Mission, launched by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, from 12 April, 2005, the trained community health worker is called 'ASHA' (Accredited Social Health Activist).
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993 The National Health Policy was announced in the year 1983 by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- According to the National Family Health Survey-3 (NFHS3) (2005–06), the private medical sector was the main source of health care for about 70 percent of households in urban areas and about 63 percent of households in rural areas.
- At the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- Shabari Sankalp Abhiyan is related to the National Nutrition Mission, now Mission Poshan 2.0.
- The Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) Scheme, launched on 2 October, 1975, is a flagship programme of the Government of India.
- Under the Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) Scheme, there is no provision for the distribution of free books and school uniforms to children.
- Programme Starting Year National Programme for Control of Blindness – 1976 Integrated Child Development Scheme – 1975 National Leprosy Eradication Programme – 1983 National Rural Health Mission – 2005
- Correct matching is as follows— Schemes Starting Year Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Package 2020 Muskaan Scheme 2021 Mission Indradhanush 2014 Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana 2018 Thus, option (c) is the correct answer.
- Among the given schemes, all except 'STRIDE' are related to skill development.
- The 'Skill Development Initiative' was launched by the Ministry of Labour and Employment in May, 2007.
- The Skill India Mission was launched by the Prime Minister in July, 2015.
- Under the Union Budget 2023-24, it was announced that 30 'Skill India International Centres' would be set up across different states to skill youth for international opportunities.
- On 3 July, 2017, the foundation stone of India's largest Global Skill Park was laid in Bhopal.
- In 2014, the United Nations General Assembly declared 15 July as 'World Youth Skills Day'.
- Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) is a flagship initiative of NITI Aayog, launched with the objective of promoting innovation and entrepreneurship in India.
- The Department of Science and Technology has launched NIDHI (National Initiative for Developing and Harnessing Innovations) to transform ideas and innovations into successful start-ups.
- Pradhan Mantri Sahaj Bijli Har Ghar Yojana 'Saubhagya' was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2017.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 'Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana' (PMJDY) is a national mission for financial inclusion in India, whose objective is to provide banking facilities to all households across the country and to ensure that every household has a bank account.
- Scheme Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana Beginning 28 August, 2014 Digital Gender Atlas for Advancing 9 March, 2015 Girls' Education in India Mudra Bank Yojana 8 April, 2015 Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana 9 May, 2015
- In 2015, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, Government of India, was given a certificate by the Guinness Book of World Records for its 'PAHAL' scheme as the world's largest Direct Benefit Transfer cash transfer scheme.
- To provide clean fuel (LPG) to poor families living below the poverty line, Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the 'Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana' (PMUY) on 1 May 2016, from Ballia district of Uttar Pradesh with the tagline 'Clean Fuel, Better Life'.
- The 'Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao' scheme was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 22 January 2015 in Panipat, Haryana.
- In February 2025, as an important step towards promoting women entrepreneurship in the Northeast, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE), in collaboration with NITI Aayog, launched 'Swavalambini'—a women entrepreneurship programme— in Assam, Meghalaya and Mizoram.
- The Swavalamban Programme, which was earlier known as the NORAD/Women's Economic Programme, was launched throughout the country in the year 1982–83.

- In the year 2010, the Government of India launched the ‘Swavalamban Yojana’ for workers in the unorganized sector.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) ‘Swadhar’ Scheme is a scheme sponsored by the Ministry of Women and Child Development, Government of India, for the benefit of women living in difficult circumstances.
- In order to make women self-help groups (SHGs) economically strong across India, the Union Cabinet approved major changes in the National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM), keeping in view the objective of poverty eradication and the empowerment of village women.
- The Mahila Samakhya Programme was started in the year 1988, not in 1989.
- Mahila Samriddhi Yojana was launched in India by the Department of Women and Child Development, Government of India, on October 2, 1993.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 975 Under the National Rural Health Mission (NRHM), the centrally sponsored Janani Suraksha Yojana was launched on April 12, 2005, to encourage institutional deliveries among women belonging to families living below the poverty line.
- Janani Suraksha Yojana was launched on April 12, 2005, under the National Rural Health Mission (NRHM).
- The name of the ambitious scheme launched by the Government of India on 1 June, 2011 to provide free health care facilities to pregnant women and infants is ‘JananiShishu Suraksha Karyakram’.
- The Integrated Rural Energy Programme (IREP) is mainly a programme focused on renewable energy to meet the minimum domestic needs of rural groups in selected villages of each district for cooking, heating and lighting purposes, whereas the Integrated Rural Development Programme and the Development of Women and Children in Rural Areas Programme are income-generating programmes for women.
- The Government of India started the ‘Accelerated Rural Water Supply Programme’ (ARWSP) in 1972-73.
- The ‘Jal Jeevan Mission’ scheme was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 15 August, 2019.
- The Shyama Prasad Mukherji Rurban Mission was launched in February, 2016 and not in the year 2015.
- AMRUT, or Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 25 June, 2015 in New Delhi.
- • ■ Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JNNURM) – started on December 3, 2005.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021 In December 2015, the ‘Accessible India Campaign’ was launched as a nationwide campaign by the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment to provide universal accessibility for persons with disabilities.
- Sangam Yojana was launched on August 15, 1996.
- The ‘Sankalp’ project is related to the elimination of HIV/ AIDS.
- The main objective of the Pradhan Mantri Gramodaya Yojana, started in the year 2000-01, is to fulfill the basic needs of rural people, such as primary education, health care, drinking water, housing, roads, etc., within a fixed time period.
- The Etawah Pilot Project for rural development was conceived in the year 1947, but it was started in September 1948.
- l Community Development Programme (CDP): It was started on 2 October, 1952.
- In the year 1995-96, the Government of India established the Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF) under NABARD with an initial corpus of Rs.
- The Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF) was created in the year 1995-96 under NABARD.
- The Rural Infrastructure Development Fund was established in the year 1995-96 for financing rural infrastructure.
- The Integrated Rural Development Programme (IRDP) was first started on a pilot basis in the year 1978-79 and was implemented throughout the country from 2 October, 1980.
- JRY (Jawahar Rozgar Yojana) was started on 1 April, 1989.
- The Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (SGSY), launched on April 1, 1999, merged six earlier ongoing schemes.
- Scheme/Programme Pradhan Mantri Gramodaya Yojana Starting Year 2000–2001 Rural Employment Generation Programme 1995 Pradhan Mantri Rozgar Yojana 1993 Valmiki Ambedkar Awas Yojana 2001 Thus, option (d) is the correct answer.
- Programme Starting Year Integrated Rural 1980 (on a small scale in Development Programme 1978) Swarn Jayanti Gram 1999 Swarozgar Yojana Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment 2006 Guarantee Act Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan 2014 Yojana Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

- Correct matching is as follows— Scheme Agricultural Labour Social Security Scheme Swarn Jayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana Employment Assurance Scheme Pradhan Mantri Gramodaya Yojana Year 2001 1999 1993 2000
- Swaranjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (SGSY) was launched on April 1, 1999 as an integrated programme to provide self-employment opportunities to the rural poor.
- Scheme/Programme Launch Year National Rural Health Mission 2005 National Social Assistance Programme 1995 Swarn Jayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana 1999 Sampoorna Gramin Rozgar Yojana 2001
- Janshree Bima Yojana was launched on August 10, 2000.
- Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (RMSA) was launched by the Government of India in March 2009 to increase access to secondary education and improve its quality.
- The Bill related to the National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (NREGS) was passed by Parliament in 2005 and it came into force on February 2, 2006.
- The National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme was launched on February 2, 2006 at Bandlapalli village in Anantapur district, Andhra Pradesh.
- Among the given options, the budget allocations under Budget Estimates 2019-20 and Budget Estimates 2020-21, along with the amounts allocated in the recent two years, i.e., 2025-26 and 2026-27, are as follows (in ■ crore)– Scheme 2019–20 2020–21 2025–26 2025–26 2026–27 (B.E.) (B.E.) (B.E.) (R.E.) (B.E.) MGNREGA 60000 61500 86000 88000 30000* Ayushman# 6556 6429 9406 9000 9500 Mid-Day Meal Scheme* 11000 11000 12500 10600 12750 National Ganga Scheme 750 800 3400 2687 3100 # Ayushman Bharat–Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana * PM POSHAN Scheme From the above data, it is clear that if the Budget Estimates 2019-20 are compared with the Budget Estimates 2020-21, then except for the Ayushman Scheme, the allocation for all other schemes in 2020-21 was either increased or kept stable.
- According to the Union Budget 2023-24, in the context of allocation, a higher percentage cut than MGNREGA was made in the Atmanirbhar Bharat Rojgar Yojana, while a higher percentage increase was made in the Reform Linked Distribution Scheme than the allocation of the Jal Jeevan Mission.
- The National Rural Employment Guarantee Act did not guarantee 100 days of employment in a year to every adult member of a rural household; rather, it guaranteed 100 days of employment in a year to a rural household.
- The positive outcomes of MGNREGA include a substantial increase in the purchasing power of the rural poor, an increase in the bargaining power of labourers, and a reduction in migration towards cities.
- The Community Development Programme was started on 2 October, 1952.
- S.K. Dey is called the chief architect of Community Development in India.
- Retail traders/shopkeepers/self-employed persons whose annual turnover does not exceed Rs.
- The Central Government launched the ‘Aam Aadmi Bima Yojana’ on 2 October, 2007 to provide social security to all landless labourers belonging to rural households below the poverty line.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) The Unorganised Workers’ Social Security Act was passed by Parliament in the year 2008.
- The major social protection programmes in India include Aam Aadmi Bima Yojana, Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana, Unorganised Workers’ Social Security Act, 2008 and National Social Security Fund, etc.; whereas Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rozgar Yojana is an employmentgeneration programme.
- The Skill Development Programme is related to the system of vocational education and training, whereas the remaining three options are programmes adopted under social protection schemes.
- The employment generation and poverty alleviation programmes of the Government of India include the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, National Rural Livelihood Mission and Swarna Jayanti Shahari Rozgar Yojana, whereas the objective of the National Social Security Fund, constituted in July 2011, is to support schemes run for workers of the unorganised sector.
- The correct matching is as follows: Social Security Contribution of the Programme Beneficiary Pradhan Mantri Shram ■55 – ■200 per month Yogi Maan-dhan Yojana Pradhan Mantri Jeevan ■436 per year Jyoti Bima Yojana Pradhan Mantri Suraksha ■20 per year Bima Yojana Atal Pension Yojana As opted by the beneficiary Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.
- Name of Scheme Launch Year Swachh Bharat Mission 2014 Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana 2015 Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana 2016 Pradhan Mantri Mahila Shakti Kendra Yojana 2017 Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.
- Except option (d), all other options are correctly matched, because the ‘Swachh Bharat Mission’ is not related to safe drinking water; rather, it is related to ‘Universal Sanitation’.
- The Swachh Bharat Abhiyan was launched on October 2, 2014.

- The Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation, Ministry of Jal Shakti, Government of India, launched the 10-year (2019-2029) Rural Sanitation Strategy on September 27, 2019.
- The Swachh Bharat Mission was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on October 2, 2014.
- In Swachh Survekshan, 2021, in the category of cities with a population of more than one lakh, Indore (Madhya Pradesh) was awarded the title of India's cleanest city for the fifth consecutive year under Swachh Survekshan, while Surat and Vijayawada secured the second and third positions, respectively.
- In the context of states having more than 100 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), Uttar Pradesh obtained the sixth rank in Swachh Survekshan, 2021.
- Even today, the rural population does not consider open defecation a threat to health.
- Nirmal Bharat Abhiyan Scheme was formerly known as the Total Sanitation Campaign.
- To give further momentum to the implementation of the total Sanitation Campaign, the Government of India launched a scheme called 'Nirmal Gram Puraskar' in October, 2003.
- In view of the prevention of infectious diseases, the government is emphasizing the toilet construction programme and is providing government assistance through grants and loans for the construction of flush toilets in villages and towns.
- The Government of India has been implementing the Integrated Low Cost Sanitation (ILCS) Scheme since 1980.
- The National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP) was launched by the Government of India on 15 August, 1995.
- The 'Minimum Needs Programme', sponsored by the Government of India, was launched in the year 1975.
- Except social forestry, all the remaining programmes given in the options were included under the Minimum Needs Programme.
- Liberalization of the economy is a method adopted for economic reform.
- Rajiv Awas Yojana was launched in June 2011 and was extended up to the year 2022.
- The Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalaya scheme was launched by the Government of India in August 2004 for establishing residential upper primary schools for girls belonging to Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Other Backward Classes, minorities, families of sex workers, manual scavengers, etc., in educationally backward blocks where female literacy was low and the gender gap in literacy was above the national average.
- Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA) was started by the Government of India in the year 2001.
- The Saakshar Bharat Programme was started in September 2009 by restructuring the National Literacy Mission.
- The Right to Education Act, 2009 came into force on 1 April 2010, under which education for children in the age group of 6–14 years was made free and compulsory.
- India adopted the 'Look East Policy' to enhance trade relations with South-East Asian countries.
- From 15 August 1995, the 'National Programme of Nutritional Support to Primary Education' (NP-NSPE) was launched in support of primary education.
- In 2021, the name of the 'Mid-Day Meal Scheme' was changed to 'Pradhan Mantri Poshan Shakti Nirman' (PMPOSHAN) Scheme.
- The Mid-Day Meal Scheme, now 'PM-POSHAN', was started in the year 1995 as a centrally sponsored scheme.
- The Mid-Day Meal Scheme is not started and managed by a contractor, whereas all the remaining options are involved in it.
- The 'Akshaya Patra Foundation' is an Indian nongovernmental organization (NGO), established in the year 2000 in Bengaluru, Karnataka.
- The 'School Chalo Abhiyan' (Go to school campaign) for the elementary education of all children in the age group of 6–14 years was started in Uttar Pradesh in July, 2000.
- The Kalp Yojana, started by the Government of Uttar Pradesh in the year 1998, was related to primary education.
- The implementation of the Shiksha Mitra Yojana was started in the year 2000–2001 to fulfil both the above objectives.
- The District Primary Education Programme was launched in the year 1994 with the objectives of making primary education universally accessible, reducing the dropout rate, reducing social and gender disparity, and enhancing children's practical understanding.
- The Prarambhik Shiksha Kosh was constituted by the Central Government in the year 2005 for collecting revenue received from the education cess.
- Operation Blackboard, started in the year 1987, aimed to provide minimum essential facilities and services in all primary schools of the country.
- The scheme 'Inclusive Education for Disabled at Secondary Stage' (IEDSS) was started in the year 2009–10.

- The correct matching is as follows– Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan – Saakshar Bharat Mission – Operation Blackboard – National Literacy Mission – 2001 2009 1987 1988
- In June 2013, the then Union Rural Development Minister Jairam Ramesh launched a new skill development and training programme named ‘Roshni’ for rural tribal youth in Naxal-affected districts.
- Under the Ministry of Minority Affairs, the ‘Nalanda Project’ is meant for minority higher educational institutions.
- The Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act was passed in the year 1976.
- The Council for Advancement of People’s Action and Rural Technology, i.e.
- ‘Aadhaar’, promoted by the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI), is a programme for providing identity to Indian citizens.
- In September 2010, the village ‘Tembhli’ in Nandurbar district of Maharashtra was in the news because the muchawaited ‘Aadhaar Project’ of the Unique Identification Authority of India was first launched from there.
- The concept of ‘PURA’ (Providing Urban Amenities in Rural Areas) was first presented by former President Dr.
- The Prime Minister’s Shram Awards are given by the Ministry of Labour and Employment, Government of India.
- The National Handicapped Finance and Development Corporation, now known as the National Divyangjan Finance and Development Corporation (NDFDC), was established by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India, on 24 February, 1997.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) To deal effectively with various problems of persons with disabilities, national institutions have been established in each major field of disability.
- India’s first open university was established in Hyderabad, then in Andhra Pradesh and now in Telangana, in August, 1982, and was named after Dr.
- ‘Tarun Bharat Sangh’ is a voluntary organization founded by Dr.

## Poverty & Unemployment

- The International Day for the Eradication of Poverty, 2022 was observed on 17 October, 2022.
- Poverty means the inability to access basic necessities; that is, when a person is unable to fulfil even his/her fundamental needs, he/she is called poor.
- At the ‘World Summit for Social Development’ held in Copenhagen, Denmark, in 1995, the United Nations defined poverty in two forms absolute poverty and overall poverty.
- The Poverty Line represents the minimum level of consumption/income in a society/country that is considered necessary to fulfil ‘basic needs’.
- Social indicators are those aspects that show the social dimensions of poverty; such as illiteracy, low general immunity due to malnutrition, lack of health services, lack of access to safe drinking water and sanitation, and lack of employment opportunities, etc.
- ‘The Challenge of World Poverty’ is a work by Gunnar Myrdal.
- Cumulative % of Income (4 5 In the year 1977, a Task Force on ‘Minimum Needs Programme and Effective Consumption Demand’ was constituted under the chairmanship of Dr.
- The Lorenz Curve was developed by the American economic statistician Dr.
- ua The then Planning Commission had constituted an expert group for calculating the population living below the poverty line, which used the data on household consumption expenditure collected by the National Sample Survey Office (NSSO) for poverty estimation.
- The Government of India constituted a committee to set new standards for the estimation of population living below the poverty line.
- 11. of 8. Poverty in India has been defined in terms of [
- B 60 80 20 0 *UPPSC Question Papers 20 40 Cumulative % of Households 100 993
- The concept of the ‘Culture of Poverty’ was propounded by the American anthropologist Oscar Lewis.
- The noted economist Ragnar Nurkse, in his book ‘Problems of Capital Formation in Underdeveloped Countries’ published in 1953, discussed the concept of the ‘Vicious Cycle of Poverty’ and expressed the view that poor countries remain poor because of the vicious cycle of poverty.
- In India, the erstwhile Planning Commission was the nodal agency for determining the poverty line at the national and state levels.
- Since the time of the Sixth Five Year Plan, the Planning Commission has been estimating poverty at the national and state levels.

- For the identification of poor people living in urban areas, an expert committee was constituted in 2010 under the chairmanship of Prof.
- Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason clearly explains the assertion.
- In India, both the rich and the poor are malnourished because the poor have very limited options for obtaining nutrition, while the rich consume excessive or unhealthy food.
- According to the data released by the Planning Commission in March 2012, in the year 2009–10, the proportion of poor people in the country was 29.8 percent of the total population.
- According to the survey by the National Council of Applied Economic Research, among the given states, Bihar had the maximum percentage of population below the poverty line.
- The backwardness of Bihar state is due to its social, economic and political conditions.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 995 According to the report on poverty published by the Planning Commission in 1999-2000, the highest poverty ratio was in Odisha (47.1%).
- On the basis of both the Tendulkar methodology and the Rangarajan methodology, among the given states, the lowest percentage of population below the poverty line in 2011–12 was in Himachal Pradesh.
- During the reference period of the question, according to the official poverty percentage data of 2009–10, among the given options, the state with the lowest poverty percentage was Goa.
- The poverty ratio of the states mentioned in the question, according to the data of 2009-10 and –12, is as follows: State Year 2009-10 Year 2011-12 Kerala 12.0 7.05 Punjab 15.9 8.26 Andhra Pradesh 21.1 9.20 Gujarat 23.0 16.63
- According to the India State Hunger Index (ISHI), which was published in 2008, the condition of Madhya Pradesh was the worst in India.
- No clear determination of the extent of poverty in India could be made.
- In the 1960s, the Public Distribution System was started as a price support programme.
- Among the given programmes, IRDP (Integrated Rural Development Programme) was started on 2 October, 1980; TRYSEM (Training of Rural Youth for Self-Employment) was started on 15 August, 1979; and NREP (National Rural Employment Programme) was started in October, 1980.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) has identified two categories of poverty–
- According to UNDP, a comprehensive estimate of a person’s poverty cannot be made merely by measuring his/her income.
- The Global MPI (Multidimensional Poverty Index) is a major international measure, which measures acute multidimensional poverty in more than 100 developing countries.
- In the year 2010, the ‘Global Multidimensional Poverty Index’ (MPI) was developed by the ‘Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative’ (OPHI) in collaboration with UNDP.
- It is based on ten indicators under three dimensions.
- Inadequate growth rate, high population growth rate and unemployment are responsible for poverty, whereas a rising rate of investment is not responsible for poverty.
- Among the given options, except option (a), ‘limited means of transport’, all the remaining three options – level of illiteracy, lack of access to health care and lack of employment opportunities are social indicators of poverty.
- A large population in Indian villages, various religions, four castes and their sub-castes, diverse culture, level of sex ratio, etc.
- With a high rate of development, employment is also generated.
- In economics, the term hidden or disguised unemployment was first used by Mrs.
- In India, hidden or disguised unemployment is mainly found in the primary sector, i.e., agriculture and allied sectors.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 999 Unemployment found in rural areas of India is mainly of two types—
- Usual Status Unemployment— It shows the work status of a person during the last 365 days preceding the date of survey.
- For measuring unemployment in India, the NSSO, now a part of the NSO, adopts three methods— Usual Principal Status- A person is considered unemployed if, during the previous year, he/she was not working for a long period, i.e., 183 days or more, but was available for work or was seeking work.
- At the time of the question, data on unemployment in India were collected and published by the NSSO.
- Increase in per capita income is not responsible for unemployment, whereas rapid population growth, lack of skills and lack of manpower planning are factors responsible for unemployment.

- In the context of the time of the question, option (a) is the correct answer.

## International Trade

- In the long-term vision of the Department of Commerce, the aim was to make India a major partner in world trade by 2020 and to place it in a leadership role in line with India's growing importance in international trade organizations.
- In the context of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1001 In 2010-11, exports of goods and services from India were 22 percent of GDP.
- At the time of the question, and also according to the Economic Survey 2025-26, Asia is India's largest trade partner in overall trade.
- America 10.7% 25.51% North America 7.3% 22.04% Europe 13.1% 22.49% European Union 8.4% 17.33% At the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- Among the options given in the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- Among the options given in the question, in 2011 as well as in 2024-25, the pair of China and U.A.E.
- Singapore 12976 2.96 At the time of the question, and also according to the Economic Survey 2025-26, among the countries listed, India's largest trading partner in 2024-25 is the United States of America.
- At the time of the question, and according to the Economic Survey 2025-26, even in 2024-25 India had the highest favourable trade balance (exports more than imports) with the U.S.A.
- At the time of the question, option (c) was the correct answer.
- In 2009-10, the largest share in India's exports was that of the U.A.E.
- According to IMF Balance of Payments Manual 5, India's trade deficit had reached its highest level in FY 2012-13 at 195.66 billion U.S.
- The difference between the total value of exports and imports between two countries during a fixed period is called the balance of trade.
- The statement of all international economic transactions or dealings (all imports and exports) that generally take place during one year between the residents of a country and the residents of the rest of the world is called the Balance of Payments.
- Balance of Payments (BoP) includes visible trade, invisible trade and Borrowing.
- In a financial year, the sum of imports and exports of visible and invisible items is called the current account.
- At the time of the question, and even according to the Economic Survey 2025-26, among the given options the combined import of petroleum products and edible oils remains the most important item in India's imports.
- In the year 2004-05, following groups had important share in India's imports :
- At the time of the question, option (a) was correct.
- At the time of the question, and according to updated data as well, India receives the maximum LNG supply from Qatar.
- The importer first applies to the Reserve Bank of India for the required foreign exchange for imports.
- According to the Economic Survey 2025-26, exports of the given items in 2024-25 were as follows: • Engineering goods - 116.54 billion U.S.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was correct.
- From the above data, it is clear that for both 2023-24 and 2024-25, option (d) is the correct answer.
- For the question asked at that time, option (c) was correct.
- According to the Economic Survey 2007-08, the highest growth rate among the given years was in 2004-05 (30.8%).
- In economics, export of services is called invisible export.
- A tariff is a tax or duty imposed on goods when they enter or leave the national boundary.
- Duty-drawback is the full or partial refund of the customs or excise duty paid by exporters on goods imported for the purpose of export.
- The export performance of any country depends on the special qualities of the goods produced there.
- Under the foreign trade policy, the target was to achieve a 1.5 percent share in world trade by 2009; therefore, in the then context option (c) was correct.
- Registered exporters are classified in ascending order of export performance of previous years as Export House, Trading House, Star Trading House and Super Star Trading House.

- Globalization means unrestricted exchange of goods, services, capital and intellectual property between one country and other countries.
- Globalization is the process of increasing mutual relations and full integration among different countries.
- Globalization is related to foreign investment and large companies.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) Encouraging multinational companies in India is related to privatization, globalization, and liberalization.
- After the liberalization of economic policies in 1991, the share of agriculture in India GDP gradually declined.
- Free Trade Policy is a policy in which Absence of tariff of any kind is imposed on trade.
- To remove the defects arising from red tape and controls, the lack of world-class infrastructure, the difficulties caused by unstable economic conditions, and with the objective of attracting greater foreign investment into India, the Special Economic Zone policy was announced in April 2000.
- In India, the Special Economic Zone (SEZ) Act, 2005 was passed by Parliament in May 2005 and received the President assent on 23 June 2005.
- SEZs were established to attract domestic and foreign investment, not to discourage it.
- Among the above statements, 1, 2 and 3 are correct, whereas statement 4 is incorrect, because the mining of diamonds takes place in Panna district of Madhya Pradesh.
- Falta SEZ: In 1984, the Falta Export Processing Zone was established in South 24 Parganas district of West Bengal; later it was converted into a Special Economic Zone (SEZ).
- Export Processing Zones are being used as an effective instrument to promote the export of manufactured goods.
- During the relevant period, the highest growth rate of exports from Special Economic Zones was recorded in 2007-08, at about 93 per cent.
- During the period of the question, the highest number of approved and operational SEZs was in Andhra Pradesh.
- The mobile app named SEZ India was launched by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry on 6 January 2017.
- All the above four organizations influence India foreign trade (imports and exports).
- In the Union Budget of 1981-82, the establishment of the Export-Import Bank (Exim Bank) in India was announced, and the bank was formed in 1982.
- ECGC Limited (formerly Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India Limited) promotes foreign trade by covering the risks of export credit.
- Export Credit Guarantee Corporation Limited (formerly ECGC Ltd.) was established in 1957 under the name Export Risks Insurance Corporation (ERIC) to cover the credit risk related to the export of goods and services from the country.
- The India Brand Equity Foundation (IBEF) was established in 1996 by the Ministry of Commerce.
- The Marine Products Export Development Authority (MPEDA) was established in 1972 through an Act of Parliament.
- According to India Tourism Data Compendium, 2025 issued in September 2025, option (a) is still the correct answer.
- During the period of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.

## Foreign Exchange, FDI & External Debt

- During the period of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- Super 301 is a section of the American Trade and Competitiveness Act, 1988, under which the U.S.A.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development)
- A floating or flexible exchange rate is determined by market forces (demand and supply).
- Rupee convertibility means that the rupee can be exchanged into foreign currencies, and foreign currencies can be exchanged into rupees, freely and without any intervention.
- On 20 March 2006, the Reserve Bank of India appointed a six-member committee under the chairmanship of former Deputy Governor S.
- The devaluation of currency means a reduction in the value of the rupee in relation to foreign currencies.
- Due to devaluation, the value of a country currency falls in relation to foreign currencies.
- Devaluation means reducing the external value of a country currency.
- 4 2 2 3 1 4 U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024 In terms of remittances sent by migrants, the correct ranking of major countries in both 2022 and 2024 is as follows – Country Rank Mexico Second China Third India First Philippines Fourth

- During the period of the question, option (a) was the correct answer.
- According to the context of the question as well as updated data, there are adequate opportunities in all the sectors listed for absorbing foreign capital in the Indian market.
- Under SEBI, for those foreign investors who want to become part of the Indian stock market without directly buying the securities themselves, registered foreign portfolio investors issue participatory notes (P-notes).
- Through the Union Budget 2020-21, the limit of portfolio investment in outstanding corporate bonds was raised from 9% to 15%.
- During the financial years 2023-24 and 2024-25 (AprilMarch), Singapore remained the largest source of FDI in India.
- In the retail trading sector, FDI in India in respect of singlebrand products has been permitted since 2006, while in multi-brand retail FDI has been permitted since 2012.
- On 4 October 2012, the Government of India proposed increasing the ceiling of foreign direct investment (FDI) in the insurance sector from 26% to 49%.
- According to the New Small Industrial Policy announced by the Central Government in August 1991, a 24% limit for foreign equity investment in small industries was fixed.
- During the period of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- In India, external commercial borrowings (ECB) are regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- During the period of the question as well as at present, on the basis of the size and components of external debt, the World Bank has classified India as a low-indebted country.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) Green bonds are like other bonds issued at a fixed rate of interest.
- During Yashwant Sinha tenure as Finance Minister, under a decision, the Administered Price Mechanism in the oil sector was abolished from 1 April 2002.
- India foreign exchange reserves include foreign currency assets, gold, Special Drawing Rights (SDR), and the Reserve Position in the IMF.
- There are four important components of foreign exchange reserves – gold, Special Drawing Rights (SDR), Reserve Position in the IMF, and foreign currency assets.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1017 According to weekly statistics of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), at the end of the week ending 27 December 2024, India total foreign exchange reserves stood at 640.3 billion U.S.
- Former RBI Governor Dr. C. Rangarajan identified the following factors as determining the exchange value of the rupee – high interest rates, high fiscal deficit, and rising prices of crude oil.
- On the basis of the Maastricht Treaty, the new single European currency came into being, which was named the Euro.
- In 1999, the euro was issued as an electronic currency by the European Union.
- FEMA (Foreign Exchange Management Act) was brought in to make external trade and payments easier and to promote the development and stability of the foreign exchange market in India.
- For imports of good importers may obtain approval for the acquisition, foreign exchange can be obtained through banks authorized by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

## International Organizations

- The 18th G-20 Summit was organized in New Delhi under India presidency on 9-10 September 2023.
- At the 18th G-20 Summit, 2023 held in New Delhi, besides India Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the following leaders were present: Brazil President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva, Indonesia President Joko Widodo, Australia Prime Minister Anthony Albanese, Canada Prime Minister Justin Trudeau, Argentina President Alberto Fernandez, U.S.
- Under the auspices of UNESCO, the first World Summit for Social Development was held in Copenhagen (Denmark) from 6-12 March 1995.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) The correct matching is as follows – List-I List-II Human Development Report ■United Nations Development Programme World Economic Outlook ■International Monetary Fund World Investment Report ■United Nations Conference on Trade and Development Emission Gap Report ■United Nations Environment Programme
- The Global Financial Stability Report (GFSR) is a report of the International Monetary Fund (IMF), usually issued twice a year (in April and October).
- The World Development Report is published by the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development Bank (World Bank).

- During the period of the question, option (a) was the correct answer.
- In October 2017, India was placed at the 100th rank in the Ease of Doing Business report published by the World Bank.
- In the Ease of Doing Business Index, 2020 issued by the World Bank, New Zealand was at the top and India was at the 63rd rank.
- During the period of the question, option (c) was correct, but according to data released by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) in October 2025, in terms of nominal GDP at current prices in 2025, after the U.S.A., China is the world second largest economy.
- During the period of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- At present, option (c) was the correct answer.
- In the year 2019, for the first time, the Central Government set the ambitious target of making the Indian economy a 5 trillion U.S.
- To provide special economic assistance to India, the World Bank established the 'India Aid Club' in 1958, which was later renamed the 'India Development Forum'.
- With the support of the World Bank, the National Agricultural Innovation Project (NAIP), operated by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR), was launched on 26 July, 2006.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) To help investors distinguish companies trading in emerging economies on the basis of 'carbon efficiency', the World Bank developed an environmentally friendly stock-market index called the 'Green Index'.
- The International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank (IBRD) were conceived/established at the Bretton Woods Conference of 1944.
- Formally, the World Bank was established in 1944, but its membership became effective from December, 1945.
- India is one of the founding members of the International Monetary Fund (IMF).
- 'Paper Gold' is the Special Drawing Right (SDR) of the International Monetary Fund.
- The World Trade Organization (WTO) is an intergovernmental organization that regulates international trade.
- After the establishment of GATT in 1948, many changes took place in the conduct of world trade and in the conditions of member states, because of which change/reform in the GATT system became necessary.
- In November, 2001, the Fourth Ministerial Conference of the World Trade Organization (WTO) was held in Doha.
- Brazil's Roberto Azevedo took charge as Director-General of the World Trade Organization on 1 September, 2013 in place of Pascal Lamy.
- The World Trade Organization is a global organization that formulates appropriate policies for the fair and smooth conduct of international trade and also convenes round meetings from time to time.
- Dumping, anti-dumping and countervailing duties are not included under the WTO's Agreement on Agriculture.
- Green box, blue box and amber box are related to subsidies under the World Trade Organization (WTO).
- Subsidies given in agriculture are broadly classified as direct and indirect subsidies.
- The General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT), i.e.
- Under the WTO's Trade Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS), the following are included, excluding labour standards.
- Plant Breeding was not included for protection under the TRIPS agreement.
- In May, 2016, the Government of India approved the National Intellectual Property Rights Policy.
- According to the provisions of the WTO, developed countries were required to reduce agricultural subsidies within 6 years (base year 1986–88) of the establishment of the WTO by up to 20 percent, whereas developing countries were required to reduce them by about 13 percent within 10 years.
- According to the Global Talent Competitiveness Index, 2020 released by the World Economic Forum on 22 January, 2020, the correct combination is as follows— (Country) (Rank) Switzerland – 1 U.S.A.
- The World Economic Forum (WEF) releases the 'Global Gender Gap Report'.
- The Travel and Tourism Competitiveness Index (TTCI) was first prepared in 2007.
- The 'India Resident Mission' of the Asian Development Bank (ADB), which was opened in 1992, is located in New Delhi.
- At the hundredth annual meeting of the International Labour Organization (ILO) held in Geneva on 16 June, 2011, a decision was taken to protect the interests of domestic servants/workers.
- The 'World Social Protection Report' is published by the International Labour Organization.

- The correct matching is as follows— List-I List-II WTO – ■Generally to forbid the use of quantitative restrictions in trade IMF – ■To provide finance to correct equilibrium in balance of payments SAARC – ■To promote cooperation among South Asian countries IDA – Sanction of Soft Loans
- The correct matching is as follows— U.N.O.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1025 The Asia-Pacific Trade Agreement (APTA) was originally signed in 1975 as the Bangkok Agreement.
- Among the members of OPEC (Organisation of Petroleum Exporting Countries), which was established in 1960, China is not included.
- SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation) was formed on 8 December, 1985.
- BIMSTEC was originally established in 1997.
- In 2015, Indian banker K. V. Kamath was made the first President of the New Development Bank (NDB), or BRICS Bank.
- At present, Russia had the highest per capita income among all the original BRICS member countries.
- It is known that for 2024-25, Qingdao (China) was declared the S.C.O.
- U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2001 At Astana (Kazakhstan), during the 17th summit meeting of the heads of state of the member countries of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, on 9 June, 2017, India and Pakistan were granted the status of full member states of the organization.
- U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2001 For cooperation in transport, tourism, culture, education and communication between India and its eastern neighbouring countries, the Ganga-Mekong Swarnabhumi Project, established in 2000, includes six countries – India, Cambodia, Vietnam, Laos (Lao PDR), Myanmar and Thailand.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2004 The Shanghai-5 group was originally established in 1996 by China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia and Tajikistan.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010 For the present, option (b) is the correct answer.
- Consider the following statements regarding Voice of Global South Summit (VOGSS):
- At the 22nd summit meeting of the Council of Heads of State of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (S.C.O.) held in Samarkand, Uzbekistan on 16 September, 2022, Varanasi was declared the first S.C.O.
- The group formed by India, China, Brazil and other developing countries for future negotiations with the World Trade Organization is called G-77.
- ASEAN was established in 1967 in the capital of Thailand, Bangkok.
- Among the given organizations, Brunei is a member of ASEAN.
- The Gulf Cooperation Council (Gulf Cooperation Council: GCC) is a regional organization established in 1981.
- Australia is an important trade-partner country for India in the Oceania region.
- The first National Education Policy in the country was issued in 1968.
- On 26 October, 2024, the Tamil Nadu School Education Department issued the ‘Guidelines for Eliminating Corporal Punishment’ (GECP) in schools.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1029 The concept of ‘Marginal Man’ was propounded by Robert E.
- Gujarat Co-Operative Milk Marketing Federation Ltd.
- The idea of ‘Missing Women’ was given by the economist Amartya Sen.
- The development of the concept of the ‘Global Village’ is based on the development of transport and communication.
- In India, the Competition Commission was established on 14 October, 2003 under the Competition Act, 2002.
- At the time of question, Ashok Chawla was the Chairman of Competition of Commission of India.
- Bulgaria’s Kristalina Georgieva has been the Managing Director and Chairperson of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) since 1 October, 2019.
- T. S. Krishnamurthy remained India’s Chief Election Commissioner from 8 February, 2004 to 15 May, 2005.
- Among the given options, C. D. Deshmukh was both the Governor of RBI and later the Finance Minister.
- The Tarapore Committee was constituted to give advice on convertibility of the rupee in the capital account, not on customer service in banks.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development)
- The author of the book From Dependence to Self-Reliance is Bimal Jalan.
- B 1 4 3 2 C 4 3 2 1 D 3 1 1 4 U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007 TRYSEM and SJRY are related to employment.
- A group of certain persons which effectively and decisively influences policy decisions is called a pressure group.

- Scotland's Angus Deaton was awarded the Nobel Prize in Economics in 2015 (The Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel).
- The book India's Economic Policy: The Gandhian Blue Print was written by India's former Prime Minister Chaudhary Charan Singh.
- When India had to keep gold in foreign banks, Chandra Shekhar was the Prime Minister of India.
- India's ranking in the Corruption Perceptions Index issued by Transparency International was as follows: in 2014 it was 85th, in 2012 it was 94th, in 2011 it was 95th, and in 2010 it was 87th.
- To keep a record of the rise and fall in the prices of residential properties, the National Housing Bank (NHB) started the housing price index RESIDEX in July 2007.
- The Trade and Merchandise Marks Act was passed and enacted by Parliament in 1958.
- In India, the Patents Act was enacted in 1970.
- In 2002, the Indian Parliament finally approved the Patent (Amendment) Act, and it was enacted in the same year.
- The newspaper Bahini Darbar has been published since 2008 from the Dabhoura Block of Java Tehsil in Rewa district of Madhya Pradesh.
- The V. V. Giri National Labour Institute is located in Noida.
- The National Institute of Agricultural Economics and Policy Research (NIAP) is located in New Delhi.
- None of the above statements is correct.
- The Entrepreneurship Development Institute of India is situated in Ahmedabad (Gujarat).
- The National Institute for Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development is located at Noida (U.P.).
- Point Fact Full name of ICAR–National Institute of Agricultural institution Economics and Policy Research (ICARNIAP) Location New Delhi Established March 1991 (earlier name: National Centre for Agricultural Economics and Policy Research, NCAP) Under the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR), this institution is a major national centre for agricultural economics and policy research.
- In November 2015, The then Union Minister for Urban Development M.
- In April 2008, the Postal Department started a scheme called "Project Arrow" to bring timely and long-term changes in the Indian postal system.
- With the exception coal mines, the other three are included in economic infrastructure.
- A supermarket is a kind of retail sales organization.
- The correct matching is— Gunnar Myrdal — Economic Theory and Underdeveloped Regions A.
- The famous classical economics book published in 1776, An Inquiry into the Nature and Causes of the Wealth of Nations, was written by the famous economist Adam Smith.
- The author of On the Principles of Political Economy and Taxation is David Ricardo.
- F. W. Taylor is the Father of Scientific Management.
- The theory of trusteeship of business assets was propounded by Mahatma Gandhi.
- Gandhian economy is based on the Principle of trusteeship.
- The concept of trusteeship was presented by Mahatma Gandhi.
- Gandhian economy is based on the doctrine of trusteeship.
- The concept of "age-quake" is related not to the childage population, but to the increasing proportion of elderly people in the population.
- Strategic choices are not a specific achievement in international policy processes that is directly connected with women's empowerment.
- According to current and study data, the U.S.A.
- According to expenditure on basic infrastructure during 2019–2023, the order of these states is as follows— State Expenditure Rank Uttar Pradesh ■5.31 lakh crore First Maharashtra ■4.39 lakh crore Second Tamil Nadu ■2.84 lakh crore Third Karnataka ■2.76 lakh crore Fourth Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.
- At the time of publication, option (a) was correct.
- In November 2015, the Ministry of Power, Government of India, launched the Ujwal Discom Assurance Yojana, or UDAY.
- Primary energy is the energy included in natural resources before any man-made transformation or change.
- In Gujarat, the first railway line built under the PublicPrivate Partnership (PPP Model), the broad-gauge rail line, was dedicated to the nation on 14 July 2015.
- In Indian tourism, the Golden Triangle includes Agra, Delhi and Jaipur.
- At present, more than one-third of the world's crude steel production comes from China.

- *UPPSC Question Papers 1037 According to current data and the data released by the World Steel Association in January 2026, China remained at the top in global crude steel production in 2025 as well.
- The Kamaiya system is a hereditary labour system in Nepal which, despite being declared abolished by the Nepal government, continued from generation to generation through ministers and bureaucrats.
- Before 15 August 1947, India was a British colony.
- Arthashastra is a book of political science written by Kautilya.
- Usually, in non-domestic gas cylinders, the weight of filled LPG is 19.0 kg, whereas in domestic gas cylinders it is 14.2 kg.
- The full name of PVR Cinema is Priya Village Roadshow.
- AGMARK is a quality certification mark applied in India to agricultural/food products.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009 AGMARK was legally brought into force in 1937 through the Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act.
- AGMARK is a symbol of quality for agricultural products.
- ISO 14001 is an international certificate given to those industrial units which follow environmental protection and environment-related laws.
- In 2015, the Geographical Indication (GI) Registry granted the GI tag to black pottery from Nizamabad in Azamgarh district of Uttar Pradesh.
- Under the Eco Mark Scheme, 1991, soap, detergents, paper, plastic, sanitary preparations and aerosols have been notified.
- At present, packaging has become important because it makes products safe, attractive and credibility.
- After the merger of Air India and Indian Airlines, the new company came to be known as Air India.
- The Universal Service Obligation Fund (USOF) is related to adjustment of the liabilities of telecom companies.

## India : Population

- In the country, rising population is not only increasing unemployment, poverty and hunger, but is also adversely affecting nature.
- Birth and death are the natural causes of population change in any region.
- 1040 “Demographic transition” is a theory which shows the gradual change occurring in population over time.
- In a stable population structure, both the birth rate and death rate remain controlled and at a low level; that is, both remain nearly equal, due to which the population remains stable.
- At present, India’s population growth is at a high growth rate with a declining trend.
- Malthus was the first thinker who, in his 1798 article An Essay on the Principle of Population, mentioned population growth and demographic change on the one hand and social, cultural and economic changes on the other.
- T. R. Malthus propounded the famous theory of “The Malthusian Theory” in the context of population.
- According to Malthus, population grows much faster than the means of subsistence (food materials).
- 3 4 4 1 1 2 U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023 The correct matching is as follows : Optimum Population Theory – Social Maladjustment Theory – Demographic Transition Theory – Population–Food Supply Theory – Edwin Cannan Henry George Thompson Malthus
- Standard of living is not a part of the demographic feature of population.
- In India, the first census in a modern and systematic form was conducted non-synchronously in different parts of the country between 1865 and 1872.
- Under the modern administrative system during British rule, the first census was completed in 1872 during the tenure of Lord Mayo, but the regular arrangement of census, that is, the first regular census, was conducted in 1881 during the tenure of Lord Ripon.
- India’s first census was conducted in 1872 during the tenure of Lord Mayo, but regular census began from 1881.
- For Census 2011 in India, the slogan line used was “Our Census, Our Future”.
- The geographical area (in sq km) of these four states is respectively: Haryana (44,212 Sq.
- During the decade 1901–1911, the decadal growth rate of population was 5.75%, while during 1911–1921, India’s decadal growth rate became negative (-0.31%).
- See the explanation of the above question.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, India’s decadal population growth rate during 2001–2011 was 17.7 percent.

- The highest percentage change in India's population was recorded in the 1971 Census (that is, during 1961–71).
- In the history of Indian Census, 1921 is the only census year in which the decadal growth rate of population was negative (-0.31%).
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000 In 1951, India's population was about 36 crore, which became more than 102 crore in 2001.
- India recorded the highest average annual exponential growth rate of population (2.22%) during the decade 1971–81, while during 2001–2011 it was 1.64%.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the percentage of women in India's population was 48.46 percent, whereas according to the final data it is 48.53 percent.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the most populous state is Uttar Pradesh.
- According to Census 2001, the literacy rate of Uttar Pradesh was 56.3 percent and its population density was 690 persons per sq km.
- On the basis of Census 2011, the descending order of the top five states by population is— Uttar Pradesh > Maharashtra > Bihar > West Bengal > Andhra Pradesh.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, about 17 percent (16.49 in provisional data) of India's population lives in Uttar Pradesh.
- According to both the 2001 and 2011 Census, Uttar Pradesh is the most populous state of India.
- According to Census 2011, the populations of the states given in the options are – Bihar – 104099452 Andhra Pradesh (undivided) – 84580777 Uttar Pradesh – 199812341 West Bengal – 91276115 On the basis of these data, the descending order is – Uttar Pradesh > Bihar > West Bengal > Andhra Pradesh
- According to Census 2011, with an area of 307713 sq km, Maharashtra ranks third in area after Rajasthan (342239 sq km) and Madhya Pradesh (308252 sq km), while in terms of population, with 112374333 persons, it ranks second after Uttar Pradesh (199812341).
- More than one-third of India's population is concentrated in Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Bihar.
- According to both the question hour and Census 2011, among the states given in the question, Karnataka has the lowest population— State Population (2011) Maharashtra – 112374333 Bihar – 104099452 Madhya Pradesh – 72626809 Karnataka – 61095297
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) The area of West Bengal is 88752 sq km, while that of Chhattisgarh is 135192 sq km.
- In the question hour (according to Census 1991), option (c) was the correct answer.
- According to Census 2001, the descending order of population of the states/UTs in question was— Puducherry (974345) > Chandigarh (900635) > Mizoram (888573) > Sikkim (540851).
- The decadal growth (in percent) in the populations of the above-mentioned states was as follows— State 1981–91 2001–2011 Nagaland 56.08 –0.6 Arunachal Pradesh 36.83 26.0 Tripura 34.30 14.8 Uttar Pradesh 25.61 20.2 Thus, it is clear that according to the 1991 Census, Nagaland was the correct option among those given.
- According to Census 2001, the lowest population growth among the states was recorded in Kerala, whereas during 2001–2011 the lowest population growth was recorded in Nagaland (-0.6%).
- In the present context as well as according to Census 2011, option (c) is the correct answer among the given states.
- According to Census 2011, among Indian states, Nagaland recorded a negative population growth rate (–0.6%) during 2001–2011.
- According to Census 2011, among the states given in the question, the minimum decadal population growth was in Andhra Pradesh (11.0%).
- Among the options given, during 2001–2011, the state with the highest decadal population growth rate was Bihar (25.4 percent).
- According to the Provisional data of Census 2011, the decadal growth rate of Uttar Pradesh's total population during 2001–11 was 20.09 percent, while in the final data it was 20.2 percent.
- According to Census 2001, the population of Uttar Pradesh was 166197921, whereas the most densely populated state in the country was West Bengal (903).
- The population of Uttar Pradesh has been increasing rapidly during the last two decades.
- According to Census 2011, the populations of the districts given in the options are – District Population 2011 Allahabad (Now-Prayagraj) – 5954391 Moradabad – 4772006 Ghaziabad – 4681645 Lucknow – 4589838
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1047 In the present context (according to Census 2001), Kerala's population density was 819, which made it the second most densely populated state of India, and its literacy rate was 90.9 percent, the highest in India.

- At the beginning of the 20th century (1901), India’s population density was 77 persons per sq km, which continuously increased and became 382 persons per sq km in 2011.
- According to Census 2011, Bihar has the highest population density in India.
- Population Density (Census 2011) persons/sq km Position Bihar 1106 Highest Uttar Pradesh 829 Punjab 551 Madhya Pradesh 236 State Note : In its preliminary answer key, UPPSC gave option (a) as the answer to this question, which is incorrect.
- According to Census 2011, the states with the highest population density in India are Bihar (1106 persons per sq km) and West Bengal (1028 persons per sq km), while the state with the lowest population density is Arunachal Pradesh (17 persons per sq km).
- According to Census 2011, the population densities are— Bihar 1106, West Bengal 1028, Kerala 860, and Uttar Pradesh
- In the Question hour, and according to Census 2011 also, option (a) is correct.
- According to the 2001 and 2011 Census, the ascending order of population density among the states in question is as follows— Population Density State 2001 2011 Odisha 236 270 Andhra Pradesh 277 308 Tripura 305 350 Punjab 484 551
- According to both the 2001 and 2011 Census, option (c) is correct.
- According to Census 1991, the population density of Jammu and Kashmir was 77 persons per sq km, which was lower than that of the other states given in the options.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) According to the final data of Census 2011, among the states in the question, the population density of Mizoram is 52, which is less than
- (On the basis of Census 2011 data) Union Territory ■Population Density (persons/ sq km) Puducherry 2547 Daman and Diu 2191 Lakshadweep 2149 Dadra and Nagar Haveli 700
- According to Census 2011, the Union Territory of India with the lowest population density is Andaman and Nicobar Islands (46 persons per sq km).
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the ascending order of population density among the states in question is— Rajasthan (200) < Madhya Pradesh (236) < Gujarat (308) < Karnataka (319)
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1049 According to Census 2011, the ascending order of population density among the above states is— Gujarat (308) < Karnataka (319) < Assam (398) < Haryana (573)
- According to Census 2001, the population density of Uttar Pradesh was 690 persons per sq km (according to Census 2011, it is 829), whereas India’s overall population density was 324 persons per sq km.
- In India, the effective literacy rate is calculated on the basis of the population aged 7 years and above.
- Among the decades mentioned in the question, India recorded the highest percentage increase in literacy during 1991–2001 (about 12.62%).
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the literacy rate in India was 74.04 percent.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the district with the highest literacy was Serchhip (Mizoram), whose literacy rate was 98.76.
- Outside the state of Kerala, Bardhaman district of West Bengal was declared the first fully literate district.
- According to the states given in the options, on the basis of the final data of Census 2011, the highest increase in literacy rate during 2001–2011 occurred in Bihar (14.8% = 61.8% – 47.00%), whereas among all Indian states/Union Territories, the highest increase in literacy rate during 2001–2011 occurred in Dadra and Nagar Haveli (18.6% = 76.2% – 57.6%).
- According to Census 2011, among the options given, the state with the highest literacy is Manipur, where the literacy rate is 79.2 percent, while Punjab has 75.8 percent, Assam 72.2 percent, and Madhya Pradesh 69.3 percent.
- According to Census 2011, the state of Mizoram stands second in India in terms of literacy rate (91.3%) and urbanization (52.1%).
- According to both Census 2001 and 2011, among all the states of India, Mizoram has the highest literacy rate after Kerala.
- According to both Census 2001 and 2011, option (b) is correct.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the correct ascending order of the four least literate states is— Bihar (61.8%) < Arunachal Pradesh (65.4%) < Rajasthan (66.1%) < Jharkhand (66.4%) This was the same order according to the final data of Census 2011 as well.

- *UPPSC Question Papers 1051 According to the Census 2001, the ascending order of literacy in the given states was as follows— State Literacy Rate (%) Bihar 47.0 Uttar Pradesh 56.3 Rajasthan 60.4 Madhya Pradesh 63.7 Thus, option (a) was correct with respect to the ascending order of states on the basis of literacy.
- According to both the 2001 and 2011 census Lakshdweep had the highest literacy rate among the given states/UTs.
- On the basis of the provisional and final data of Census 2011, the descending order of literacy percentage of the above states is as follows— Census 2011 Census 2011 State Provisional Final Tripura 87.75 87.2 Himachal Pradesh 83.78 82.8 Sikkim 82.20 81.4 Nagaland 80.11 79.6 1052
- According to the provisional and final data of Census 2011, the difference between male and female literacy rates in India is as follows— Provisional Final Male literacy rate 82.14 80.9 Female literacy rate 65.46 64.6 Literacy gap 16.68 16.3 According to the final data of Census 2011, female literacy in the country is approximately 65.5%.
- According to Census 2011, the minimum difference of 3.1% between the literacy rates of males (76%) and females (72.9%) is in Meghalaya.
- Among the given options, according to Census 2011, Uttar Pradesh has the maximum difference between male and female literacy rates.
- The female literacy rates (in percentage) in the given states are as follows— State 2001 2011 Chhattisgarh 51.9 60.2 Odisha 50.5 64.0 Madhya Pradesh 50.3 59.2 Rajasthan 43.9 52.1 Thus, with reference to Census 2001, the correct answer is option (a).
- The female literacy rate (in percentage) in the given states is as follows— State 2001 2011 Bihar 33.1 51.5 Jharkhand 38.9 55.4 Uttar Pradesh 42.2 57.2 Chhattisgarh 51.9 60.2 It is clear from the above data that, according to both Census 2001 and Census 2011, option (a) is correct.
- According to Census 2011, among the given states, the lowest female literacy rate was recorded in Rajasthan (52.1%).
- According to both the provisional and final data of Census 2011, among the given states, the highest literacy rate is in Uttarakhand.
- Union Territory Literacy Rate (%) 2011 Position Lakshadweep 91.8% Highest Daman and Diu 87.10% 1054 Andaman and Nicobar Islands 86.60% Chandigarh 86.00%
- According to Census 2011, the literacy rate of the given Union Territories is as follows— Union Territory Chandigarh Dadra and Nagar Haveli Daman and Diu Lakshadweep Literacy Rate 86.0% 76.2% 87.1% 91.8%
- According to Census 2001, among the states given in the question, the highest rural literacy was in Goa (79.67%), whereas the highest rural literacy in India was in Kerala (90.04%).
- According to Census 2001, Uttar Pradesh ranked 31st among states/Union Territories in literacy rate, whereas according to Census 2011, Uttar Pradesh ranked 29th in this regard.
- According to Census 2011, the correct descending order of average literacy rate of the given four districts of Uttar Pradesh is Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.1%), Kanpur Nagar (79.7%), Auraiya (78.9%) and Etawah (78.4%).
- According to Census 2011, female literacy in the given districts is as follows—Ballia (59.8%), Deoria (59.4%), Gorakhpur (59.4%) and Rampur (44.4%).
- According to Census 2011, the sex ratio in India is 943, not
- According to the Census 1951, India’s sex ratio was
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the number of females per thousand males, that is, sex ratio, is the highest in Kerala (1084).
- State Kerala Karnataka Tamil Nadu West Bengal Total Sex Ratio in 2011 (women per 1000 men) 1084 973 996 950
- At the time of the question and even at present, the number of females is greater than the number of males in Kerala.
- According to Census 2011, the sex ratio in Puducherry is above 1000, i.e., 1037.
- According to Census 2011, India’s sex ratio is
- According to Census 2011, in all the four given states, the number of males aged 7 years and above is greater than that of females.
- According to Census 2011, the state and UTs with the lowest sex ratio is Haryana (879), while Sikkim (890), Punjab (895) and Jammu and Kashmir (889) have a higher sex ratio than Haryana.
- State Per Capita Net State Domestic Product at Current Prices, 2024–25 (in ■) Sex Ratio (2011) Madhya Pradesh 152615 931 Maharashtra 309340 929 West Bengal 163467 950 Haryana 353182 879 It is clear from the above data that among the optional states, Haryana is economically the highest, but it is the lowest on the basis of sex ratio.

- According to both Census 2001 and Census 2011, option (b) is the correct answer.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1057 In the given states/Union Territories, the sex ratio during 1991, 2001 and 2011 was as follows— State/Union Territory 1991 2001 2011 Haryana 865 861 879 Himachal Pradesh 976 968 972 Dadra and Nagar Haveli 952 812 774 Daman and Diu 960 710 618 It is clear from the above data that option (d) is the correct answer.
- According to Census 1991, 2001 and 2011 data, the sex ratio of the above states is as follows—
- According to Census 2011, the female/male ratio, that is, sex ratio, in Uttar Pradesh is 912/1000, whereas in 2001 it was 898/1000.
- The first three are the main causes of the low sex ratio.
- In India, the sex ratio of the child population aged 0–6 years has shown a continuously declining trend since 1961.
- According to Census 2011, in the age group 0–6 years, Haryana has the highest number of boys per 100 girls, i.e., 120 boys.
- According to Census 2011, India's child sex ratio (0–6 years) declined from 927 in 2001 to 919, which is the lowest since 1961.
- According to Census 2001 and Census 2011 also, option (b) is the correct answer.
- According to the question hour and Census 2011 also, option (d) is the correct answer.
- According to Census 2011— State Kerala Nagaland Sikkim Assam Scheduled Caste Population 3039573 0 (nil) 28275 2231321 Scheduled Tribe Population 484839 1710973 206360 3884371
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017 The North-Eastern Region (NER) includes Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura.
- According to Census 2001, the proportion of Scheduled Tribes in India's total population was 8.2%.
- According to Census 2011, no Scheduled Tribe population is recorded in Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi and Puducherry.
- According to Census 2011, the ascending order of the optional states in terms of Scheduled Tribe population is Arunachal Pradesh (951,821), Mizoram (1,036,115), Nagaland (1,710,973) and Meghalaya (2,555,861).
- According to Census 2011, Madhya Pradesh has the highest Scheduled Tribe population.
- Order State Scheduled Tribe Population % (Census 2011) 1 Maharashtra 9.40% 2 Rajasthan 13.50% 3 Madhya Pradesh 21.10% 4 Meghalaya 86.10% Therefore, the ascending order will be II (Maharashtra) → III (Rajasthan) → I (Madhya Pradesh) → IV (Meghalaya), which matches option (c).
- According to Census 2011, among the optional states, in Uttar Pradesh the percentage of Scheduled Tribe population as a percentage of its total population is the minimum.
- In February 2000, the Government announced the National Population Policy, 2000.
- Under the 10-year action plan prepared under the National Population Policy, 2000, promotion of self-help groups, free and compulsory education for the age group 6 to 14 years, and compulsory registration of marriages and pregnancies have been included.
- On 15 February, 2000, the newly formulated National Population Policy announced immediate, medium-term and long-term measures for population control.
- To reach the replacement level of fertility, the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) of the population should be 2.1 children per woman.
- According to SRS, 2016, the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) of India was 2.3, which, according to NFHS-5 (National Family Health Survey, 2019–21), declined to 2.0, i.e.
- In the fourth round of the National Family Health Survey (NFHS), 2015–16, India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) was 2.2, while in the third round, 2005–06, it was 2.7.
- According to Census 2011, India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) was 2.4, which, according to the SRS Statistical Report 2023, declined to 1.9 in the year 2023, i.e.
- At the time of the question, Uttar Pradesh had a higher TFR than other states of India.
- The composition of population, such as education, health, economic condition, etc., is an important factor of social change.
- In the context of the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- Population stabilization is the level at which there is no change in population.
- In India, the counting of deaths was first started by the state of Karnataka.
- At the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- According to the SRS Bulletin released at the time of the question, among the given states, the lowest death rate was in Maharashtra.

- According to Census 2011, the Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) in India was 44 per thousand live births.
- According to the then UNICEF report, the child mortality rate in Odisha was the highest, at 75 per 1000 live births.
- As per the question period and updated data also, among the given states, the lowest Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) is in Tamil Nadu, which is lower than the all-India average IMR.
- During the Eleventh Plan Period, the target was to reduce the Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) to 28 per 1000 live births.
- In the Economic Survey 2013–14, the average age of the Indian population in 2020 was estimated at 29 years, and it was considered that India would be the youngest country in the world, while the average age of the populations of China and the United States would be 37 years.
- According to Census 2011, the percentage of people aged 20 years or above in India's total population was approximately 59.29 percent.
- Old-age dependency ratio is the ratio of elderly or nonworking population, 60 years and above, to the working population, 15–59 years.
- According to the United Nations Population Fund, demographic dividend means the economic growth potential that may result from changes in the age structure of the population, mainly when the share of the working population, 15-64 years, is greater than the share of the nonworking population, 14 years and below and 65 years and above.
- ■ (c) Above 50 years group (d) 0-14 years group
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013 In the population pyramid, the 0-14 years age group is generally known as the dependent population.
- The dependency ratio is the ratio of the population aged 0–14 years and 65 years and above to the population aged 15–64 years.
- "Demographic bonus" means an increase in the productive or labour-related age group in the population.
- An increase in the size of the working population is not an adverse effect of population growth; rather, it is a favourable effect.
- According to Census 2011, disabled persons constituted 2.1 percent of India's total population.
- According to the Censuses of 2001 and 2011, the ascending order of the given religious communities and their related population is as follows: Religious community 2001 2011 Jain 4225053 4451753 Buddhist 7955207 8442972 Sikh 19215730 20833116 Christian 24080016 27819588
- Among the northeastern states, the proportion of Christians in the total population of the state was highest in Nagaland, 90 percent according to Census 1991.
- The literacy percentage in Kerala is higher than in other Indian states.
- According to the Censuses of 2001 and 2011, the position of the given religious communities on the basis of their sex ratio is as follows: Religious community 2001 2011 Christian 1009 1023 Buddhist 953 965 Jain 940 954 Muslim 936 951 From the above data, it is clear that according to both Census 2001 and Census 2011, option (b) is the correct answer.
- According to the religion-based population data of Census 2011 released in August 2015, the lowest sex ratio is in the Sikh community, at
- The National Literacy Mission was started on 5 May, 1988 by the then Prime Minister, Late Rajiv Gandhi.
- The five progressive population-resource regions of India are as follows—
- Urban growth is the result or indicator of an increase in the number of people living in cities, an increase in the number of urban centres, an increase in the total population of the country and an increase in income generated from urban areas.
- According to sociology, cultural diversity is not included among the characteristics of a rural community.
- Sociologist T.K. Oommen used the following patterns to explain urban families – (i) ■Sources of income and patterns of emerging or changing values; (ii) Structure of authority; (iii) Urban social milieu and social ecology.

## India : Urbanization

- Rural-urban migration plays an important role in the growth of urbanization.
- According to the Economic Survey 2015-16, inclusive development can be seen in the form of progress in social inclusion and financial inclusion.
- According to the data of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, presented in India 2018, India's urban population was estimated to reach 575 million by 2030 at the present growth rate.
- According to Census 2001, urbanization in India was 27.8 percent.

- According to the data of Census 2011, out of India's population of about 121 crore, 83.4 crore people, 68.9 percent, lived in villages and 37.7 crore people, 31.1 percent, lived in cities.
- In China, the rate of urbanization is much higher than the level of urbanization in India.
- At the time of the question, all the given statements were true.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) Urban settlements differ from rural settlements on the basis of their size, population and functions.
- According to Census 2011, India's population was 1,210.85 million, of which 377.1 million lived in urban areas.
- There is great regional inequality in the pattern of Indian urbanization.
- When implemented successfully, urbanization is important from the point of view of reducing the birth rate.
- With urbanization, the facilities available to people have increased.
- The period from 1931 to 1961 is known as the period of moderate urbanization in India.
- Among the decades given in the question, the decadal growth rate of India's urban population was highest during 1971-81.
- In India, the following conditions should be fulfilled to declare a settlement as an urban area—
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the total number of census towns in India was 3892; according to provisional data, it was 3894.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, India's total population was 1,210,854,977, of which the rural population was 833,748,852, i.e.
- In India, the Jain religious group about 0.4 percent of the total population, and the largest share of its population lives in urban areas.
- State Urban Population (in thousand) 2001 Urban Population (in thousand) 2011 Decadal Growth Rate Maharashtra 41101 50818 23.67% Nagaland 343 571 66.47% Kerala 8267 15935 92.75% Sikkim 60 154 156.7% From the above data, it is clear that during 2001–2011, among the given states, the highest decadal growth in urban population was recorded in Sikkim.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) According to Census 2001 as well as Census 2011, option (d) is correct.
- According to Census 2001 and Census 2011, the position of the three states with the highest urban population is as follows: State Urban Population, 2001 (in thousand) Urban Population, 2011 (in thousand) Maharashtra 41,101 50,818 Uttar Pradesh 34,540 44,495 Tamil Nadu 27,484 34,917 Thus, it is clear that according to both Census 2001 and Census 2011, option (d) is correct.
- According to Census 2011, the urban population in the given states was as follows : State Urban Population Maharashtra 5,08,18,259 Uttar Pradesh 4,44,95,063 Tamil Nadu 3,49,17,440 West Bengal 2,90,93,002 According to Census 2001, the ascending order of states in terms of urban population was—West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the ascending order of urban population among the given states is as follows: 1 1
- According to the final data of Census 2011, Himachal Pradesh is India's least urbanized state (10%).
- State Percentage of urban population (2011) Goa 62.2% – highest among all states Tamil Nadu 48.4% Maharashtra 45.2% Gujarat 42.6% * Which State of India has the highest percentage of urban population, according to the Census 2011? [U.P.
- According to the Census 2001 and 2011, among the states given in the options, Tamil Nadu had an urban population of 44.5% and 48.4% of its total population respectively.
- The urbanization position of the states asked in the question is as follows—
- State/UTs Percentage of Urban Population (2011) Haryana 34.9 Jammu and Kashmir 27.4 Punjab 37.5 Madhya Pradesh 27.6
- According to Census 2011, the urban population of the states given in the options is as follows – State Total urban population Percentage 48.4% Gujarat 25745083 42.6 42.4% 45.2% Andhra Pradesh 28219075 33.4 Gujarat 37.4% 42.6% Karnataka 34.0% 38.7% Maharashtra 50818259 45.2 Punjab 33.9% 37.5% West Bengal 29093002 31.9 State/UTs 2001 2011 Tamil Nadu 44.5% Maharashtra Thus, it is clear that during the period of the question as well as at present, option (b) is correct.
- According to both Census 2001 and Census 2011, option (b) is the correct answer.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1073 According to Census 2011— State Total Urban census (2011) Urbanization (%) (2011) Andhra Pradesh 28219075 33.4 Haryana 8842103 34.9 Mizoram 571771 52.1 West Bengal 29093002 31.9

- According to the final data of Census 2011, the descending order of these states according to the percentage of urban population is— State Urban Population (%) Tamil Nadu 48.4% Kerala 47.7% Maharashtra 45.2% Gujarat 42.6% According to the provisional data of Census 2011 also, this was the correct order of these states.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, urban population density in the states asked in the question is as follows— State Urban population density Maharashtra 5594 Punjab 4136 Tamil Nadu 2561 West Bengal 5683 1074 Thus, among these states, the highest urban population density is in West Bengal.
- Urbanization percentage in states on the basis of Census 2011— State Urbanization percentage Nagaland 28.9 Arunachal Pradesh 22.9 Sikkim 25.2 Bihar 11.3 On the basis of the above data, it is clear that among the option-based states, Bihar has the lowest level of urbanization.
- According to Census 2011, the urban population and its percentage in the total population in the option-based states are as follows— State Urban population Percentage Tripura 961453 26.2 Sikkim 153578 25.2 Arunachal Pradesh 317369 22.9 Himachal Pradesh 688552 10.0 According to the above data, among the option-based states and all Indian states, Himachal Pradesh has the minimum percentage of urban population, at 10.0%.
- According to the final data of Census 2011, the percentage of urban population as compared to the total population of the states given in the options is as follows—Himachal Pradesh (10.0%), Odisha (16.7%), Jharkhand (24.0%) and Rajasthan (24.9%).
- According to Census 2011, among the Union Territories given, Andaman and Nicobar Islands is the least urbanized.
- According to Census 2011, among the following Union Territories, the number of villages is minimum in Daman and Diu, where the number of inhabited villages is only
- Statements 1 and 3 are true, while statements 2 and 4 are false, because according to the provisional data of census 2011, the rural and urban population was 68.84% and 31.16% respectively.
- According to Census 2001, the percentage of rural population in India was 72.2%.
- According to Census 2011, the highest proportion of rural population is in Himachal Pradesh at 90.0%.
- State Population (Census - 2011) Rural Urban Madhya Pradesh 52557404 (72.4%) 20069405 (27.6%) Maharashtra 61556074 (54.8%) 50818259 (45.2%) *UPPSC Question Papers 1075 Population (Census - 2011) State Rural Urban Punjab 17344192 (62.5%) 10399146 (37.5%) Uttar Pradesh 155317278 (77.7%) 44495063 (22.3%) From the above data, it is clear that on the basis of population, both among the option-based states and in the whole country, the highest rural population is in Uttar Pradesh.
- According to Census 2011, the percentage of child population in the rural areas of the option-based states is as follows — State/UTs Percentage Kerala 10.4% Punjab 11.2% Haryana 13.2% Jammu and Kashmir 17.5%
- According to Census 2011, the child sex ratio of the urban and rural areas of the states given in the options is as follows– State/UTs Child Sex Ratio Total Urban Rural Uttar Pradesh 902 885 906 Kerala 964 963 965 Haryana 834 832 835 Jammu and Kashmir 862 850 865 It is clear from the above data that among the states asked, Haryana has the minimum child sex ratio in both urban and rural areas.
- According to data Census 2001 and NSS 76th Round (July– December 2018), the percentage of rural population living in pucca houses in the above states is as follows— State Goa Kerala Himachal Pradesh Punjab Percentage of Rural Population Living in Pucca Houses (Census 2001) NSS 76th Round (July–December 2018) 60.9 64.6 95.9 85.0 61.8 86.9 83.4 97.9
- Due to the presence of traders and manufacturers, the boundary between village and town begins to disappear and villages get transformed into towns.
- The occupational characteristics of population are reflected in the working force, dependent population, employment and unemployment.
- Urbanization refers to the process which is primarily a rural-to-urban transformation.
- In India, towns are divided into six classes on the basis of population.
- According to the Census 1991, the highest population growth rate in India was found in Class I towns, whereas according to Census 2001, the highest population growth rate was in Class III towns.
- According to Census 2001, the percentage of population of Class I towns in India’s total urban population was 62.32%.
- According to Census 2011, the number of Class I towns in India is 468, which accounts for 70.02% of the country’s total urban population.
- According to the provisional data of Census 2011, the number of million-plus cities, i.e.
- A difference in population growth is found in many towns of India, whereas according to Census 2001, there were six mega cities, i.e.
- According to Census 2001, there were a total of six megacities in India—1.

- At the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- According to Census 2001, the number of towns with a population of more than ten lakh in different states was as follows: Uttar Pradesh – 6, Maharashtra – 4, Tamil Nadu – 3 and West Bengal –
- Among the given options, Odisha does not have even one ten lakh-plus town.
- According to Census 2001, Madhya Pradesh had three million-plus cities – Indore, Bhopal and Jabalpur.
- During 1991–2001, the number of towns with a population of more than ten lakh increased from 23 to
- According to Census 2011 (P), the population of Agra is 1,746,467, Allahabad (Now-Prayagraj) 1,216,719, Meerut 1,424,908 and Lucknow 2,901,474.
- According to Census 2011 (P), the correct descending order of the option-based urban centres in terms of urban population is— Ghaziabad (2,358,525) > Agra (1,746,467) > Varanasi (1,435,113) > Meerut (1,424,908).
- According to the Indian Census 2011 (P), Kota in Rajasthan is at the last position in the list of the country's million-plus, i.e.
- In terms of population in 2001, the smallest million-plus city among the option-based cities was Rajkot.
- According to Census 2001, among the given states, Jharkhand had two million-plus cities – Dhanbad and Jamshedpur.
- The number of women per 1000 men is expressed as the sex ratio.
- According to the major census decades, and also during 2001–11, the growth rate of Uttar Pradesh's urban population was— Decade Growth in Urban Population (In %) 1961–71 29.72 1971–81 60.89 1981–91 38.52 1991–2001 32.88 2001–2011 28.75
- According to the provisional and final data of Census 2011, Ghaziabad has the highest population density in Uttar Pradesh.
- According to Census 2001, 27.8% of India's population lived in towns; according to the final data of 2011, it is 31.1%.
- India's eastern cities generally have an unbalanced sex ratio.
- Assertion (A) : All cities are expanding rapidly.
- According to the data of March 2011, Uttar Pradesh was in second place in India in terms of total road length.
- India's urban population was 11% of the total population in 1901, which gradually increased to 31.1% in 2011.
- Among the options asked, the name of Lee is associated with the Migration Theory.
- Movement of population from one place to another is called migration.
- Urban corridors are related to the expansion of urban function through the expansion of transport facilities.
- The growth of urbanization and industrialization and rapid increase in urban population encourage various types of social crimes, because the non-availability of the required facilities gives rise to material deprivation.
- Increasing urbanization is responsible for population concentration in cities as a result of rapid population growth in towns.
- According to Census 2001 and 2011, the most urbanized state of the country in terms of percentage was Goa, while Maharashtra had the highest urban population.
- Due to the low level of education in rural areas, most migrated villagers perform low-quality work in urban towns and are compelled to live in slums.
- According to Census 2001, among Indian cities, the highest slum-dwelling population was in Greater Mumbai (6.5 million).
- According to the 2011 Census, the descending order of the top five States having the highest share in the total slum population was Maharashtra (18.1%), Andhra Pradesh (15.6%), West Bengal (9.8%), Uttar Pradesh (9.5%) and Tamil Nadu (8.9%).
- The India Urban Observatory (IUO) of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs is located in New Delhi.
- Urban infrastructure includes drinking water, sanitation and transport, whereas housing is not included in it.
- Swachh Bharat Mission, Heritage City Development and Augmentation Scheme (HRIDAY) and Smart City Scheme are new schemes for urban infrastructure development, whereas the Digital India Programme is an initiative implemented by the Government of India to transform the entire ecosystem of public services through the use of information technology and to transform India into a knowledge economy.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) For the development of basic infrastructure and expansion of services in major cities of the country, the Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JNNURM) was launched by Prime Minister Dr.
- The Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JNNURM) was launched in December, 2005.

- In the Smart Cities Mission, desalination of water and sewage is proposed to be financed through property tax.
- The objective of a smart city is to shape the development of a local area, use technology, especially such technology which produces smart outcomes, to increase economic development and improve people's quality of life.

## World Population & Urbanization

- The idea of the 'Folk-Urban Continuum' was developed by American cultural anthropologist Robert Redfield.
- According to Redfield and Singer, the process of primary urbanization is characterized by the development of the Great Tradition.
- The term Megalopolis was used by French geographer Jean Gottmann in 1961 in his book Megalopolis: The Urbanized Northeastern Sea board of the United States.
- The United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) releases the State of World Population report every year.
- World Population Day is observed every year on July
- The theme of World Population Day, July 11, 2017 was – "Family Planning: Empowering People, Developing Nations." The theme of World Population Day 2022 was – "A World of 8 Billion: Towards a Resilient Future for All Harnessing Opportunities and Ensuring Rights and Choices for All." The theme of World Population Day 2024 was – "To Leave No One Behind, Count Everyone." The theme of World Population Day 2025 was – "Empowering young people to create the families they want in a fair and hopeful world."
- At the time of the question, from the population point of view, most of the five largest countries of the world –China, India, the United States of America, Indonesia and Brazil – except Indonesia and Brazil, namely China, India and the United States, were located between 20°–40° north latitudes.
- According to Census 2011, India's population was 17.5 percent of the world's population.
- At the time of the question, option (b) was the correct answer.
- According to World Statistics 2008, about 61 percent of the world's population lived in Asia.
- At the time of the question and according to updated data also, among the given options Indonesia has the highest population.
- At the time of the question, option (d) was the correct answer.
- According to mid-year estimates for 2025, Brazil's population is 212.8 million, which is the highest among South American countries.
- At the time of the question and in the updated context also, option (c) is the correct answer.
- At the time of the question and at present also, among the above options, Dominica has the highest population.
- At the time of the question, among the optional regions, the minimum population growth rate was in Europe.
- Assertion (A) is false, whereas Reason (R) is true.
- General Studies (Economic & Social Development) At the time of the question and according to updated data also, option (a) is the correct answer.
- According to the UN Population Division Data Portal, based on World Population Prospects 2024, the population density of the countries mentioned in the question in 2025 is as follows— Country Population density (2025) Mongolia 2 Saudi Arabia 16 Iraq 108 Afghanistan 68
- At the time of the question and according to the UN Population Division Data Portal, based on World Population Prospects 2024, in 2025 the sex ratio of the optional countries is as follows— Country Sex ratio (2025): number of men per 100 women Sweden 101.5 Switzerland 98.8 Netherlands 98.8 Finland 97.8 1088
- Among the options given in the question, the rate of decrease in sex ratio in the world is associated with an increase in sex-determination tests.
- On the basis of religion, the population of Christians, Muslims, Hindus and Buddhists is in descending order respectively.
- According to the World Urbanization Prospects: Revision 2018 report issued by the Population Division of the United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UNDESA), in 2018, 55.3 percent of the world's population lived in urban areas.
- The change in the level of urbanization over time is called the urbanization curve.
- According to the data given in the World's Cities Report 2016 issued by UN-Habitat, in 2016, 54.5 percent of the world population lived in urban settlements.
- In the 20th century, the process of urbanization was rapid in developed countries, but after that, due to population explosion and rural-urban migration, this process became rapid in developing countries.

- According to UN-Habitat's report on the condition of world cities, the bases for determining the prosperity of cities include productivity, quality of life, equity, etc., but not optimum population.
- China's urban population is greater than the total population of Indonesia and even the total population of the United States of America.
- According to the World Cities Report, 2024, in 2020 the share of urban population in the total population of optional regions was as follows— Region East Asia South Asia Europe Oceania Urban population as percentage of total population 64.8% 36.6% 74.9% 68.2%
- At the time mentioned in the question and according to the World Bank also, in 2024 the most urbanized country among optional countries is Singapore, where 100 percent of the population lives in urban areas.
- At the time of the question and according to data issued by the World Bank also, among the optional countries, option (c) is the correct answer.
- Among the countries given in the options, at the time of the question the most urbanized country was Pakistan.
- According to the question period and among the given options, at present also option (d) is the correct answer.
- Industrialization is a period of social and economic transformation which changes a human group from an agricultural society to an industrial society.
- Most Asian cities suffer from the problem of excessive urbanization.
- In developed western countries, agriculture is mainly carried out with modern mechanized technology, which is mainly done by men, and women mostly work in secondary and tertiary sectors in cities.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1091 According to the World Migration Report, 2000, the total population of migrants in the world was 173 million, which was 2.8 percent of the then world population.
- At the time of the question, option (a) was correct, whereas at present option (c) is correct.
- In China, the total fertility rate (TFR) fell from 5.0 in the 1970s to the replacement level of 2.1 in the early 1990s.
- At the time of the question, among the optional countries, the minimum fertility rate was that of Italy, whereas in 2024 and 2025 it is that of China.
- Among developed countries, life expectancy at birth is the highest in Japan.
- About 80 percent of the world population is not covered by social security.
- At the time of the question, the World Development Report, 2006 declared Bangladesh as the poorest nation in South Asia.
- In 1952, India launched the world's first national family planning programme.

## Historical Scenario

- Among the options given in the question, sufficient authentic written evidence is available regarding Buddha, Nawabs, and Maharajas, whereas information about Rama is derived only from the epic Ramayana.
- The archaeological material obtained from Alamgirpur reflects Harappan culture.
- Mandi – It is located in Muzaffarnagar district of Uttar Pradesh, and a hoard of Harappan gold ornaments was found here.
- Some of the earliest evidence of agriculture in the world has been found at many excavated archaeological sites in Uttar Pradesh.
- Begum Samru (died in 1836 A.D.) got a very famous church built at Sardhana near Meerut.
- The mausoleum of Nawab Shuja-ud-Daula's Begum, Ammatuz-Zahra/Ummat-ul-Zohra Bano, popularly known as "Bahu Begum," is located in Faizabad (Ayodhya).
- Malihabad Kanpur Moradabad Lucknow
- Bismil at his birthplace, Shahjahanpur in Uttar Pradesh.
- Alfred Park (Company Bagh) is situated in Allahabad (now Prayagraj).
- On 11 June, 2021, the Ministry of Culture and Tourism, as part of Azadi ka Amrit Mahotsav, organized a special function on the occasion of the birth anniversary of Shaheed Ram Prasad General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) (b) Allahabad (d) Varanasi
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006 Bharat Kala Bhavan Museum is situated in Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi.
- Vindhyachal is located in Mirzapur, Deva Sharif in Barabanki, and Hastinapur in Meerut, whereas Shringverpur is located in Allahabad (now Prayagraj) district.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 The Bharat Mata Temple is situated in the campus of Mahatma Gandhi Kashi Vidyapith in Varanasi.
- Dayal Bagh, located in Agra, is associated with the Radha Swami sect.

- The correct matching is as follows— Fatehpur Sikri – Akbar Jaunpur – Firoz Shah Tughlaq Agra – Sikandar Lodi Jama Masjid, Badaun – Iltutmish 1096
- Chunar Fort is located at Chunar in eastern Uttar Pradesh.
- The correct matching is as follows— Kanak Bhavan – Ayodhya Kamadgiri Mountain – Chitrakoot Kalinjar Fort – Banda Deva Sharif – Barabanki
- The correct matching is as follows— Chaurasi Gumbad – Jalaun Jama Masjid – Moradabad Buddhist Stupa – Kushinagar Kamadgiri Mountain – Chitrakoot
- In 1775, Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula shifted his capital from Faizabad to Lucknow and developed the capital in a planned manner.
- The correct matching is as follows— Session venue Year Meerut – 1946 Kanpur – 1925 Lucknow – 1916 Banaras – 1905 Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the Lists : List-I List-II (Year of Congress (Place of Congress Session) Session in U.P.) A.
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) The correct matching is as follows— Year of Congress Session Place of Congress Session in Uttar Pradesh 1892 – Allahabad (President– W.C.
- Kalinjar Fort, situated in Banda district of Uttar Pradesh, was a historically and strategically important fort of Bundelkhand.
- The Government of Uttar Pradesh celebrates ‘Uttar Pradesh Day’ every year on 24 January.

# PART IV - UTTAR PRADESH SPECIAL

## Political Scenario

- The first Governor of Uttar Pradesh (also the first woman Governor in India) was Mrs.
- U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998 The chronological order of the above Chief Ministers of Uttar Pradesh is as follows—Dr.
- * Who was the first woman Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh? [U.P.
- Under the new Constitution of the Indian Republic, the first session of the Uttar Pradesh Legislative Assembly began on 2 February 1950, and Purushottam Das Tandon became the first Speaker of the Assembly.
- The peacock is not included in the State Emblem of Uttar Pradesh, whereas all the other symbols given in the options are included.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 So far, 2 women have served as Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh.
- 80 members are elected from Uttar Pradesh to the Lok Sabha, while 31 seats in the Rajya Sabha are allotted to Uttar Pradesh.
- The position of these major political parties in the U.P.
- In April 2012, Mata Prasad Pandey was elected as the Speaker of the Sixteenth Legislative Assembly of Uttar Pradesh.
- In the 2012 Uttar Pradesh Legislative Assembly elections, a total of 582 women were in the fray, out of whom 35 were successful in winning the election, including the highest number, 20, from the Samajwadi Party.
- In November 2017, elections were conducted in three phases for a total of 652 urban local bodies in Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009; U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008 The first citizen of a city is the Mayor, the first citizen of a state is the Governor, and the first citizen of the country is the President.
- At present, 17 towns in Uttar Pradesh have attained the status of a Municipal Corporation.
- At the time of the question, Faizabad had a Municipal Council in existence, whereas Aligarh, Moradabad, and Saharanpur already had Municipal Corporations.
- The local self-government institution of Jhansi is the Municipal Corporation, of Machhlishahr is the Nagar Panchayat, of Tundla is the Municipal Council, and of Saifai is the Area Committee.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2010 At present, all four exist in Lucknow: Jal Sansthan, Municipal Corporation, Development Authority, and District Urban Development Agency.
- In Uttar Pradesh, the principal tax levied by the Zila Panchayat is on circumstances and property.
- In Uttar Pradesh, the Gram Pradhan is elected by all electors included in the electoral roll of the territorial area of the Panchayat, from among the electors of the same area.
- U.P. P.C.S (Pre) 2016 In Uttar Pradesh, all three are included in the District Plan: Nagar Panchayat, Kshetra Panchayat, and Gram Panchayat.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008 The 71st district of Uttar Pradesh was Kanshiram Nagar (present name—Kasganj).
- 1 1 3 4 2 2 U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008 The correct matching is as follows– District Headquarters Ambedkar Nagar – Akbarpur Kanpur Dehat – Akbarpur Mati Jalaun – Orai Siddharth Nagar – Naugarh
- Uttar Pradesh’s share in India’s total exports stood at 4.80 percent and 5.65 percent respectively, ranking fifth among the states of the country.
- For the financial year 2023–24, the size of Uttar Pradesh’s budget was not Rs.

## Economic Scenario

- According to the question, among the given options, Allahabad (now Prayagraj) is not an Export Promotion Centre, whereas Agra, Khurja (Bulandshahr), and Meerut are Export Promotion Centres.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2016 In 2014-15, Uttar Pradesh’s share in India’s total exports was about 4.5 percent.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2022 The Uttar Pradesh Government presented a total budget of Rs.
- The size of the Uttar Pradesh Budget for 2018–19 was Rs.
- The Koshvani portal has been developed by the Uttar Pradesh Finance Department and NIC, Lucknow.
- According to NITI Aayog’s Fiscal Health Index 2025 report (January 2025), Uttar Pradesh’s overall Fiscal Health Index (FHI) score in the financial year 2022–23 was 45.9, whereas during the period from 2014 to 2019, the state’s Fiscal Health Index score was recorded as 37.0.

- With reference to the period asked in the question, option (b) was the nearest correct answer.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004 In the Bundelkhand region, agriculture is the main source of livelihood, and the region remains highly underdeveloped.
- The western region of Uttar Pradesh is more developed than the other regions of the state because, after the Green Revolution, due to greater availability of high-yielding variety seeds, fertilizers, and increased use of irrigation, this region advanced more in agriculture.
- GIDA is the abbreviation of Gorakhpur Industrial Development Authority.
- The headquarters of the Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Corporation (UPSIDC) is located in Kanpur.
- Udyog Bandhu (now Invest UP) is an organization of the state of Uttar Pradesh dedicated to facilitating investment in the industrial and service sectors and solving problems related to industries.
- 'Nivesh Mitra' is the single-window clearance portal of the Uttar Pradesh Government, launched under the state's investment promotion and facilitation agency Invest UP.
- Among the given options, Theme Park, Agra is not currently an upcoming major investment project of the Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority (earlier known as Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Corporation).
- Uttar Pradesh State Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.
- The Uttar Pradesh Financial Corporation (UPFC) was established in 1954 under the State Financial Corporations Act, 1951.
- In the Uttar Pradesh Budget 2018–19, provision was made for the establishment of a Single Window Clearance Department in the Chief Minister's Office to provide online facilities under one roof for approvals, sanctions, permissions, and licences related to industrial units.
- The handloom industry is the industry providing the highest employment opportunities in Uttar Pradesh.
- Agriculture has an important contribution to the economy of Uttar Pradesh.
- According to Census 2011, Uttar Pradesh has the highest number of workers in all categories.
- With reference to the period of the question, Uttar Pradesh had a share of about 9.4% in the country's GDP (according to the Uttar Pradesh Budget Estimates 2025–26, it is 8.62%), whereas Uttar Pradesh has never had a 66% share in the country's total exports.
- Both the assertion (A) and the reason (R) are correct, but the reason does not clearly explain the assertion.
- The largest share of the total revenue receipts of the Uttar Pradesh Government was obtained from trade tax, which was about 55 percent during the period concerned.
- *UPPSC Question Papers (b) Kanpur (d) Noida
- The first 'Deen Dayal Hastkala Sankul' Trade Facilitation Centre and Craft Museum is located in Varanasi.
- In 2004-05, the contribution of indirect taxes to the total tax revenue of Uttar Pradesh was about 76 percent.
- During the time of question, the share of direct taxes in the total tax revenue of the Uttar Pradesh Government had increased.
- Uttar Pradesh recorded its highest industrial growth rate in the 10th Five-Year Plan.
- During the Ninth Five-Year Plan, Uttar Pradesh's industrial growth rate remained negative.
- Taking an important step to strengthen e-governance in Uttar Pradesh, the state government announced in October 2020 that the first data centre of Uttar Pradesh would be established in Greater Noida.
- During the time of question, the lowest number of rural families below the poverty line in Uttar Pradesh was found in Baghpat district.
- The 'Zero Poverty Uttar Pradesh Campaign' was announced by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Gandhi Jayanti, 2 October 2024.
- Under the Aspirational District Programme launched by NITI Aayog in 2018, eight (8) districts of Uttar Pradesh are included among the total 112 aspirational districts of the country.
- In the financial year 2010–11, Uttar Pradesh had the secondhighest contribution to India's total Gross Domestic Product (GDP), after Maharashtra.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2004 General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) Agricultural labour productivity is highest in Western Uttar Pradesh.
- The major causes of low per capita income in Uttar Pradesh are rapidly increasing population, lack of enterprise, and inadequate infrastructural facilities, which are given in statements 1, 2 and
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004 The gap between per capita national income and per capita state income of Uttar Pradesh is continuously increasing, and compared to the whole country, the percentage of cultivators in total workers is higher in Uttar Pradesh.

- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015 The present government of Uttar Pradesh is focusing on the development of infrastructure, energy production, industry, etc.
- At the time of the question, Moradabad and Kanpur were among the places where Special Economic Zones (SEZs) were being established.
- In Uttar Pradesh, the maximum contribution in traditional industrial goods production (in million tonnes) is of the sugar industry.
- According to the updated available figures for 2024–25 (provisional), Uttar Pradesh ranks first in the country in sugar production.

## Geographical Scenario

- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 Uttar Pradesh does not share a boundary with Punjab.
- The boundary line of Uttar Pradesh touches 8 states and 1 Union Territory of India, that is, a total of 9 administrative units.
- Ballia is the easternmost city of Uttar Pradesh, whose eastern boundary meets the state of Bihar.
- Among the districts mentioned, Lalitpur shares its land boundary only with Jhansi district.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 The boundary of Lucknow district touches Barabanki district in the east, Unnao district in the west, Rae Bareli district in the south, and the boundaries of Sitapur and Hardoi districts in the north.
- According to the Uttar Pradesh Statistical Diary, 2022 and Census 2011, the areas of the districts given in the options are as follows— District Area (sq km) Gautam Buddha Nagar – 1,282 Barabanki – 4,402 Mirzapur – 4,405 Sonbhadra – 6,905 Thus, it is clear that the ascending order of the districts in terms of geographical area is—Gautam Buddha Nagar, Barabanki, Mirzapur and Sonbhadra.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005 Among the given options, Gautam Buddha Nagar is the district with the minimum area in Uttar Pradesh, having an area of 1,282 sq km.
- According to Census 2011, Lakhimpur Kheri is the largest district of Uttar Pradesh in terms of area.
- The districts referred to in the question and their areas are as follows— District Area (sq km) Varanasi – 1,535 Jaunpur – 4,038 Allahabad (now Prayagraj) – 5,482 Ghazipur – 3,377 Clearly, among the given districts, Varanasi has the smallest area.
- The correct order of the districts mentioned from north to south is—Siddharth Nagar → Sant Kabir Nagar → Ambedkar Nagar → Sant Ravidas Nagar (Bhadohi).
- Sonbhadra district does not share a boundary with Allahabad (now Prayagraj), because Mirzapur district lies between Sonbhadra and Allahabad districts.
- ‘Anna Pratha’ is a curse for the development of agriculture and forestry in the Bundelkhand region of Uttar Pradesh.

## Climate and Forest

- Uttar Pradesh has been divided into 4 economic regions– Eastern Division, Western Division, Central Division, and Bundelkhand Division.
- See the explanation of the above question.
- The Upper Ganga Plain agro-climatic region includes the central and western parts of Uttar Pradesh.
- According to a state-level assessment (GIZ-UP DoE, 2021), Bundelkhand has been identified as the “most vulnerable agro-climatic region” in all three scenarios– present, RCP 4.5, and RCP 8.5– on the basis of climate risk, vulnerability, and minimum adaptive capacity.
- According to the India State of Forest Report (ISFR), 2023, only 6.24 percent of the total geographical area of Uttar Pradesh is under forest cover, and when tree cover is included, this percentage reaches 9.96.
- Only the following three districts of Uttar Pradesh have more than 20 percent of their area under forest:

## Population and Urbanisation

- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 The top 4 states of India in terms of area are–
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 According to the final figures of Census 2011, the population of Uttar Pradesh was 19,98,12,341, which was about 16.5 percent of the total population of the country.
- According to Census 2011 figures, Uttar Pradesh was the fifth largest state in India in terms of area.

- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015 According to Census 2011, the population of Uttar Pradesh was 16.50 percent of India's population.
- According to the provisional figures of Census 2011, the statement in option (c) was not correct.
- According to the final figures of Census 2011, the literacy rate in Uttar Pradesh increased by 11.42 percentage points between 2001 and 2011.
- According to Census 2001, the literacy rate of Uttar Pradesh was 56.3 percent, while Rajasthan had 60.4 percent, Odisha 63.1 percent, and Bihar 47.0 percent.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2010 In the given statement, both the assertion and the reason are correct, but (R) does not correctly explain (A).
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) District Literacy Rate (in 2011, percent) Allahabad – 72.3 Varanasi – 75.6 Bareilly – 58.5 Ghaziabad – 78.1 Therefore, among the districts given in the options, Ghaziabad (78.1%) had the highest literacy rate according to Census 2011.
- Shravasti is the district with the lowest literacy in Uttar Pradesh.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1113 Among the given options, the decadal population growth rate of Uttar Pradesh was higher than the national average during 1971 to 1981.
- U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010 During 1991-2001, the sex ratio in Uttar Pradesh improved by 19 points (from 879 in 1991 to 898 in 2001), which was the highest among the decades mentioned in the question.
- Therefore, the disparity in sex ratio declined the most in Uttar Pradesh between 1991 and 2001.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2010 According to Census 2001, Uttar Pradesh ranked 9th in India in terms of population density.
- U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010 According to Census 2001, statements 1 and 4 were correct.
- The Uttar Pradesh Law Commission issued a bill on population control, whose official name is the "Uttar Pradesh Population (Control, Stabilization and Welfare) Bill, 2021." This bill sets a target of bringing down the Total Fertility Rate (TFR), and not the birth rate, to 2.1.
- The list of cities of Uttar Pradesh selected by the Centre under the Smart City Mission is as follows–
- The National Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY) was launched on 21 January 2015.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009 According to Census 2001, the order of the million-plus cities in question was– Kanpur, Lucknow, Agra, Varanasi.
- Kanpur and Lucknow of Uttar Pradesh became million-plus cities in the Census years 1971 and 1981 respectively.
- The population of Uttar Pradesh out exceeds that of –
- According to Census 2011, the female population in Uttar Pradesh is approximately 48% (47.71%) of the total population.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Spl.) (Pre) 2010 The state with the highest urban population in India is not Uttar Pradesh, but Maharashtra.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 According to the Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin, 2013, released in September 2014, the birth rate in Uttar Pradesh was 27.2 per 1000 population, which was higher than India's birth rate of 21.4.
- U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010 The first population policy of the state was announced on 11 July 2000, in which population growth was linked not with restrictive measures but with the broader issues of poverty, health, and development.
- In the Uttar Pradesh Population Policy declared in 2000, the target was to reduce the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) to 2.1 by 2016.
- According to Census 2001, the districts of Uttar Pradesh with the highest and lowest density of population (persons/ sq km) were Varanasi and Lalitpur respectively.
- According to Census 2001, among the given options, population concentration (density) was highest in Kanpur Nagar district, while in the entire state it was highest in Varanasi.
- According to both the provisional and final figures of Census 2011, the five most populous districts are– Allahabad (Prayagraj) > Moradabad > Ghaziabad > Azamgarh > Lucknow.
- According to the final figures of Census 2011, Mahoba district had the lowest population in the state (8,75,958).
- According to Census 2001, the descending order of population of the districts in question was– Allahabad, Gorakhpur, Lucknow, Mathura.
- According to Census 2011, among the religious communities in Uttar Pradesh, Hindus are the largest (15,93,12,654), Muslims are second (3,84,83,967), and Sikhs are third (6,43,500).
- U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008 The 15th Census of the country was divided into two phases.

- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008 According to Census 2001 and 2011, the Scheduled Tribe population in the districts given in the options is as follows– District 2001 2011 Kheri 37,949 53,375 Balrampur 19,347 24,887 Bahraich 8,558 11,159 Shravasti 4,756 5,534 Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.
- According to Census 2011, the districts with the highest Scheduled Tribe population in the state are respectively Sonbhadra, Ballia, and Deoria.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007 At the time of the question, the life expectancy of males in Uttar Pradesh (during 2002–06) was 60.1 years, whereas on the basis of 2015–19 data, male life expectancy in the state is 65.0 years and female life expectancy is 66.2 years, while the average life expectancy of the total population is 65.6 years.
- According to Census 2001, rural and urban population in Uttar Pradesh were 79.22 percent and 20.78 percent respectively.
- The geographical area of Uttar Pradesh is 240928 sq km (about 2,41,000 sq km).

## Wildlife & Bird Sanctuaries

- The largest wildlife sanctuary in Uttar Pradesh is Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary.
- Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary is located in Chandauli district of Uttar Pradesh.
- An Asiatic Lion Breeding Centre and Lion Safari Park was developed in Etawah district of Uttar Pradesh, which has now been renamed as Etawah Safari Park (Lion Breeding Centre and Multiple Safari Park).
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) In Uttar Pradesh Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary is located in the district [
- Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary/Bird Sanctuary is located in Sant Kabir Nagar district of Uttar Pradesh, Okhla Wildlife Sanctuary/Bird Sanctuary in Gautam Buddha Nagar district, Sandi Wildlife Sanctuary/Bird Sanctuary in Hardoi district, and Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary in Lalitpur district.
- Suraha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan) Bird Sanctuary is located in Ballia district.
- The locations of the Ramsar sites mentioned in the question are as follows: Sarsai Nawar Jheel – Etawah, Uttar Pradesh Samaspur Bird Sanctuary – Rae Bareli, Uttar Pradesh Rudrasagar Lake – Located in the state of Tripura Sultanpur National Park – Located in the state of Haryana Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

## Mineral Resources

- The formal publication of the state's first mineral policy was made on 29 December, 1998.
- Mica is not found in Uttar Pradesh, whereas the other minerals mentioned in the question are found here.
- B 2 2 3 3 C 3 1 1 2■ U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008 Cement-grade limestone is mainly found in Sonbhadra district.
- Among the options given, the major minerals found in Uttar Pradesh are limestone and dolomite.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007 Coal reserves are found in the Singrauli region of Sonbhadra district in Uttar Pradesh.
- Limited reserves of uranium have been discovered in Lalitpur district of Uttar Pradesh.

## Agriculture, Soil and Crops

- Uttar Pradesh is an agriculture-dominated state.
- With the objective of doubling farmers' income, the Uttar Pradesh Government constituted the 'Krishak Samriddhi Commission' in November 2017.
- The 'Kisan Mitra Yojana' was officially launched by the Agriculture Department of the state government on 18 June, 2001.
- The Uttar Pradesh Agricultural Research Council is located in Lucknow.
- In Uttar Pradesh, the first phase of the 'Uttar Pradesh Agricultural Diversification Project' (U.P.
- The Uttar Pradesh State Organic Certification Agency was established in accordance with the order of the Uttar Pradesh Government dated 21 August, 2007.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 The most effective factor in increasing agricultural production in Uttar Pradesh is the use of improved varieties of seeds.
- In 2005, the Uttar Pradesh Government announced a new agricultural policy to promote the agricultural sector, in which a target of achieving a 4 percent growth rate in agriculture was fixed.
- U.P. P.C.S (Mains) 2016 The traditional land measurement unit in Uttar Pradesh is 'Bigha'.
- Small and marginal farmers are predominant in Uttar Pradesh.
- Red soil is mainly found in Jhansi division and in Mirzapur and Sonbhadra districts.

- The soils found in the Bundelkhand region can be broadly divided into two categories – (1) Black soil and (2) Red soil.
- *UPPSC Question Papers (b) April-May (d) October-December
- Both at the time of the question and at present, option (d) is the correct answer in the context of the pulse crops mentioned.
- Uttar Pradesh ranks first in the country in milk production, and the maximum potato cultivation in the country is also done here.
- Statement 1 is correct; in recent years, including 2023-24 and 2024-25, Uttar Pradesh has held the top position among all states in potato production.
- At the time of the question, Uttar Pradesh was the leading producer of barley.
- *UPPSC Question Papers U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl.) (Pre) 2003 1123 Among the pulse crops mentioned, moong has the shortest duration.
- In both 2023-24 and 2024-25, Uttar Pradesh remained the top food grain producing state in the country.
- India produces about 80 percent of the world's total mentha oil, of which the highest production takes place in Uttar Pradesh.
- According to the Uttar Pradesh Statistical Diary, 2024, in 2023-24 the area under wheat in Uttar Pradesh was 10,004 thousand hectares, which was the highest among major crops.
- According to the final estimates released by the Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare for 201213, Uttar Pradesh, with 30.30 million tonnes of wheat production, contributed 32.41 percent of the country's total wheat production.
- At the time of the question, Uttar Pradesh ranked second in rice cultivated area in India, while it ranked third in production.
- Pratapgarh is the largest producer of aonla in Uttar Pradesh.
- Saharanpur district has the highest orange production in Uttar Pradesh.
- Lucknow district is the highest producer of Dashehari mango in Uttar Pradesh.
- Dashehari is the mango variety occupying the largest area in Uttar Pradesh.
- Uttar Pradesh is the top sugarcane-producing state in India, and it is the state's principal commercial crop.
- ● ■Sugarcane is the most important cash crop of Uttar Pradesh.

## Dams, Rivers and Means of Irrigation

- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007 Arjun Dam was built on the Arjun River at Charkhari in Mahoba district of Uttar Pradesh.
- The Paricha Dam of Uttar Pradesh, located in Jhansi, is situated on the Betwa River.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009, 2012 The Rani Lakshmibai Sagar Project is located on the Betwa River.
- The correct matching is as follows— Name of Dam Adwa Ahraura Badua Baghdkhand Location (District) Mirzapur (U.P.) Mirzapur (U.P.) Banka (Bihar) Balrampur (U.P.)
- The first floating solar power plant of Uttar Pradesh is being built on Rihand Dam in Sonbhadra district at a cost of ■750 crore.
- The Gokul Barrage Project is a drinking water project of Uttar Pradesh.
- Sharda Canal is the largest canal system of Uttar Pradesh.
- The point of origin of the Lower Ganga Canal is Narora (Bulandshahr).
- Keeping in view the adequate availability of water in the Ganga River throughout the year, the Middle Ganga Canal Project was constructed.
- The main river flowing through Jaunpur city is the Gomti, whereas the Sai River, flowing from Pratapgarh through rural areas of Jaunpur, joins the Gomti.
- *UPPSC Question Papers U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2010 General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) Varanasi is situated on the bank of the Ganga River, Ayodhya on the bank of the Saryu, and Sultanpur on the bank of the Gomti.
- Among the major rivers, the Gomti originates in the plains of Pilibhit district of Uttar Pradesh.
- The Ganga enters Uttar Pradesh through Bijnor district and exits the state in Ballia district.
- The Jhelum River originates from Verinag, near Anantnag (Jammu and Kashmir), from Sheshnag Lake.
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) The Ramganga River joins the Ganga near Kannauj, whereas the Betwa does not join the Yamuna near Prayagraj but near Hamirpur.

- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 In Uttar Pradesh, flood-prone areas are classified into high, medium and low flood-prone regions.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2004 From the point of view of irrigation intensity, Uttar Pradesh ranks third in the country after Punjab and Haryana.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011 Among the options given, Etawah district is the most affected by alluvial erosion.

## Transportation

- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 In Uttar Pradesh, G.T.
- 1128 6. U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007 National Highway No.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 The Yamuna Expressway (earlier known as Taj Expressway) passes through the districts of Gautam Buddha Nagar, Aligarh, Mathura, Hathras and Agra.
- On 16 November 2021, Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Purvanchal Expressway in Sultanpur district of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 Under the Dream Project of the then Chief Minister Akhilesh Yadav, the low-cost A.C.
- At present, the proposed Taj International Airport is being established at Jewar village near Greater Noida in Gautam Buddh Nagar district.
- On 24 June 2020, the Union Cabinet approved granting international airport status to Kushinagar Airport (U.P.).
- Rajiv Gandhi National Aviation University is located at Fursatganj in Amethi district of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011; U.P.Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002 The correct matching is— Lucknow – Amausi Varanasi – Babatpur Kanpur – Chakeri Agra – Kheria
- Fursatganj Airport is in Amethi, whereas Agra has Kheria Airport.

## Cultural Activities

- Dhuriya dance is performed by the Kumhar community of Bundelkhand wearing special dress.
- All the three dances mentioned in the question are important folk dances of Uttar Pradesh.
- Kartik dance is performed in the Bundelkhand region during the month of Kartik by men dressed as Shri Krishna and Gopis.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016 Swala, Badhaiya and Rai are folk dances of the Bundelkhand region of Uttar Pradesh, whereas Dandiya is a popular folk dance of Gujarat.
- Charukula dance is performed in the Braj region of Uttar Pradesh.
- Charukula is a folk dance of Braj region.
- 8. “Rahula” folk drama is associated with Bundelkhand region of Uttar Pradesh.
- Charukula, Charkha and Karma are folk dances of Uttar Pradesh, whereas Muriya is related to Madhya Pradesh.
- Major folk dances of Uttar Pradesh include Charukula, Karma, Paedand, Rai, Jhanjha, Natwari, Kartik, Dheever, Shobhiya, etc.
- Birha, Kajri and Rasia are folk songs of Uttar Pradesh, whereas Dhoal-Maru is a folk song of Rajasthan.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Spl.) (Pre) 2010 Dhola is a popular folk song of the Agra and Meerut regions.
- The major folk songs of Uttar Pradesh are Rasia, Kajri, Alha, Birha, Chaiti and Dola.
- Braji 4. Kauravi C 4 3 3 2 D 3 4 1 4■ Karma is a tribal folk dance of Sonbhadra and Mirzapur.
- “Alha” is a famous heroic ballad of the Bundelkhand region.
- This folk line is associated with “Alha” of the Bundelkhand region of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004 Birha is a famous folk singing tradition of Purvanchal, in which singers narrate local events in Bhojpuri.
- U.P.U.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2010 General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special)
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009 Holi and Raas are associated with Braj; Kajri and Birha are linked with Mirzapur-Banaras; the Nautanki tradition is associated with Pandit Natharam Sharma of Hathras; and the pehlwan singing tradition is associated with Kanpur.
- List II (Occasion of singing) Sanskar geet Braj Lokgeet Vivah and seasonal geet Seasonal geet U.P.
- Alha is famous in Bundelkhand. Birha is a major folk song of Purvanchal.
- Ans. (a) U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009 Hathras and Kanpur are two important places in Uttar Pradesh where Swang took root and developed.

- U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2012, 2016 Lathmar Holi is associated with Barsana.
- Lachhu Maharaj was associated with Kathak.
- Rasoolan Bai, Moti Bai and Siddheshwari Devi are associated with the Banaras gharana, whereas Begum Akhtar is associated with the Patiala gharana.
- The famous Thumri singer Girija Devi was born on 8 May 1929 in a village near Varanasi.
- Thumri is a style of Indian classical music.
- Correct matching – Ustad Vilayat Khan Master Pita Husain Narsi Sitara Devi Jatin Bhattacharya – – – – Sitar Hindi Theatre Kathak Sarod
- Among the options given above, all except option (c) are correctly matched.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 Etawah is known for the Imdad Khani gharana of sitar and surbahar music.
- Apart from Mehdi, the other three Bindadin, Ustad Faiyaz Khan and Inayat Khan made important contributions to the cultural arts of Lucknow.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 Shambhu Maharaj was a Kathak artist of the Lucknow gharana.
- The Rang Theatre was located at G.P.O., Lucknow.
- Consider the following statements with reference to Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Academy : (1) It was established in the year 1965.
- Kathak is the state dance of Uttar Pradesh.
- The correct matching is— Rajya Lalit Kala Akademi, Lucknow – 1962 Uttar Pradesh Sangeet Natak Akademi, Lucknow – 1963 Bharatendu Natya Akademi, Lucknow – 1975 Ayodhya Shodh Sansthan, Ayodhya – 1986
- Guru Purnima is important for both Hindus and Buddhists in Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 The Mudiya Purnima fair, also known as the Mudiya Puno fair, is held every year at Govardhan in the Mathura– Vrindavan area on the occasion of Guru Purnima (the full moon of Ashadha).
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Spl.) (Pre) 2010 Varanasi is a famous pilgrimage place of both Jain and Buddhist religions.
- Every year a fair is held at the shrine of the famous Sufi saint Haji Waris Ali Shah at Dewa Sharif in Barabanki.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021 The Baldev Chhath fair is organized at the Shridauji temple in Jewar (Noida, western Uttar Pradesh).
- The correct matching is— Kailash fair – Agra Nauchandi fair – Meerut Kalinjar fair – Banda Soron fair – Kasganj (earlier in Etah)
- B 2 1 3 4 C D 3 4 2 3 1 4 1 2 U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Re- Exam) (Pre) 2016 The correct matching is— Devi Patan fair – Balrampur Kampil fair – Farrukhabad Bateshwar fair – Agra Dadri fair – Ballia
- The correct matching is— Bateshwar – Agra Dewa – Barabanki Haridas Jayanti – Vrindavan Nauchandi – Meerut * Haridas Jayanti is celebrated every year at [
- The correct matching is as follows— Place District of Uttar Pradesh Bateshwar – Agra Deva Sharif – Barabanki Sankisa – Farrukhabad Bithoor – Kanpur Nagar
- The correct matching is as follows— Cattle Fair – Bateshwar Dhrupad Mela – Varanasi Govind Sahib Mela – Ambedkar Nagar Magh Mela – Allahabad (present Prayagraj)
- The Mahakumbh Mela is organized in the 12th year.
- The correct matching is as follows— Mela Place Magh Mela – Allahabad (now Prayagraj) Jhula Mela – Vrindavan Cattle Fair – Bateshwar Deva Mela – Barabanki 1136
- The symbol of Hindu-Muslim unity, “Sulahkul Utsav”, is organized in Agra.
- The Nauchandi Mela is held at Nauchandi in Meerut.
- The correct matching is as follows— Name of pilgrimage site Town/Place Chakratirth – Naimisharanya Govind Dev Temple – Vrindavan Salim Chishti’s Dargah – Fatehpur Sikri Buddhist and Jain Temple – Kaushambi
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 Sankisa, situated in Farrukhabad district of Uttar Pradesh, is associated with Buddhism.
- • Samaspur Bird Sanctuary is in Rae Bareli, not in Amethi.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011 J.K. Temple is situated in Kanpur, whereas the other pairs are correctly matched.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011, U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 The famous religious magazine “Kalyan” was first published from Bombay in 1926.

## Industrial and Scientific Institutions

- In Uttar Pradesh, H.C.L. IT City has been established in Lucknow, and Ansal IT City and Parks has been established in Greater Noida.

- In Uttar Pradesh, the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) is situated at Allahabad (now Prayagraj).
- Dr. Ambedkar Institute of Technology for Divyangjan (earlier for Handicapped) was established in Kanpur in 1997.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017 After the death of a large number of children due to encephalitis at B.R.D.
- The Central Institute for Subtropical Horticulture is situated in Lucknow, not in Srinagar.
- The Indian Institute of Pulses Research is situated not in Agra but in Kanpur.
- The National Chamber of Industry and Commerce, U.P., was established in Agra in 1949.
- The “School of Paper Technology” was established in Saharanpur in 1964.
- The correct matching is as follows— Central Drug Research Institute Central Leprosy Institute (National JALMA Institute for Leprosy and Other Mycobacterial Diseases) Motilal Nehru National Institute of Technology Indian Institute of Sugar Technology (present name – National Sugar Institute) – Lucknow – Agra – Allahabad – Kanpur
- The correct matching is as follows— V.V.
- The Shiladhar Soil Science Institute is situated at Allahabad (now Prayagraj).
- Moradabad is famous for copper work and has made a distinct identity in this handicraft industry throughout the world.
- In the ODOP list of Uttar Pradesh, “Munj products” are notified for Prayagraj, Amethi and Sultanpur districts, whereas the notified product for Sant Kabir Nagar is “Brassware Craft (brass art/brass utensils)”.
- On 24 January 2018, on the occasion of “Uttar Pradesh Day”, the Government of Uttar Pradesh launched the “One District, One Product” scheme.
- The products mentioned in the question are all declared under “One District One Product”, and their matching is as follows— Kala Namak rice – Siddharth Nagar Desi ghee – Auraiya Amla – Pratapgarh Banana fibre – Kushinagar Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.
- The major centre of the match industry in Uttar Pradesh is Bareilly.
- The correct matching is as follows— Wooden toys – Varanasi Sports goods – Meerut Brass idols – Mathura Match industry – Bareilly *UPPSC Question Papers 1139
- The correct matching is as follows— Sports goods – Meerut Match industry – Bareilly Brass goods – Moradabad Wood carving – Saharanpur
- The correct matching is— Aligarh – Locks Firozabad – Bangles Muradabad – Brass utensils Tanda – Powerloom products Note: In the question, Tanda has been shown as a district, whereas Tanda is not a district but a town in Ambedkar Nagar district.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 The correct matching is as follows— Khurja – Pottery craft Meerut – Sports goods Jalesar – Cast bells Lakhimpur Kheri is not known for carved wood craft.
- The correct matching is as follows— Aonla – Fertilizer Modinagar – Rubber Barabanki – Poly fibre Kanpur – Biscuit The major centres of the leather industry in Uttar Pradesh are Kanpur and Agra.
- The Artificial Limbs Manufacturing Corporation of India (ALIMCO) is situated in Kanpur.
- At present, the operating artificial rubber factories in Uttar Pradesh are situated at Modinagar (Ghaziabad) and Partapur (Meerut).
- The Uttar Pradesh State Leather Development and Marketing Corporation Ltd.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1141 The correct matching is as follows— Agra – Tourism Kanpur – Leather goods Meerut – Sports goods Muradabad – Metal vessels
- Bareilly is famous for the surma industry in Uttar Pradesh.
- Kannauj is called the “City of Perfumes”.
- For cement, not Varanasi but Sonbhadra district of Uttar Pradesh is famous.
- The jute industry is associated with Ghaziabad, so this pair is not correctly matched.
- Kannauj district of Uttar Pradesh is famous for perfume, Bulandshahr (Khurja) for china-clay pottery, Pratapgarh for amla and related products, and Chitrakoot for the production of wooden toys.
- The correct matching is as follows— Terracotta – Gorakhpur Wooden toys – Varanasi China clay utensils – Chinhat Glassware – Firozabad
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 The factories situated at Dadri near Greater Noida, Chunar in Mirzapur district, and Churk and Dala in Sonbhadra all produce cement.
- Farrukhabad is known for hand printing work, which in the local language is called Zardozi.
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) The correct matching is as follows— Clay Utensils – Khurja Wood designing – Saharanpur Wooden footwear (Kharau) – Pilibhit Embroidery – Bareilly
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017 The city of Saharanpur in Uttar Pradesh is famous for the wood-carving cottage industry.

- The correct matching is as follows— Indian Telephone Industries – Raebareli Transformer Factory – Jhansi Artificial Limb Manufacturing Corporation – Kanpur Fertilizer Factory – Phulpur
- Among the above options, option (b) is not correctly matched.
- The first Biotechnology Park in Uttar Pradesh was established in Lucknow.
- With the cooperation of the Ministry of Food Processing Industries, Government of India, and through the Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Kanpur, two agro parks were developed at Kursi Road (Barabanki) and Karkhiyanv (Varanasi) to promote agro-based industries.
- In Greater Noida of Uttar Pradesh, a Knowledge Park has been established with the objective of providing quality institutional facilities in the fields of education and research.
- The biggest centre of the software and business process outsourcing industry in Uttar Pradesh is located at Noida.
- The establishment of the first Energy Education Park in Uttar Pradesh was proposed in Allahabad (now Prayagraj).
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 The Regional Science Centre, Lucknow was inaugurated on 7 September 1989, and it was upgraded as the Regional Science City on 21 September 2007.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008 The Indian Institute of Sugarcane Research (IISR), Lucknow is under the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR).
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 The Central Institute of Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP) is located in Lucknow.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) The Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute is located in Jhansi.
- Khurja, in Bulandshahr district of Uttar Pradesh, is famous for pottery.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 The U.P. Council of Sugarcane Research was first established in 1912 by George Clarke, then serving as Agricultural Chemist (who later became Director of Agriculture), as a research centre.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 The Central Potato Research Institute is located at Shimla (Himachal Pradesh).
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1145 The U.P. Council of Agricultural Research (UPCAR) is located in Lucknow.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 The National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI) is one of the country's leading national laboratories.
- Among all the given options, option (d) is not correctly matched, because the Indian Institute of Farming Systems Research is located in Meerut, not in Varanasi.
- The correct matching is as follows— Indian Institute of Vegetable Research – Varanasi (IIVR) Indian Institute of Pulses Research – Kanpur (IIPR) Indian Veterinary Research Institute – Izatnagar (Bareilly) (IVRI) Indian Grassland and Fodder Research – Jhansi Institute (IGFRI)
- Under the MoU signed on 22 April 2010, Bajaj Hindustan Ltd.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017 Diesel Locomotive Works (present name—Banaras Locomotive Works), Varanasi now manufactures both diesel and electric engines.
- Among the given options, option (c) "Modern Bakery – Lucknow" should actually be "Modern Bakery – Kanpur." Therefore, option (c) is incorrect.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Spl.) (Pre) 2010 Among the given options, option (c) is not correctly matched.
- IFFCO's urea factories in Uttar Pradesh are located at Aonla (Bareilly) and Phulpur (Prayagraj).
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) The pair "Fertilizer plant — Lucknow" is not correctly matched, while the other pairs are correctly matched.
- The oil refinery plant in Uttar Pradesh is located at Mathura.
- Lal Bahadur Shastri Sugarcane Farmers' Institute is located in Lucknow.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 For the all-round development of the Khadi and Village Industries sector in Uttar Pradesh, this Board was constituted in 1960 as an advisory board under the Uttar Pradesh Khadi and Village Industries Act, 1960.

## Educational and Sports Institutions

- According to the National Education Policy, 2020, the school curriculum and academic structure were reorganized into a 5+3+3+4 pattern.
- Operation Kayakalp is an inter-departmental programme launched by the Uttar Pradesh Government in June 2018.
- The Uttar Pradesh State Higher Education Council was established in 1995 at Lucknow under the Uttar Pradesh State Higher Education Act, 1995.
- In December 2013, the Uttar Pradesh Government decided to establish two new state medical colleges (state allopathic medical colleges) at Badaun and Jaunpur.

- The correct matching is— Jhansi – Maharani Laxmi Bai Medical College Kanpur – G.S.
- Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyay Veterinary Science University and Cow Research Institute, Uttar Pradesh, is located in Mathura district of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016 At present, there are 6 central universities in Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014 Rani Lakshmi Bai Central Agricultural University was established in Jhansi in 2014.
- Till 31 December 2017, there were 17 state universities under the Higher Education Department in Uttar Pradesh.
- General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) The only open University of Uttar Pradesh is located at [U.P.R.O./A.R.O.
- Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel University of Agriculture and Technology is located in Meerut.
- Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia National Law University, Lucknow, is a state university, whereas the other universities given in the options are central universities.
- *UPPSC Question Papers U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 1149 There are two universities in Uttar Pradesh named after Dr.
- The oldest university in Uttar Pradesh is Allahabad University, Allahabad (now Prayagraj).
- Mahatma Gandhi Kashi Vidyapith (now having the status of a state university) is situated in Varanasi district of Uttar Pradesh.
- The first music college established in Uttar Pradesh for music education was Bhatkhande Hindustani Sangeet Mahavidyalaya.
- The correct matching is— Bhatkhande Sangeet Sansthan Rajya Lalit Kala Academy U.P.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 The State Lalit Kala Academy is located in Lucknow.
- U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016 Bharteendu Natya Kendra was established in August 1975 by the Culture Department of the Uttar Pradesh Government.
- The Uttar Pradesh Government established “Maulana Mohammad Ali Jauhar Urdu University” in Rampur.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016; U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Mains) 2008 For the development of sports in Uttar Pradesh, the government established Guru Gobind Singh Sports College at Lucknow on 1 August 1975.

## Scheduled Tribes

- The tribes found in Varanasi district are Chero, Gond, Kharwar, Ojha, Nayak, Dhuriya, Pathari, etc.
- The Agariya tribe resides in Sonbhadra district of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016 The Jaunsari tribe has the practice of joint family.
- According to Census 2011, the Gond group is the largest tribal group in Uttar Pradesh (5,69,035).
- According to Census 2011, the Tharu tribe resides in Uttar Pradesh (1,05,291), Uttarakhand (91,342) and Bihar (1,59,939).
- The Buksa or Bhoksa tribe is found mainly in the districts of Bijnor and Agra in Uttar Pradesh.
- In Uttar Pradesh, the Tharu tribe is found in districts such as Lakhimpur Kheri, Gonda, Bahraich, Maharajganj and Gorakhpur.
- Anoothi Uphaar Yojana was launched by the Uttar Pradesh Government in 2021 to promote COVID vaccination in the state.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the “Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana” from Ballia district of Uttar Pradesh on 1 May 2016.
- Operation Green Project was launched in Uttar Pradesh in 2001.

## Plans / Projects

- The “Kalp Yojana” for primary education was started in Uttar Pradesh in 1998.
- Under the Union Ministry of Women and Child Development, Kishori Shakti Yojana was started in Uttar Pradesh in 2001.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007; U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2010 The only atomic energy centre in Uttar Pradesh is established at Narora (Bulandshahr).
- In Uttar Pradesh, the number of NTPC-owned coal-based power plants is 5—Singrauli, Rihand, Dadri, Unchahar and Tanda.
- U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010 Among the NTPC plants, Tanda and Unchahar thermal power stations are not gas-based, whereas Auraiya is gasbased and Dadri has both gas-based and coal-based thermal power plants.

- On 12 March 2018, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and French President Emmanuel Macron inaugurated a 100 MW solar power plant in Mirzapur district of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2010 3. Siksha Mitra of urban areas will get a monthly honorarium of Rs.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006 Among the given options, Ganga Expressway is a scheme of the Uttar Pradesh Government.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012; U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009 The “Shiksha Mitra Scheme” was started by the Uttar Pradesh Government in the academic session 2000-2001.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 The Mid-Day Meal Scheme (present name: PM-POSHAN) is a scheme operated through the combined efforts of the Government of India and the State Government.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009 To promote girls’ education, the Uttar Pradesh Government launched the Kanya Vidya Dhan Scheme in 2004-05.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012 For the primary education of all children in the age groups 6-11 years and 11-14 years, the “School Chalo Abhiyan” was started by the Uttar Pradesh Government in July 2000.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007 The Uttar Pradesh Government has shown its commitment by framing programmes that give high priority to providing primary education to all children in the 6-14 year age group.
- For the World Bank-financed “Sodic Land Reclamation Project-II,” a total of 17 districts of Uttar Pradesh had been selected.
- The Vikas Kendra Project in Uttar Pradesh was launched in December 2005.

## Languages and Dialects

- The Singrauli Small Hydel Project is located in Sonbhadra district of Uttar Pradesh.
- The centre of the Computer Aided Designing project in Uttar Pradesh is located in Lucknow, and it is known in short as “CAD.”
- U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003 General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special)
- “Bhojpuri” is a folk language spoken in Eastern Uttar Pradesh, Western Bihar, and Northern Jharkhand.
- *UPPSC Question Papers 1155 In Uttar Pradesh, Hindi written in Devanagari script was declared the official language in October 1947.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010, 2012 The Kanhaiyalal Maniklal Munshi Institute of Hindi Studies and Linguistics is located in Agra.
- For the proper development and promotion of Sanskrit, Pali, and Prakrit languages in the state, the Uttar Pradesh Sanskrit Sansthan was established on 31 December 1976.
- The Hindustani Academy, which was established in 1927 for the protection and development of Indian languages, is located in Allahabad (now Prayagraj).

## Awards/Honours

- 4 2 2 4 1 1 U.P.B.E.O. (Pre) 2019 The correct matching of writers and their pen names is as follows— Suryakant Tripathi – Nirala Raghupati Sahay – Firaq Gorakhpuri Vaidyanath Mishra – Nagarjun Dhanpat Rai Shrivastava – Munshi Premchand
- The correct matching of persons and honours received by them is as follows— Pt.
- On 22 August 2006, the Uttar Pradesh Government announced the institution of the annual “Sangeet Ratna Award” of ■5 lakh in memory of the famous shehnai player Ustad Bismillah Khan.
- At the Pravasi Diwas held in Agra in January 2016, 16 NonResident Indians were honoured with the Uttar Pradesh Ratna Award.
- Ranbir Singh, the volleyball player has received Arjun and Laxman Awards both.
- U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl.) (Pre) 2004 When this question was asked, the highest sports honour of Uttar Pradesh – the Laxman Award was given to Gyanendra Pandey.
- 'Yash Bharati Award' is provided by the Government of Uttar Pradesh.
- Narsingh Yadav of Uttar Pradesh won Gold Medal in 2010 Commonwealth Games in 74 kg freestyle wrestling category.

## U.P. Miscellaneous

- A National Law University will be established on 25 acres of land in Prayagraj.

- Among the wetlands of international importance included in the Ramsar list, the Surinsar-Mansar Lakes are located in Jammu and Kashmir.
- The Rail Coach Factory in Uttar Pradesh is located at Lalganj in Rae Bareli district.
- In October 2014, construction work of the Ekana International Cricket Stadium began in Lucknow district of Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014 The Uttar Pradesh Government had decided to observe the year 2015-16 as “Farmers’ Year.” The central theme of the Uttar Pradesh Government’s budget for 2023-24 was also “Self-reliant Uttar Pradesh.”
- The districts of Eastern Uttar Pradesh were the most affected by Japanese encephalitis (JE), but among these districts, Gorakhpur, Maharajganj, and Kushinagar were the most severely affected.
- In 2005, the Uttar Pradesh Government decided to provide green power to the Taj Trapezium Zone.
- Under the “Victim Compensation Scheme” notified by the Uttar Pradesh Government in February 2013, compensation of ■2 lakh for rape victims, ■1.5 lakh for acid-attack victims, ■2 lakh in case of murder, and ■2 lakh in cases of human trafficking was provided.
- “Jhini Jhini Bini Chadariya” was written by Abdul Bismillah.
- The founder of the “Gulabi Gang Movement” is Sampat Pal.
- In Western Uttar Pradesh, the “Khap Panchayat system” is found among the Jat community.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Spl.) (Mains) 2010 The first Lokayukta of Uttar Pradesh was Justice Vishambhar Dayal, whose tenure was from 14 September 1977 to 13 September 1982.
- With the establishment of the “Katra Cooperative Milk Committee” in Allahabad (now Prayagraj) in 1907, not only the first milk cooperative society of the state but also the first milk cooperative society of the country came into existence.
- Ans. (d) U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2015 So far, a total of six State Finance Commissions have been constituted in Uttar Pradesh.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015 General Studies (Uttar Pradesh : Special) U.P.
- The first sports village in Uttar Pradesh was established in Agra.
- The Aryabhata Planetarium is located in Rampur district of Uttar Pradesh.
- Jawahar Planetarium is located in Allahabad (now Prayagraj), Uttar Pradesh.
- The rail coach factory is being established in Rae Bareli, not in Amethi.
- U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006 Ghaziabad, located in Uttar Pradesh, is a satellite city of Delhi in the National Capital Region (NCR).
- The Uttar Pradesh Zamindari Abolition and Land Reforms Act, 1950 (Uttar Pradesh Zamindari Vinash and BhumiVyavastha Act, 1950) was included in the Ninth Schedule of the Constitution (under Entry 11), thereby granting it judicial protection.
- The functions of the Uttar Pradesh Culture Department include preservation and exhibition, publication, and documentation of historical, archaeological, and artistic heritage, but sale is not included among its functions.
- U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Spl.) (Pre) 2010 Cherasiya Dance does not belong to Gorakhpur; rather, it is performed by the Kahars of Jaunpur.
- In June 2015, the Government of India launched the Smart City Mission.
- Rampur district of Uttar Pradesh has the highest concentration of minority community population.